CHENNAI - WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25, 2026

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Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

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(Please scan the QR code to view the RHP)

POWERICA

A PROMISE FOR POWER

# POWERICA LIMITED

## TO BE LISTED ON MAIN BOARD OF NSE AND BSE

Our Company was incorporated as 'Consolidated Power Systems Private Limited', a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to certificate of incorporation dated May 4, 1984 issued by the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai-I, at Mumbai (previously known as Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Mumbai prior to amendment to gazette notification S.O. 4850 (E)) ("**ROC**"). Subsequently, the business of Hindustan Industrial & Electrical Engineers, a partnership firm constituted amongst late Naresh Chander Oberoi, late Kharatiram Kharak Puri and Mitter Sen was assigned to our Company pursuant to an agreement to assign dated May 23, 1984 with effect from June 1, 1984. Our Company became a deemed public limited company under Section 43(A) (1A) of the Companies Act, 1956, and the word "private" was struck off from the name of our Company with effect from June 15, 1988 pursuant to a special resolution passed by our Shareholders on July 15, 1988. Subsequently, the name of our Company was changed from 'Consolidated Power Systems Limited' to 'Powerica Limited', pursuant to a special resolution passed by our Shareholders on September 16, 1989. A fresh certificate of incorporation dated October 5, 1989 was accordingly issued by the RoC. For details in relation to changes in the name and registered office of our Company, see ***"History and Certain Corporate Matters – Brief history of our Company"*** and ***"History and Certain Corporate Matters - Changes in the registered office"*** on page 279 of the red herring prospectus dated March 17, 2026 read with the corrigendum to the red herring prospectus dated March 21, 2026 (**"RHP"** or **"Red Herring Prospectus"**) filed with the RoC.

**Registered and Corporate Office:** 9th Floor, Bakhtawar, Nariman Point, Mumbai – 400 021, Maharashtra, India

**Telephone:** 022 - 43152525; **Website:** www.powericaltd.com; **Contact person:** Anita Praful Renuse, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **E-mail:** investorrelations@powericaltd.com; **Corporate Identification Number:** U31100MH1984PLC032825

**THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY: BHARAT OBEROI, RENU NARESH OBEROI, JAI RAM OBEROI, NARESH OBEROI FAMILY TRUST, BHARAT OBEROI FAMILY TRUST AND KABIR AND KIMAYA FAMILY PRIVATE TRUST**

**INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF POWERICA LIMITED ("COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,100.00 CRORES COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹700.00 CRORES BY OUR COMPANY ("FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹400.00 CRORES ("OFFERED SHARES") BY THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS (AS DEFINED BELOW), CONSISTING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 280.00 CRORES BY NARESH OBEROI FAMILY TRUST AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 120.00 CRORES BY KABIR AND KIMAYA FAMILY PRIVATE TRUST (COLLECTIVELY THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES OFFERED BY THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFERED SHARES") ("OFFER FOR SALE", AND TOGETHER WITH THE FRESH ISSUE, THE "OFFER").**

**THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 2.00 CRORES (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMS MAY OFFER A DISCOUNT OF UP TO 10.00% (EQUIVALENT TO ₹37 PER EQUITY SHARE) OF THE OFFER PRICE TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT"), SUBJECT TO NECESSARY APPROVALS AS MAY BE REQUIRED. THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY.**

**DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OFACQUISITION**

| NAME OF THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS | TYPE | NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH OFFERED / AMOUNT (₹ IN CRORES) | WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION (IN ₹ PER EQUITY SHARE)# |
|---|---|---|---|
| Naresh Oberoi Family Trust | Promoter Selling Shareholder | Up to [●] equity shares of face value of ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹ 280.00 crores | Nil |
| Kabir and Kimaya Family Private Trust | Promoter Selling Shareholder | Up to [●] equity shares of face value of ₹5 each aggregating up to ₹ 120.00 crores | Nil |

*#As certified by Kapoor & Parekh Associates (FRN: 104803W), by way of their certificate dated March 17, 2026.*

**PRICE BAND: ₹375 TO ₹395 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH.**
**THE FLOOR PRICE IS 75 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 79 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.**
**BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 37 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 37 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH THEREAFTER.**
**THE PRICE TO EARNINGS (P/E) RATIO BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2025 AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND (i.e FLOOR PRICE) IS 24.57 TIMES AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND (i.e CAP PRICE) IS 25.88 TIMES.**
**A DISCOUNT OF ₹37 PER EQUITY SHARES IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION**
**WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS 18.18%.**

The details of the Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of our Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

| Particulars | At Floor Price of ₹375 per equity share | | At Cap Price of ₹395 per equity share | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Up to number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each | Up to Amount (₹ Crores) | Up to number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each | Up to Amount (₹ Crores) |
| Fresh Offer* | 1,86,72,504 | 700.00 | 1,77,26,751 | 700.00 |
| Offer for sale | 1,06,66,666 | 400.00 | 1,01,26,581 | 400.00 |
| Total Offer Size | 2,93,39,170 | 1,100.00 | 2,78,53,332 | 1,100.00 |
| Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company | 12,74,97,904 | 4,781.17 | 12,65,52,151 | 4,998.81 |

**Fresh Offer Size has been calculated considering the discount of ₹ 37 each at Cap Price and Lower Price for shares reserved under Employee Reservation portion.*

| BID/ OFFER PERIOD | BID/ OFFER OPEN |
|---|---|
| | BID/ OFFER CLOSES ON FRIDAY, MARCH 27, 2026* |

**The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.*

**WE ARE AN INTEGRATED POWER SOLUTIONS PROVIDER SPECIALISING IN DIESEL GENERATOR SETS, MEDIUM SPEED LARGE GENERATORS, AND RELATED SERVICES. WE EXPANDED INTO THE WIND POWER SECTOR AS AN INDEPENDENT POWER PRODUCER, AN ENGINEERING, PROCUREMENT, AND CONSTRUCTION CONTRACTOR, AS WELL AS AN OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE SERVICE PROVIDER FOR BALANCE OF PLANT.**

**THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.**
**THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE AND NSE.**
**NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.**
**• QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER • RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER**
**• EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 5 EACH SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹2.00 CRORE**

**IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRE-OFFER AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BRLMS.**

***IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED MARCH 17, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/ KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS DISCLOSED IN THE "BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE" SECTION ON PAGE 128 OF THE RHP VIS-A-VIS THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN THE "BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE" SECTION BEGINNING ON PAGE 128 OF THE RHP AND PROVIDED BELOW IN THIS ADVERTISEMENT.***

### Risk to Investors
### For details, refer to section titled *"Risk Factors"* on page 31 of the RHP.

1. **Risk from significant dependency on Generator Set Business:** Our Generator Set Business, contributed 80.50%, 85.00%, 86.30%, and 82.79% of our revenue from operations for the six month period ended September 30, 2025, and Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively.
   It comprises of three primary segments: (a) diesel generator sets ("DG sets") which remain the single largest product line (b) sale of medium speed large generator ("MSLG") sets; and (c) allied business activities comprising of allied products and services such as electromagnetic integrated shelters for defence; production of acoustic enclosures and manufacture, assembly, distribution, and service of Schneider Electric's PRISMA control panels and switchboards applications and Schneider PRISMA control panels and switchboards.
   Our reliance on the long-established Generator Set Business significantly increases our exposure to sector-specific and product-specific risks. Any negative developments in our Generator Set Business could have a material adverse impact on our business.
2. **Risk of our reliance on our business collaborations:** Revenue from sale of DG sets powered by Cummins engines accounted for 63.60%, 70.39%, 71.04% and 56.77% of our revenue from operations for the six month period ended September 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2025, 2024 and 2023, respectively.We have been a non-exclusive original equipment manufacturer ("OEM") for Cummins in India for over four decades, and we rely exclusively on Cummins for supply of engines and alternators for our DG sets with capacities ranging from 7.5 kVA to 3,750 kVA. In the MSLG segment, we collaborate with Hyundai for the sale of MSLG sets.
   If Cummins or Hyundai exercises their respective rights in a way that is contrary to our interests, such as appointing competitors, changing product pricing, or failing to renew existing arrangements, they may significantly impact our results of operations and profitability.
3. **Business Risk :** The table below outlines our revenue from operations derived from the independent power producer operations in our Wind Power Business for the fiscals indicated and the six month period ended September 30, 2025:

| Business Division | Six month period ended September 30, 2025 | | Fiscal 2025 | | Fiscal 2024 | | Fiscal 2023 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Revenue from operations (in ₹ crore) | (% of total revenue from operations) | Revenue from operations (in ₹ crore) | (% of total revenue from operations) | Revenue from operations (in ₹ crore) | (% of total revenue from operations) | Revenue from operations (in ₹ crore) | (% of total revenue from operations) |
| IPP operations of Wind Power Business | 124.09 | 8.57% | 200.68 | 7.56% | 218.75 | 9.90% | 208.40 | 8.76% |

   Our key wind turbine generator suppliers, Vestas Wind Technology India Private Limited and GE Renewable R&D India Private Limited, a member of the GE Vernova Group, provide operation and maintenance services under comprehensive long-term O&M contracts, typically ranging between five to 20 years, with complimentary service periods of two to three years in some cases. any disruption or shortfall in the performance or renewal of O&M contracts with our key original equipment manufacturer could materially and adversely affect our business, results of operations, and financial condition.
   While we manufacture certain allied components in-house, we remain reliant on third-party suppliers for most critical parts, including engines, alternators, steel and switchgear.
4. **Compliance Related Risk:** One of our Independent Directors, is on the board of directors of a company whose securities have been suspended from trading on the Stock Exchanges. The said suspension was procedural in nature.
5. **Legal Risk:** Our Company, some of our Promoters and Directors have been impleaded in a civil suit, where the relief sought inter-alia pertains to the family arrangement agreement and equity shares of our Company. There can be no assurance that this civil suit will be decided in our favour. Any unfavourable outcomes or developments relating to the civil suit, such as judgments or injunctions, could have a material adverse effect on our reputation, business, financial condition, results of operations, cash flows and the value of our Equity Shares.
6. **Supplier Risk:** We are reliant on third-party suppliers for most critical parts, including engines, alternators, steel, and switchgear.
   The table below sets out the cost of raw materials which we have obtained from our top supplier, top five suppliers and top 10 suppliers for our Generator Set Business and Wind Power Business divisions on a consolidated basis together with such cost as a percentage of our total expense in the six month period ended September 30, 2025, and Fiscal 2025, Fiscal 2024 and Fiscal 2023.

| Particulars | Six month period ended September 30, 2025 | | Fiscal 2025 | | Fiscal 2024 | | Fiscal 2023 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Cost of raw materials (in ₹ crore) | As a % of total expenses | Cost of raw materials (in ₹ crore) | As a % of total expenses | Cost of raw materials (in ₹ crore) | As a % of total expenses | Cost of raw materials (in ₹ crore) | As a % of total expenses |
| Top supplier (Cummins India Limited) | 664.75 | 51.13% | 1,154.81 | 46.84% | 969.01 | 48.07% | 793.63 | 35.71% |
| Top five suppliers | 919.18 | 70.76% | 1,422.43 | 57.70% | 1,232.85 | 61.15% | 1,325.23 | 59.63% |
| Top 10 suppliers* | 969.46 | 74.57% | 1,474.51 | 59.81% | 1,269.80 | 62.98% | 1,380.07 | 62.10% |

**For the six month period ended September 30, 2025 and the last three Fiscals, our top 10 suppliers included Cummins India Limited, Cummins Generator Technologies India Private Limited, Nelson Global Products India Pvt Ltd, Shiva Ferric Private Limited, Platino Automotive Private Limited, Satyam Enterprises Pune Pvt. Ltd., Anav Infra Steel Private Limited, Xicon International Limited, Shankara Building Products Limited, Zv Steel Pvt Ltd., HD Hyundai Heavy Industries Co. Ltd., Symatic Engineering Pvt. Ltd., Frontline Electricals, Naresh Steel Industries Pvt. Ltd. and Shilchar Technologies Limited. The names of two of the top 10 suppliers are not being disclosed due to non-receipt of consent from these suppliers.*

   Failure to manage supplier relationships, secure favourable supply terms, or respond effectively to cost and logistical pressures may have a material adverse effect on our business, financial condition, and results of operations.

7. **Risk of Dependency on Power purchase agreements ("PPA"):** We are dependent on our PPAs to sell power and generate our revenue from operations. Furthermore, the terms of our PPAs may expose us to certain risks that may affect our future results of operations and cash flows. Further, we may not be able to qualify, compete, or secure new projects either through competitive bidding or through bilateral arrangements with central and state utilities. As a result, we may not be able to renew or obtain new PPAs at tariffs as favourable as those under our current agreements, or may not be able to procure new PPAs at all for some or all of our capacity.
8. **Risk in relation to terms of land lease agreements:** Some of the land lease agreements for our wind power projects have shorter terms than the corresponding PPAs entered into for the respective projects. The expiry and non-renewal of such land lease agreements prior to the end of the relevant PPA, impact on title, ownership rights, development rights of the owner from whom whose premises we operate or breach of the contractual terms of any lease and license agreement may have a material adverse effect on our business, cash flows, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Risk in relation to financing agreements:** We are required to comply with certain restrictive covenants under our financing agreements. Any non-compliance may lead to, amongst others, accelerated repayment schedule and suspension of further drawdowns, which may adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.
10. **Risk of not having long-term agreements with customer and suppliers:** We do not have long-term agreements with the majority of our customers and suppliers in our Generator Set Business. This lack of long-term commitments exposes us to the risk of variations in customer demand and supply arrangements, which could lead to fluctuations and uncertainties in our Generator Set Business. In the absence of exclusive contracts with our customers, our customers may also replace our products with those of our competitors on short notice. Additionally, if we fail to meet our contractual obligations in a timely manner, or at all, our customers may be entitled to liquidated damages, as per the terms of the purchase orders.
11. **Risk in relation to geographical dependency:** Our Generator Set Business is heavily dependent on the performance of the diesel generator market in southern India and western India. According to the F&S Report, in Fiscal 2025, the southern region accounted for 29.95% and the western region for 20.03% of the LHP DG sets market by volume. According to the F&S Report, the southern region represented 28.23% of volumes for MHP DG sets, largely driven by strong information technology, manufacturing, and urban development activity in cities such as Bengaluru, Chennai, and Hyderabad. According to the F&S Report, the western region accounted for 23.62% of the MHP DG sets market by volume, supported by a robust industrial base in states such as Maharashtra and Gujarat. Any adverse changes in the conditions affecting these markets could adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition.
12. **Offer related risk:** This Offer is being undertaken as a Fresh Issue of Equity Shares as well as an Offer for Sale of Equity Shares by the Promoter Selling Shareholders. The proceeds from the Offer for Sale will be paid to the Promoter Selling Shareholders and we will not receive any proceeds from the Offer for Sale.
13. **The Price/Earnings Ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2025 for the Company at the upper end of the price band is 25.88. The average Industry group Price / Earnings ratio is 77.81.**
14. **Weighted average Return on Net Worth for past three Financial Years i.e. 2025, 2024 and 2023 is 18.18%.**
15. **Weighted average price at which the specified securities were acquired by our Promoters (including our Promoter Selling Shareholders) in the one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus**

| Name | Number of equity shares of face value of ₹ 5 each acquired in the last one year | Weighted average price of acquisition per Equity Share* (in ₹) |
|---|---|---|
| ***Promoters*** | | |
| Late Naresh Chander Oberoi** | 2,44,800 | Nil |
| Bharat Oberoi | 4,13,871 | Nil |
| Renu Naresh Oberoi** | 1,39,011 | Nil |
| Jai Ram Oberoi | 3,000 | Nil |
| Naresh Oberoi Family Trust(1)# | 2,85,00,000 | Nil |
| Bharat Oberoi Family Trust(2) | 3,91,57,650 | Nil |
| Kabir and Kimaya Family Private Trust(3)# | 1,31,52,321 | Nil |

* As certified by Kapoor & Parekh Associates (FRN: 104803W), by way of their certificate dated *March 17, 2026.*

*#Also Promoter Selling Shareholders.*

*(1) Holding Equity Shares through its trustee, Bharat Oberoi. | (2) Holding Equity Shares through its trustee, Jai Ram Oberoi.*

*(3) Holding Equity Shares through its trustee, Warmond Fiduciary Services Limited.*

***As on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, Naresh Chander Oberoi is deceased. The process in relation to the transmission of all Equity Shares held by late Naresh Chander Oberoi to his successor, Renu Naresh Oberoi, is pending and subject to grant of probate. Upon successful completion of such transmission, Renu Naresh Oberoi shall hold 5,11,748 Equity Shares aggregating to 0.47% of the pre-Offer paid up Equity Share capital of our Company.*

16. **Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, eighteen months and three years preceding March 21, 2026:**

| Period | Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition per Equity Share (in ₹)* | Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition* | Range of acquisition price: Lowest Price – Highest Price(in ₹)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Last one year from March 21, 2026 | 4.84 | 81.60 | Nil - 395.00 |
| Last 18 months from March 21, 2026 | 4.84 | 81.60 | Nil - 395.00 |
| Last three years from March 21, 2026 | 3.97 | 99.62 | Nil - 395.00 |

**As certified by Kapoor & Parekh Associates (FRN: 104803W), by way of their certificate dated March 21, 2026.*

*Continued on next page...*

...continued from previous page.

**Notes:**

(1) The shareholders of the Company, through a resolution passed on May 21, 2025, and the Board of the Company through a resolution passed on April 30, 2025, approved the issuance of bonus shares in the ratio of 3:1 for each equity share of face value ₹ 5 each. Through a Board resolution dated June 21, 2025, the Company has allotted 81,619,050 equity shares of ₹ 5 each as bonus shares to the existing equity shareholders of the Company.

(2) The above table excludes 62,00,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 5 each which were bought back by the Company on October 17, 2023, at a price of ₹ 142.00 per Equity Share pursuant to resolutions approved by the board on September 18, 2023.

**17. Weighted average cost of acquisition, Floor Price and Cap Price:**

| Past Transactions | WACA | Floor Price (in times) | Cap Price (in times) |
|---|---|---|---|
| I. Weighted average cost of acquisition for last 18 months for primary / new issue of shares (equity/ convertible securities), excluding shares issued under an employee stock option plan/employee stock option scheme, and issuance of bonus shares, during the 18 months preceding the date of this public announcement, where such issuance is equal to or more than five per cent of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of our Company (calculated based on the pre-issue capital before such transaction/s and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested), in a single transaction or multiple transactions combined together over a span of rolling 30 days | N.A. | NA | NA |
| II. Weighted average cost of acquisition for last 18 months for secondary sale/acquisition of shares (equity/convertible securities), where promoter/ promoter group entities or Promoter Selling Shareholders or shareholder(s) having the right to nominate director(s) in the Board are a party to the transaction (excluding gifts), during the 18 months preceding the date of this public announcement where either acquisition or sale is equal to or more than five per cent of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of the Company (calculated based on the pre-issue capital before such transaction/s and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested), in a single transaction or multiple transactions combined together over a span of rolling 30 days | N.A. | NA | NA |
| Since there were no Primary Issuance or Secondary Transactions of equity shares of our Company during the 18 months preceding the date of filing of this public announcement, where either issuance or acquisition/ sale is equal to or more than five per cent of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of our Company (calculated based on the pre-issue capital before such transaction/s and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested), the information has been disclosed for price per share of our Company based on the last five secondary transactions where Promoters (including the Promoter Selling Shareholder), the members of the Promoter Group, are a party to the transaction, during the last three years preceding to the date of this public announcement irrespective of the size of the transaction: | | | |
| - Based on primary issuances | Nil | NA | NA |
| - Based on secondary transactions | 20.77 | 19.02 | 18.05 |

*As certified by Kapoor & Parekh Associates (FRN: 104803W), by way of their certificate dated March 21, 2026.*

**18. The 3 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 127 public issues in the past three years, out of which 38 issues closed below the Offer price on listing date.**

| Name of the BRLMs | Total issues | Issues closed below issue price as on listing date |
|---|---|---|
| ICICI Securities Limited | 42 | 11 |
| IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* | 33 | 10 |
| Nuvama Wealth Management Limited | 16 | 5 |
| Common Issues | 36 | 12 |
| **Total** | **127** | **38** |

## Additional Information for Investors

1. Our Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement.
2. The Promoter or members of Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the DRHP till date.
3. For details regarding the aggregate pre- Offer shareholding of our Promoters, Promoter Group and additional top 10 Shareholders of our Company as a percentage of the pre-Offer paid-up Equity Share capital and post-Offer Equity shareholding of our Company, refer to the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** on page 97 of the RHP and page 3 of Pre-offer and Price Band advertisement dated March 17, 2026 and page 3 of notice to investors and corrigendum dated March 21, 2026.
4. **Comparison of Accounting Ratios with Listed Industry Peers**

| Name of Company | Face Value (₹ Per Share) | Closing price on March 11, 2026 (₹) | Revenue from operations, for Fiscal 2025 (in ₹ crores) | EPS (₹) Basic for Fiscal 2025 | EPS (₹) Diluted for Fiscal 2025 | NAV (₹ per share) for Fiscal 2025 | P/E** | RONW (%) for Fiscal 2025 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Powerica Limited*** | 5 | [●] | 2,653.27 | 15.26 | 15.26 | 99.76 | [●]* | 15.37 % |
| **Listed Peers****** | | | | | | | | |
| Cummins India Limited | 2 | 4,626.80 | 10,390.69 | 72.15 | 72.15 | 272.78 | 64.13 | 26.45% |
| Kirloskar Oil Engines Limited | 2 | 1,452.85 | 6,349.13 | 33.71 | 33.60 | 212.60 | 43.24 | 15.85% |
| NTPC Green Energy Limited | 10 | 86.70 | 2,209.64 | 0.67 | 0.67 | 21.88 | 129.40 | 2.58% |
| Acme Solar Holdings Limited | 2 | 229.85 | 1,405.13 | 4.55 | 4.53 | 74.54 | 50.74 | 5.59% |
| Adani Green Energy Limited | 10 | 849.80 | 11,212.00 | 8.37 | 8.37 | 76.62 | 101.53 | 11.90% |

Notes:

** To be included in respect of our Company in the Prospectus based on the Offer Price.*

*** Closing price as of March 11, 2026 (Source: BSE)*

****Financial information of our Company has been derived from the Restated Consolidated Financial Information as of the Financial Year ended 2025.*

***** Financial information of our listed peers has been derived from their consolidated financial information available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges*

5. Investors should read this advertisement and the RHP filed with the RoC and submitted to SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, the pre-Offer and Price Band advertisement along with the public announcement dated March 21, 2026, published in all editions of Financial Express, Jansatta and Mumbai edition of Navshakti on March 22, 2026 before making an investment decision with respect to the Offer.

## BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

**The "Basis for Offer Price" on page 128 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs : www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com and www.nuvama.com, respectively for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated for the above. (You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of ICICI Securities Limited)**

## AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

**Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):**

| Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date) | |
|---|---|
| Submission and Revision in Bids | Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. IST |
| **Bid/Offer Closing Date*** | |
| Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) for RIBs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST |
| Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is up to ₹5,00,000) | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST |
| Submission of electronic applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications of QIBs andNon-Institutional Investors) | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST |
| Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA) | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST |
| Submission of physical applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹5,00,000) | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST |
| **Modification/Revision/cancellation of Bids** | |
| Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories# | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Offer Closing Date |
| Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion* | Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST |

**UPI mandate end time shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date*

*#QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids*

**On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:**

(i) 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and NIBs, and

(ii) Until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion.

On Bid/Offer Closing Date, extension of time may be granted by Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received from RIBs, and Eligible Employees under the Employee Reservation Portion after taking into account the total number of Bids received and as reported by the BRLMs to the Stock Exchanges.

**Bid/Offer Programme**

**An indicative timetable in respect of the Offer is set out below:**

| Event | Indicative Date |
|---|---|
| Anchor Investor Bidding Date | Monday, March 23, 2026 |
| BID/OFFER OPENS ON | Tuesday, March 24, 2026 |
| BID/OFFER CLOSES ON | Friday, March 27, 2026(1)(2) |
| Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange | On or about Monday, March 30, 2026 |
| Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account* | On or about Wednesday, April 01, 2026 |
| Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees | On or about Wednesday, April 01, 2026 |
| Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges | On or about Thursday, April 02, 2026 |

*(1) Our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIBs one day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations*

*(2) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm IST on Bid/ Offer Closing Date, i.e. Friday, March 27, 2026.*

** In case of any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated in accordance with applicable law. Further, investors shall be entitled to compensation in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the agreements to be entered into between our Company with the relevant intermediaries, to the extent applicable, in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. Further, in terms of circulars prescribed by SEBI from time to time, the payment of processing fees to the SCSBs shall be undertaken pursuant to an application made by the SCSBs to the Book Running Lead Managers, and such application shall be made only after (i) unblocking of application amounts for each application received by the SCSB has been fully completed, and (ii) applicable compensation relating to investor complaints has been paid by the SCSB. RIBs and individual investors Bidding under the Non-Institutional Portion Bidding for more than ₹2,00,000 and up to ₹5,00,000, using the UPI Mechanism, shall provide their UPI ID in the Bid-cum-Application Form for Bidding through Syndicate, sub-syndicate members, Registered Brokers, RTAs or CDPs, or online using the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account (3 in 1 type accounts), provided by certain brokers.*

*The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with the SEBI ICDR Master Circular.*

**ASBA*** | **Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!**

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

For further details, check section on ASBA.

**Mandatory in public issues.**
**No cheque will be accepted.**

UPI UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

**UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.**

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Category; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section **"Offer Procedure"** on page 448 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes &intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and Axis Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

## THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Member and by intimation to Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("SCSBs"), the Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Banks, as applicable.

This Offer is being made in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended, read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process and is in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein in terms of Regulation 32(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers (**"QIBs"**, and such portion, the **"QIB Portion"**) provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations **("Anchor Investor Portion")**, of which, 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved in the following manner: (a) 33.33% shall be available for allocation to domestic Mutual Funds; and (b) 6.67% shall be reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of undersubscription in the Anchor Investor Portion reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, the unsubscribed portion shall be available for allocation to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the Net QIB Portion. Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIB Bidders (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders out of which (a) one-third of such portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹2,00,000 and up to ₹10,00,000; and (b) two-third of such portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹10,00,000, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders **("RIBs")** in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations **("Retail Portion")**, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Offer Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount **("ASBA")** process by providing details of their respective bank accounts (including UPI ID for UPI Bidders using UPI Mechanism) (as defined hereinafter) in which the Bid amount will be blocked by the SCSBs or the Sponsor Banks, as applicable, to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see ***"Offer Procedure"*** beginning on page 448 of the RHP.

**Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.**

**Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, September 17, 2021 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.**

**Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects:** For information on the main objects of our Company, please see ***""History and Certain Corporate Matters – Brief history of our Company" and "History and Certain Corporate Matters - Changes in the registered office"*** *on page 279* of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see **"*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*"** on page 488 of the RHP.

**Liability of the members of our Company:** Limited by shares.

**Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure:** As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,00,00,00,000 divided into 20,00,00,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each and ₹10,00,00,000 divided into 1,00,00,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹54,41,27,000 divided into 10,88,25,400 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 5 each. For details of the capital structure of the Company, see **"*Capital Structure*"** beginning on page 97 of the RHP.

**Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them:** The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company are late Naresh Chander Oberoi and Kharatiram Kharak Puri (deceased). For details of the share capital history of our Company please see **"*Capital Structure*"** beginning on page 97 of the RHP.

**Listing:** The Equity Shares that will be offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated September 29, 2025, respectively. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus and the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus until the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see ***"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"*** beginning on page 488 of the RHP.

**Disclaimer Clause of Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"):** SEBI only gives its observations on the offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 426 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

**Disclaimer Clause of BSE:** It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Red Herring Prospectus has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. The investors are advised to refer to the page 429 of the Red Herring Prospectus for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

**Disclaimer Clause of NSE (the Designated Stock Exchange):** It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 429 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

**General Risks:** Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and Bidders should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Bidders are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, Bidders must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have neither been recommended, nor approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the Bidders is invited to ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 31 of the RHP.

| BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS | | | REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER | COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **ICICI Securities Limited**<br>ICICI Venture House, Appasaheb Marathe Marg<br>Prabhadevi, Mumbai – 400 025, Maharashtra, India<br>**Tel:** +91 22 6807 7100; **Email:** powerica.ipo@icicisecurities.com<br>**Website:** www.icicisecurities.com<br>**Investor Grievance ID:** customercare@icicisecurities.com<br>**Contact Person:** Rahul Sharma / Namrata Ravasia<br>**SEBI Registration Number:** INM000011179 | **IIFL Capital Services Limited**<br>*(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*<br>24th Floor, One Lodha Place, Senapati Bapat Marg,<br>Lower Parel (West), Mumbai – 400 013, Maharashtra, India<br>**Tel:** +91 22 4646 4728; **Email:** powerica.ipo@iiflcap.com<br>**Website:** www.iiflcapital.com<br>**Investor Grievance ID:** ig.ib@iiflcap.com<br>**Contact Person:** Aditya Raturi/ Pawan Kumar Jain<br>**SEBI Registration Number:** INM000010940 | **Nuvama Wealth Management Limited**<br>801-804, Wing A, Building No 3, Inspire BKC, G Block,<br>Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai 400 051<br>Maharashtra, India<br>**Tel:** +91 22 4009 4400; **E-mail:** Powerica@nuvama.com<br>**Investor Grievance ID:** customerservice.mb@nuvama.com<br>**Website:** www.nuvama.com<br>**Contact Person:** Lokesh Shah<br>**SEBI Registration No.:** INM000013004 | **MUFG Intime India Private Limited**<br>*(Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited)*<br>C-101, Embassy 247, L B S Marg, Vikhroli (West)<br>Mumbai - 400 083, Maharashtra, India<br>**Tel:** +91 810 811 4949; **E-mail:** powerica.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com<br>**Investor grievance e-mail:** powerica.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com<br>**Website:** www.in.mpms.mufg.com<br>**Contact Person:** Shanti Gopalkrishnan<br>**SEBI Registration No.:** INR000004058 | **Anita Praful Renuse**<br>9th Floor, Bakhtawar, Nariman Point, Mumbai – 400 021<br>Maharashtra, India; **Tel:** 022 - 43152525; **E-mail:** cs@powericaltd.com<br><br>Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs. |

**AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:** Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 31 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP will be made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the BRLMs, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.iiflcapital.com and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.nuvama.com and at the website of the Company, POWERICA LIMITED at www.powericaltd.com and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and for National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com.

**AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:** A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: www.powericaltd.com, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.nuvama.com and www.in.mpms.mufg.com, respectively.

**AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM:** Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of our Company, **POWERICA LIMITED**: Tel.: 022 - 43152525; **BRLMs:** ICICI Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6807 7100, IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*, Tel: +91 22 4646 4728 and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Tel: +91 22 4009 4400 and **Syndicate Member:** Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, at Tel: +91 22 4009 4400, Registered Brokers, SCSBs, Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and at all the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

**SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS:** Almondz Global Securities Limited; Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Ltd; ANS Pvt Limited; Asit C Mehta; Axis Capital Limited; Centrum Broking Limited; Centrum Wealth Management Ltd; Choice Equity Broking Private Limited; DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd; Equiras Securities Pvt Ltd; Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd; Finwizard Technology private Limited; HDFC Securities Limited; IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Ltd; J M Financial Services Ltd; Jhaveri Securities; JM Financial Services Limited; Jobanputra Fiscal Services Pvt Ltd; Keynote Capitals Limited; KJMC Capital Market Services Limited; Kotak Securities Limited; LKP Securities Limited; Inventure Growth & Securities Ltd; Marwadi Shares & Finance; Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited; Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt. Ltd.; Nuvama Wealth Management Limited; Prabhudas Liladhar Pvt Ltd; Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited; Religare Securities Ltd; RR Equity Brokers Private Limited ;SBICAP Securities Limited; Sharekhan Limited; SMC Global Securities Limited; Systematix Shares and Stocks (India) Limited; Trade Bulls Securities (P) Ltd; Way2wealth brokers Pvt Ltd and YES Securities (India) Limited

**ESCROW COLLECTION BANK AND SPONSOR BANK:** Axis Bank Limited.

**PUBLIC OFFER ACCOUNT BANK, REFUND BANK AND SPONSOR BANK:** Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited.

**UPI:** UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

**All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.**

For **POWERICA LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
**Anita Praful Renuse**
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

**Place:** Mumbai, Maharashtra
**Date:** March 24, 2026

**POWERICA LIMITED** is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, an initial public offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a RHP dated March 17, 2026 with the RoC. The RHP is made available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e., ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.iiflcapital.com and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.nuvama.com, the website of the NSE at www.nseindia.com and the website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of the Company at www.powericaltd.com. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and should refer to the RHP, including the section titled ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 31 of the RHP.

The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been, and will not be, registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933 (the **"U.S. Securities Act"**) and may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. The Equity Shares offered in the Offer are being offered and sold only outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act (**"Regulation S"**) and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.

CONCEPT

**CHENNAI** - WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25, 2026

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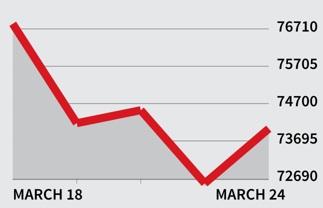



**IN FOCUS**

| | LATEST | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|
| Nifty 50 | 22912.40 | +399.75 |
| P/E Ratio (Sensex) | 20.36 | +0.38 |
| US Dollar (in ₹) | 93.86 | -0.11 |
| Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹) | 139858.00 | +848 |
| Silver 1 kg (in ₹) | 224545.00 | +5285 |

**GREEN WHEELS.** **We are actively adapting** our product range to meet EV requirements, says Rajarshi Moitra MD, Bridgestone India **p2**

**POLLSCAPE.** **Ahead of Tamil Nadu polls,** the AIADMK unveils a raft of cash assistance schemes **p7**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

## QUICKLY.

**RELIEF RALLY**

**Sensex, Nifty gain sharply on Iran 'pause'**

**Mumbai:** The benchmark indices staged a sharp relief rally on Tuesday, with the Nifty 50 surging 399.75 points to close at 22,912.40 and the BSE Sensex climbing 1,372.06 points to settle at 74,068.45. The catalyst was US President Donald Trump's announcement of a five-day pause on strikes targeting Iranian energy infrastructure. p6

**MARQUEE LISTING**

**Manipal Health files IPO papers to raise ₹8,000 cr**

**Bengaluru:** Temasek-backed Manipal Health Enterprises has filed papers with SEBI for what is expected to be one of the marquee healthcare listings of the year. The IPO comprises a fresh issue of ₹8,000 crore and an OFS of up to 4.32 crore shares. p6

**GMO 'PRESENCE'**

**China rejects three Indian rice shipments**

**New Delhi:** China has turned away three shipments of Indian rice alleging the presence of genetically modified organisms (GMO) in what appears to be a calculated attempt to gain leverage in trade talks. p10

# PM sets up 7 groups to deal with fuel, fertilizer supply

**'INDIA FIRST'.** Modi says diversifying energy sources, contacting world leaders

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**
**Prabhudatta Mishra**
New Delhi

**ASSESSING WAR IMPACT.** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, speaking in the Rajya Sabha, warned of longer disruptions ANI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday laid bare the "grave" and "serious" consequences of the West Asia war before the Rajya Sabha, outlining a multi-layered response to tackle the emerging global energy shock and safeguard supplies of critical commodities.

Modi outlined a series of urgent steps, including the creation of seven Empowered Groups led by Secretary-level officers to track disruptions, plug supply gaps and roll out time-bound solutions as the conflict threatens fuel, fertilizer and trade flows. He also detailed diplomatic and strategic efforts, including diversifying energy supply sources and contact with world leaders, to secure India's needs.

**SEVERE ENERGY CRISIS**

Warning that the war had triggered a "severe energy crisis" worldwide, the Prime Minister said India's supply lines and trade routes were already under strain. "It (the war) has created a severe energy crisis across the world. For India, too, this situation is worrisome. Our trade routes are affected. Routine supplies of essential goods, such as petrol, diesel, gas, and fertilizers, are disrupted," he said. He also flagged concerns over ships stranded in the Strait of Hormuz, and the safety of nearly one crore Indians living and working in the Gulf countries.

He cautioned that there is a "strong possibility that the adverse effects of this war will last for a long time".

With risks expected to linger, the government is widening consultations and tightening coordination across Ministries and with States. It convened an all-party meeting on Wednesday to address bottlenecks in supplies, and ensure the steady availability of fertilizers and fuel. The meeting is expected to be chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar in attendance.

An office memorandum issued late on Monday, exclusively accessed by *businessline*, said the aim of the seven Empowered Groups is to identify emerging risks, address supply disruptions and formulate time-bound strategies to manage price volatility, safeguard trade and logistics networks, and ensure the availability of critical goods.

According to the note, Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri will head the strategic affairs group, while Oil Secretary Neeraj Mittal will lead the energy group. DEA Secretary Anuradha Thakur will oversee economy and supply chains, Fertilizer Secretary Rajat Kumar Mishra will head agricultural inputs, and Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare will lead the essential commodities group. The Shipping Secretary will oversee transport and logistics, and Information and Broadcasting Secretary Sanjay Jaju will head the communication and public engagement group.

Also read p8

## Goldman cuts CY26 growth forecast

**Shishir Sinha**
New Delhi

Goldman Sachs on Tuesday cut India's growth forecast for calendar 2026 by 60 basis points to 5.9 per cent. This is the first forecast revision by any agency post the start of the West Asia war.

Details p3

# IPL valuations hit a six: RCB goes for \$1.78 b, Rajasthan Royals for \$1.63 b

**Meenakshi Verma Ambwani**
New Delhi

The deals set a new benchmark for IPL franchise valuations

Two marquee Indian Premier League (IPL) franchises have attracted record-breaking bids, underscoring the cricket league's soaring valuations and global investor appeal.

Rajasthan Royals is set to be sold to a consortium led by US-based tech entrepreneur Kal Somani for a reported \$1.63 billion, while Royal Challengers Bengaluru has been acquired by a consortium comprising the Aditya Birla Group, the Times Group, Bolt Ventures and Blackstone for \$1.78 billion.

Analysts said this sets a new benchmark for IPL franchise valuations, receiving strong interest from global investors.

**WALMART BACKING**

For the Rajasthan Royals, the Somani-led consortium is backed by members of prominent American business families, including the Walmart family.

Somani's business interests span tech solutions, data privacy and AI governance and edtech segments. He is the founder of IntraEdge, Truyo.Ai and Aca demian. He is an existing investor in Rajasthan Royals. He is also the co-owner of Motor City Golf Club.

Rajasthan Royals did not comment on the transaction, and *businessline*'s queries and text messages did not elicit a response till press time.

The deal will require BCCI approval and is likely to be formalised later this year, post the coming IPL season.

**BIRLA TEAM PICKS RCB**

In a separate deal, Aditya Birla Group, The Times of India Group, Bolt Ventures and Blackstone's perpetual private equity strategy, BXPE, have signed a definitive agreement to acquire 100 per cent of Royal Challengers Bengaluru, encompassing both the men's Indian Premier League franchise and the Women's Premier League franchise, from United Spirits Limited, a subsidiary of Diageo plc.

Under the new ownership structure, Aryaman Vikram Birla, Director, Aditya Birla Group, will serve as Chairman and Satyan Gajwani of The Times of India Group will be Vice-Chairman of the franchise.

Kumar Mangalam Birla, Chairman, Aditya Birla Group, said, "Over the past two decades, the IPL has morphed to become a global sporting powerhouse that has changed the face of Indian cricket, creating enormous value for India. RCB, as one of the most compelling franchises in modern sport, offers the Aditya Birla Group a distinctive platform to extend its legacy of institution-building into the arena of global sport."

Santosh N, Managing Partner of D&P Advisory, said: "This development indicates a strong global investor interest in IPL franchises as an asset class. The supply-demand mismatch, with only so many IPL teams available to be invested in, has led to a high premium over intrinsic valuation."

Karan Taurani, EVP, Elara Capital, said the RR deal sets a new benchmark for IPL franchise valuation.

# HDFC Bank board calls in law firms to review Chakraborty's resignation letter

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Atanu Chakraborty

The drama over the abrupt resignation of Atanu Chakraborty as the Part-time Chairman and Independent Director of HDFC Bank is getting curiouser and curiouser.

The bank's board has approved the appointment of law firms (domestic and international) to conduct a review of Chakraborty's resignation letter.

The law firms have been asked to provide their report within a reasonable period of time, the bank said in a regulatory filing.

Experts said the appointment of the law firms to go into Chakraborty's resignation letter, which contains several allegations, suggests that the bank may be weighing if his action is in keeping with the spirit of the Companies Act, 2013.

**DIRECTORS DUTY**

Legal expert and former investment banker Vijay Trimbak Gokhale observed that a director, including an independent director, is duty bound to act in good faith to promote the objects of the company for the benefit of its members and in the best interests of all stakeholders.

He emphasised that if a director has concerns over lack of values and ethics in the management, he/she has a fiduciary responsibility to shareholders and other stakeholders to inform the board and the regulator.

"At the same time, the other members of the board cannot plead ignorance about gaps and lapses in the functioning of the institution. Have they discharged their responsibility by voicing their concerns in the board meeting? It is only the minutes of the board meeting that can throw a light on this," Gokhale said.

The insinuations made by Chakraborty resulted in the bank's shares getting hammered and plumbing yearly lows.

Some brokerages removed it from the 'top buys' list or downgraded the price target citing governance issues and need for more disclosures.

Sources said that considering the aftermath of the resignation and the concerns raised, a review of the legalities of the situation was warranted.

Chakraborty stirred a hornet's nest by abruptly resigning from the bank. In his resignation letter, he cited "certain happenings and practices within the bank that I have observed over the last two years are not in congruence with my personal values and ethics".

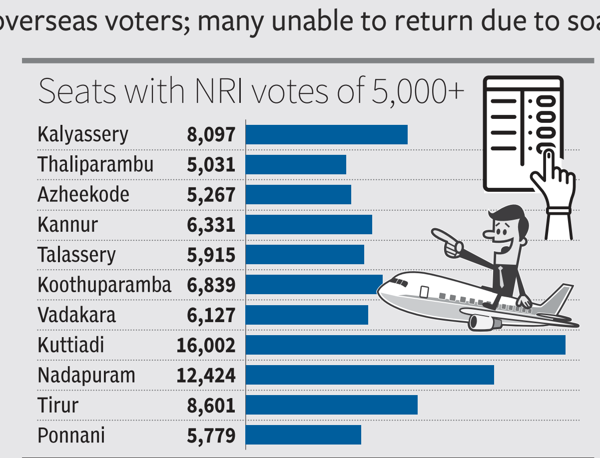
## LOW ON GAS

**RUNNING ON FUMES.** People queue up with empty cooking gas cylinders to collect refills in Chikkamagaluru, Karnataka, with supplies of LPG disrupted by the US/Israel-Iran war. Though the government has acknowledged supply disruptions, it has also lined up several cargoes. No dry out has been reported at LPG distributorships, it said, downplaying panic booking at some places PTI

# Kerala parties mull chartering flights to bring Gulf voters

State has 2.23 lakh overseas voters; many unable to return due to soaring fares, flight cuts

**Chitra Narayanan**
Kochi/Thiruvananthapuram




Source: Election Commission

Every vote counts in a tight contest. With Kerala's Assembly elections poised on a knife's edge, political parties in the State are thinking of chartering flights to bring home voters from Gulf nations to exercise their franchise.

They fear flight cuts and prohibitive fares could keep NRI voters away. Of the 2.69 crore voters in Kerala's final election list, 2.23 lakh are overseas voters (as per ECI data), who could well prove the difference between a win or a loss in several constituencies.

Take the Kuttiadi seat in Kozhikode, which has 16,002 overseas voters and the margin of victory in the last election was barely 333. Or the neighbouring Nadapuram that has over 12,424 overseas voters and where the margin of victory was just 3,385 last time.

Both Muslim League General Secretary PMA Salam and senior Congress leader VD Satheesan said their parties may charter flights to bring expatriate voters from GCC countries.

**WEST ASIA CRISIS**

Speaking to *businessline*, Salam said the ongoing crisis in West Asia had prompted political parties to explore such measures. He pointed out that the League had previously arranged chartered flights to North Kerala during the Covid period.

According to him, the Kerala Muslim Cultural Committee (KMCC), the overseas cultural wing of the League, is actively coordinating to charter flights for Malayalees employed across Gulf nations. These services are expected to be scheduled close to the polling date. However, flight operators have requested KMCC to secure permissions from West Asian governments before operating the aircraft.

Similarly, the go-getting Satheesan, the Leader of the Opposition in the Kerala Assembly, told *businessline*: "Our party is thinking of chartering flights to bring voters from the Gulf."

He, however, clarified that they were thinking of doing so only for the working class, who cannot afford the current high fares.

Significantly, most NRI voters in the State are from the Malabar region: Kozhikode (57,679), Kannur (52,163) and Malappuram (39,501). Analysts feel if Gulf Keralites are unable to vote, it could well have a bearing on poll outcomes in some constituencies.

(With inputs from Vinson Kurian and V Sajeev Kumar)

# As semaglutide generics flood the market, Drugs Controller lens on use, supply chain

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Increased audits aim to curb the misuse of semaglutide-based weight-loss and diabetes treatments

With a slew of cheaper generic versions of semaglutide hitting the market over the weekend, the Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) has stepped up surveillance on the supply chain and unauthorised sale and promotion of the GLP-1 drug, used to treat obesity and Type 2 diabetes.

"The Drug Controller, in collaboration with State regulators, has initiated a series of targeted actions to curb possible malpractices across the pharmaceutical supply chain and prevent unauthorised sales and use," said a Health Ministry note.

**ADVERSE EFFECTS**

With more options available, "concerns have emerged regarding their on-demand availability through retail pharmacies, online platforms, wholesalers and wellness clinics," the Ministry said, adding, "These drugs, when used without proper medical supervision, may lead to serious adverse effects and related health risks."

In the recent weeks, enforcement activities have been scaled up, it said. "Audits and inspections were conducted at 49 entities, including online pharmacy warehouses, drug wholesalers, retailers, wellness and slimming clinics."

The inspections were across the country and focused on identifying violations related to unauthorised sale, improper prescription practices and misleading marketing.

"Notices have also been sent to defaulting entities," it added.

Semaglutide is the active ingredient in Novo Nordisk's globally popular weightloss and diabetes drugs Wegovy and Ozempic, respectively.

**GENERIC VERSIONS**

A patent on semaglutide expired in markets including India last Friday, leading to over a handful of generic companies launching their less expensive versions of the drug in multiple delivery devices (vials with dose-specific syringes, pre-filled pens, injectables and tablets).

The generic versions are 50-80 per cent cheaper than the innovator's price.

**MORE SURVEILLANCE**

The regulatory surveillance will continue to be intensified in the coming weeks, the Ministry said.

"Non-compliance will be dealt strictly with actions including cancellation of licences, penalties, and prosecution under applicable laws," it added.

"The misuse of weight loss drugs without clinical oversight can lead to severe health complications," the note reiterated, urging citizens to take treatment only on the prescription of qualified medical practitioners. The drug can be prescribed by endocrinologists, internal medicine specialists and for some indications by cardiologists, it said.

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WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25 - 2026

## QUICKLY.

**Jindal Stainless sets up 1.2 mtpa Indonesia plant**


**Mumbai:** Jindal Stainless has commissioned a 1.2 million tonnes per annum (mtpa) stainless steel melt shop (SMS) in Indonesia, developed through the company's joint venture, ahead of schedule. The company's total melting capacity will increase to 4.2 mtpa, including 3 mtpa in India. The company is also gearing up to commission a new 1.1 mtpa hot rolled annealed pickled line and 0.17 mtpa cold rolling capacity at Jajpur in Odisha, by Q4 FY27 and Q2 FY27 respectively at an investment of ₹1,900 crore. The firm has earmarked a fresh investment of ₹900 crore at Hisar and Kharagpur which are expected to be commissioned by Q2 FY28. The expanded downstream facilities will enable the production of thinner cold rolled products tailored for high-growth industries. With these projects, the company aims to increase its cold rolling capacity from 2.05 mtpa to 2.67 mtpa by FY28. OUR BUREAU

# Steel companies gearing up to hike prices further

**RISING COST.** Domestic hot rolled coil prices are already up 23% at ₹54,000-58,000/tonne

**Suresh P Iyengar**
Mumbai

Steel companies are gearing up for substantial increase in prices with the recent spike in key raw material and logistics costs on the back of the ongoing war in West Asia.

Though steel firms have increased prices of late to offset iron ore and energy costs, the prolonged US attacks on Iran have pushed up the costs of all imported raw materials including coking coal, alongside the shipping charges.

The domestic hot rolled coil prices are already up 23 per cent at ₹54,000-58,000 a tonne against ₹47,000 a tonne recorded last November, driven by the spike in iron ore and energy costs.

Bhavik Bhagwanji Shah, Research Analyst, Metals & Mining, Choice Institutional Equities, said though prices have risen 15–20 per cent from recent lows, the cost of coking coal and ferro-alloys have climbed at a faster clip, compressing the EBITDA spreads for non-integrated players.

"We anticipate further hike of ₹1,000–2,000 a tonne in the coming weeks. However, a sharper rise may face resistance from price-sensitive sectors such as automotive and white goods," he said.

**GEOPOLITICAL CONCERN.** Prolonged US attacks on Iran have pushed up the cost of all imported raw materials, including coking coal, alongside shipping charges

**STARK DIVIDE**

The ongoing gas and fuel shortages are creating a stark divide in the industry. The MSME steel cluster, which contributes nearly 40 per cent of India's output, is facing an operational crisis. Gas supply cuts of up to 70 per cent in key industrial hubs such as Punjab and Maharashtra have led to reduced shifts and potential shutdown risks.

The gas shortage has already forced many MSME downstream producers to down shutters and this will impact demand in the near future, said a steel company official.

Early this month, the Indian Steel Association moved the government over the shortage of propane and liquefied petroleum gas impact on the entire value chain. JSW Steel noted that disruptions in fuel supplies and maritime operations are beginning to affect its operational stability and supply chain.

JSW Steel Coated Products faces the risk of failing to meet its obligations to sell and supply tinplate under a government production-linked incentive scheme and is requesting a six-month extension. The company has received a force majeure notice from one of its key suppliers — Petronet LNG Ltd — which has affected LNG supplies.

Divya Mandaliya, Commodity Research Analyst, Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers, said the recent spike in fuel prices with diesel doubling to $180 a barrel has already pushed mining and logistics costs higher and has directly impacted steel cost curves.

While cost pressures will keep steel prices higher, the macro uncertainty and slowing demand will prevent a sustained bull run keeping the market volatile, she said.

# Rupee decline takes real effective exchange rate to 12-year low

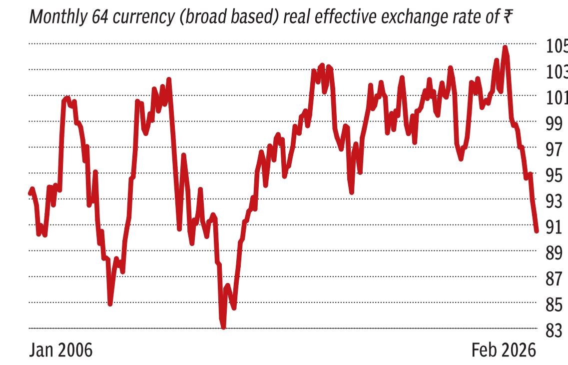
**Sourashis Banerjee**
Chennai

The rupee, which has been on a weak wicket since last year is taking a further hit due to the ongoing West Asia crisis, losing almost 9 per cent over the past 12 months. This decline, along with the cooling inflation in India, has taken the rupee's broad-based real effective exchange rate (REER) at the end of February 2026 to its lowest since July 2014.

**Relative valuation**

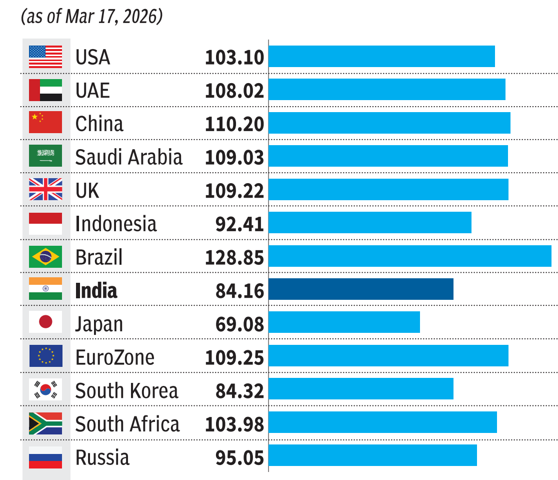
**REER at the lowest since July 2014**

*Monthly 64 currency (broad based) real effective exchange rate of ₹*




**Rupee's NEER the lowest among EM currencies**

*(as of Mar 17, 2026)*




Source: BIS, Bloomberg

**DATA FOCUS.**

While, at moderate levels, this improves the export competitiveness of the rupee, experts say that continuous depreciation will soon begin hurting the domestic economy.

The broad-based REER, as given by the Bank of International Settlement, adjusts for inflation and compares the rupee against a basket of 64 currencies from India's key trading partners. It is indexed to 100 for the year 2020.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda, explained: "REER is the inflation adjusted nominal effective exchange rate (NEER). Given our low inflation, REER has closely followed the movements of NEER, and depending on the inflation numbers that come out for March, the REER can fall further relative to the NEER."

**WEAK CURRENCY**

According to Anindya Banerjee, Head of Research at Kotak Securities, "The fall in the REER value of the rupee should be considered under two separate circumstances: one before the war and the other after. Before the war the rupee was already one of the weakest and under-valued currencies. In a way it was a deliberate ploy by the RBI, to use the currency as an effective tool to fight the trade war conditions, made possible by the prevalent low-inflation in our economy."

"However, since the end of February, following the attack on Iran, it is a play on oil. The sudden spike in oil prices from around $65 per barrel to about $113 per barrel, an almost 75 per cent jump within just three weeks has created a shock. This shock induced a surge in the demand for dollar within a very short period of time, creating a demand-supply imbalance. To bridge this gap the RBI has to intervene by either managing the rupee's value, or bond yields or FPI outflows. Given that FPI outflows (at almost $12 billion) are already at highs last seen during March 2020 (the pandemic lockdown) and bond yields are also rising for most of the global economies, the RBI has no choice but to allow the rupee to be the shock absorber," explained Banerjee.

Although he feels normalisation of the Hormuz Strait will help the rupee appreciate, Banerjee, however, cautioned against the excessive dependence on the depreciation of the currency to tide over all challenges.

"For a country where consumption is the growth engine, too much depreciation of the currency hits consumption first," he noted.

Vikram Murarka, Chief Currency Strategist at Kshitij Consultancy Services, on the other hand, questioned the wisdom of allowing for currency depreciation, altogether.

"The depreciation of the rupee does not help us in any manner. There is ample data to show that it does not help us to increase our exports, and it obviously does not help us regarding our imports or on the inflation front. Further, it is a challenge in attracting capital," he added.

**RUPEE NEER VS REST**

Of a basket of certain big developed and emerging market (EM) currencies, the rupee has been one of the most undervalued, with a NEER of 84.16 as of March 17, 2026. Only the Japanese Yen is more undervalued at 69.08. As noted earlier, although a low value of NEER points to relative export competitiveness, a weak currency has its own challenges.

Presently, Brazil with a NEER of 128.85, China with a NEER of 110.2 and the Euro-zone with a NEER of 109.25 have the most over-valued currencies.

# How the ₹2-crore BMW i7 draws same ₹8,000 tax as the ₹12-lakh Punch.ev

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

India's luxury carmakers are backing a quiet but consequential tax change, one they believe could reshape executive compensation and corporate mobility.

At the heart of it is a deceptively simple rule: Under the revised income tax framework, a ₹2-crore BMW i7 now carries the same taxable perquisite as a ₹12-lakh Tata Punch.ev at a flat ₹8,000 a month.

> The new tax benefits create meaningful annual savings and turn EVs into a smart component of total compensation
>
> **HARDEEP SINGH BRAR**
> President & CEO, BMW India

The shift stems from changes under 3(2)(A) of the Income-Tax Rules, governing company-car leases, removing engine-based classifications and assigning a fixed taxable value of ₹5,000 a month, plus ₹3,000 for a chauffeur, irrespective of the vehicle's price.

BMW Group India, which leads the luxury EV segment with an estimated 60–64 per cent share, stated the move materially changes how EVs fit into executive pay structures.

"The new tax benefits create meaningful annual savings and turn EVs into a smart component of total compensation," said Hardeep Singh Brar, President and CEO. "For senior executives, company leasing programmes now offer significantly lower overall ownership costs."

Mercedes-Benz India spokesperson called it "a positive step towards enhancing BEV penetration for leasing companies", even as it acknowledged that corporate leasing remains an under-developed channel in luxury car sales.

**'LOGIC DISMANTLED'**

At its core, the change reverses tax logic. The 'bigger car, bigger tax' principle is being dismantled, said Dinkar Sharma, Partner at Jotwani Associates, creating an "equaliser effect" where luxury and entry-level EVs fall into the same tax bracket, even as the benefit scales sharply with price.

In practice, a premium EV with a driver can cost a company close to ₹36 lakh annually, yet only ₹96,000 is added to the employee's taxable income, creating a wide arbitrage between value received and tax paid. Where employees bear running costs, the taxable value drops further.

The shift is already gaining traction in corporate leasing. By embedding lease costs within cost-to-company structures, the transition remains largely cost-neutral for employers while significantly enhancing perceived benefits for employees.

"When the tax outcome is identical, the conversation shifts from affordability to entitlement," said a senior executive at a leasing firm. "At the C-suite level, the default choice will inevitably move up-market."

For car makers, the timing is critical. "Corporate car leasing is emerging as a strong demand lever for BMW, Mercedes-Benz, Volvo, Audi, and Lexus as they expand their EV portfolios. It also benefits newer entrants such as JSW MG Motor and VinFast as they push into premium segments to gain market share," said an industry analyst.

For policymakers, the move signals a pivot from upfront subsidies to tax-led demand creation. For executives, it delivers something simpler — the ability to drive a luxury EV at a fraction of its real cost.

# Priya Kapur removes mother-in-law Rani Kapur as RK Family trustee

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

Priya Kapur, Trustee and Beneficiary of the RK Family Trust, and wife of late Sunjay Kapur, issued a formal notice removing her mother-in-law Rani Kapur as a trustee, citing breach of fiduciary duties and conduct adverse to the interests of the trust and its beneficiaries.

The development follows a sequence of events relating to the RK Family Trust created in 2017 by Rani Kapur for the benefit of her only son late Sunjay Kapur, who was its sole beneficiary during his lifetime.

Following Sunjay Kapur's passing on June 12, 2025, the beneficial interests under the trust devolved upon his legal heirs as per the trust deed.

In a notice dated March 24, Priya Kapur stated Rani Kapur's challenge to the trust itself, while simultaneously asserting powers under it and claiming ownership of its assets, constitutes a breach of fiduciary obligations expected of a trustee.

"The Trust was settled by you on 26.10.2017 as a private, irrevocable Trust and has, since its inception, been administered by its Trustees for the benefit of its beneficiaries. It is a matter of record that my husband late Sunjay Kapur, who was your only son, was the sole beneficiary of the Trust during his lifetime. Upon the untimely and unfortunate demise of late Sunjay Kapur on 12.06.2025, beneficial interest in the Trust, in terms of the Trust Deed, devolved upon me, Master Azarias Suri Kapur, and other children of the late Sunjay Kapur from his previous marriage, i.e, Samaira Kapur and Master Kiaan Kapur," Priya Kapur wrote in the notice.

On January 10 this year, Priya Kapur issued a cease-and-desist notice alleging that statements and actions disputing the creation and validity of the trust and asserting personal ownership over trust assets were prejudicial to the interest of the beneficiaries.

**CIVIL SUIT**

Ten days later, on January 20, Rani Kapur filed a civil suit at the Delhi High Court, seeking declarations that the trust is invalid and claiming personal ownership over the assets forming part of the trust corpus.

On March 21, Rani Kapur issued a notice purporting to remove Priya Kapur as trustee. And, subsequently, in the notice sent on Tuesday, Priya Kapur stated that Rani Kapur's challenge to the trust, while simultaneously asserting powers under it and claiming ownership of its assets, constitutes a breach of fiduciary obligations.

# NCLAT denies interim stay on Vedanta plea against nod for Adani bid for JAL

**Press Trust of India**
New Delhi

The insolvency appellate tribunal on Tuesday declined any interim stay over the Vedanta Group's plea against the order passed by the NCLT approving ₹14,535 crore bid by Adani Group's bid for acquiring Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL). The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal's (NCLAT) two-member bench sought a response from the Committee of Creditors (CoC) of JAL in a week.

**NEXT HEARING**

It directed to list the matter on April 10 for the next hearing.

Vedanta was in the race to acquire JAL through an insolvency process, but the lenders in November last year approved the resolution plan of Adani Enterprises.

Last week, the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) approved the Adani bid. Challenging the NCLT order, Vedanta filed two appeals before the NCLAT.

# Maruti approves ₹10,189 cr investment for 2.5 lakh units additional capacity

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

Maruti Suzuki on Tuesday said its board has approved an investment of ₹10,189 crore for a proposed first-phase capacity addition at the Khoraj Industrial Estate in Gujarat.

"This includes investment for the first phase of car manufacturing plant having an annual manufacturing capacity of 2,50,000 units and some common infrastructure and facilities for future plants. This first phase of capacity of 2,50,000 vehicles per annum is expected to be added by 2029 subject to market conditions," the company said in filings to the stock exchanges.

The development comes after the company's board granting approval to acquire land at Khoraj Industrial Estate from the Gujarat Industrial Development Corporation on January 12 this year.

Further, the meeting on Tuesday approved addition of the first phase of capacity at this site.

The expansion will be funded through internal accruals, MSIL said, adding that it was planned due to growth in domestic demand as well as exports.

**HIGHEST-EVER SALES**

The company recorded total sales of 2.14 lakh units in February this year, the highest-ever in any February and its plants were operating at more than 100 per cent production capacity.

Between April and February (FY26), the company sold 21,97,462 units (domestic and exports) as compared with 20,41,282 units in the same period previous fiscal.

MSIL had said that a production line will be commissioned at Kharkhoda in April and that should bring in more capacity.

The company has existing capacity of around 24 lakh units per annum in Gurugram, Manesar, Kharkhoda and Hansalpur, with a capability to produce 26 lakh units per annum.

# We will raise passenger car tyre capacity by 20%: Bridgestone

**bl.interview**

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

Bridgestone India is looking to deploy a ₹700–740 crore investment, announced in 2024, to expand its passenger car tyre capacity by over 20 per cent, banking on sustained growth in India's automotive market even as global supply chains face mounting pressure.

The timing aligns with a buoyant domestic market: India's passenger vehicle industry is projected to close FY26 with sales of approximately 4.7 million units, underpinned by strong demand across passenger cars and buses — both core segments for the company. Managing Director Rajarshi Moitra said the capital infusion would scale production capacity from roughly 10.8 million tyres today to nearly 13 million units over the next five years.

*Edited excerpts:*

**Are you considering price hikes given rising input costs?**

We are unable to comment on any pricing actions we may undertake keeping with our obligations under Competition Commission regulations.

That said, we are closely monitoring input costs and will take appropriate action as and when required.

**Is the West Asia situation a concern for your supply chain?**

We are watching the developments in West Asia carefully. There is no immediate disruption at this stage, but we cannot rule out some impact further down the line.

We continue to assess the situation and will respond accordingly.

**What is the scale of the capex and how much capacity will it add?**

We have committed approximately $85 million (₹700–740 crore) in capital expenditure to be deployed over three to four years.

> Capital infusion would scale production capacity from roughly 10.8 million tyres today to nearly 13 million over next five years
>
> **RAJARSHI MOITRA**
> MD, Bridgestone India

This will take our passenger car tyre capacity from around 10.8 million units currently to approximately 12.8–13 million units over the next five years.

**What is driving growth, and how do you see your market position evolving?**

Growth is coming from the passenger car segment, especially higher rim sizes.

The industry is expected to grow around 5–7 per cent, and we aim to grow slightly ahead while maintaining our leadership position.

We already have over 20 per cent market share and are a clear leader.

Our focus is not to chase volume blindly, but to sustain that leadership with a premium offering.

**How does this investment fit into your broader strategy and OEM relationships?**

Our strategy is built around a "premium mass" positioning, competing across segments with a strong premium value proposition. OEM partnerships remain central to both demand generation and technology development, and we continue to deepen ties with leading manufacturers.

**What role will tyre-as-a-service play in your growth plans?**

Tyre-as-a-service is an increasingly important part of our business. We already serve more than 60 customers, primarily mid-sized fleet operators. Tyres represent the second-highest operating cost for fleets, including bus operators and truck operators with fleet sizes above 300 trucks. In this model, where we manage the full tyre lifecycle, the company ties up with us for its tyre lifecycle; it offers a compelling value proposition.

**How are you approaching the EV segment?**

We are actively adapting our product range to meet EV-specific requirements.

## QUICKLY.

**'Private sector capex may fall 16.5% to ₹9.55 lakh cr'**

**New Delhi:** Capital expenditure by the private sector on acquisition of new assets is estimated to decline by 16.5 per cent to ₹9.55 lakh crore in 2026-27, a government survey has said. The survey indicated that during 2025-26, about 60.13 per cent of enterprises in the private corporate sector undertook capital expenditure primarily with the objective of income generation, while 42.12 per cent reported capex for upgradation of existing capacity. PTI

**Govt extends gold import licence validity amid crisis**

**New Delhi:** The government on Tuesday extended the validity of licences issued for gold import at quota-based duty concession under a free trade pact with the UAE till June 3 amid the West Asian crisis. Under the India-UAE economic partnership agreement, India has granted quota-based duty concessions on gold imports under the tariff rate quota. PTI

# US paper questions core WTO principles ahead of key meet

**NORMS EROSION.** Push for reciprocity deals seen as increasing pressure on India

**Amiti Sen**
New Delhi


**BIG BIAS.** The latest paper was an attempt by the US to justify its policy of discriminating between trade partners, say experts

A US paper on WTO reforms circulated this week questions core principles such as the right to non-discriminatory treatment under the most favoured nation (MFN) rule, special and differential treatment for developing countries, and the consensus-based decision-making that underpins the multilateral system, raising pressure on India and several other developing economies.

Released just days before the 14th WTO Ministerial Conference kicks off in Yaoundé on March 26-29, the paper pushes for a pathway to plurilateral agreements (not including the entire membership) and questions the continued self-designation of developing country status by larger economies, even though no country is named directly.

Experts cautioned that the latest paper was yet another attempt by the US to justify its policy of discriminating between trade partners and undermine the institution's foundation principles.

The US submission noted that a paper on WTO reforms submitted by Washington in December 2025 had resulted in exchange of papers from other countries showing the strength of a growing member-driven conversation on reform.

"Such a conversation is both healthy and necessary if the WTO is to be relevant and meaningfully contribute as the world transitions to a new economic order premised on reciprocity and balance and oriented toward serving concrete national interests," it said.

**FRANK DISCUSSION**

The US believes members need to rethink how the MFN principle functions in its current form and embark on a frank discussion of the link between MFN and reciprocity, which itself is a bedrock WTO founding principle, it stated.

This comes amid ongoing resistance from India and some other members to efforts to integrate the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement into the WTO's formal structure. These countries maintain that bringing plurilaterals into the multilateral system without full consensus risks undermining the institution's foundational principles.

**RULE-BASED SYSTEM**

"Trump has been undermining the WTO's rule based system. Now he wants to institutionalise it. Taking away MFN and linking it with reciprocity will give US the freedom to discriminate against countries," pointed out trade expert Biswajit Dhar.

Pushing for plurilaterals is another way of bringing in mayhem as a group of countries can stand up anytime and start negotiations on any issue without consent of others, Dhar noted.

# Goldman Sachs cuts India's CY26 growth forecast by 60 bps to 5.9%

**Shishir Sinha**
New Delhi

Goldman Sachs on Tuesday cut India's growth forecast by 60 basis points for calendar year 2026. This is the first forecast revision by any agency after the beginning of the West Asia war.

In its report, *A Tighter Squeeze on Asia's Energy Supply*, the agency said: "New cuts to our growth forecasts are negligible in Japan, China, Korea and Taiwan, but more than 0.5pp in India, the Philippines, Thailand and Singapore."

The pre-Iran war forecast was 7 per cent, which was lowered to 6.5 per cent on March 13 and now it has been further slashed to 5.9 per cent.

**BINDING CONSTRAINT**

Though the agency did discuss the crude price scenario, but at the same time, it considered whether quantity — rather than price — of gas proves to be the binding constraint on activity due to

> **The pre-Iran war forecast was** 7%, **which was lowered** to 6.5% on March 13 and has been further slashed to 5.9%

'force majeure' at key producers (i.e., Qatar Energy) sharply reducing the flow of energy in the near term.

"This seems a greater risk for LNG than for oil in the near term, though either is possible," it said.

The agency assessed potential shortage risks through two lenses – first, a country's exposure to imported energy, with higher exposures implying more shortage risk. Second, it ranked regional economies by per-capita income.

"Our expectation is that higher-income countries a) have more storage if they are net energy importers (e.g., Japan, Korea top the region in terms of oil reserves) and more importantly b) can 'bid away' the marginal unit of energy over time from lower-income economies. We would therefore expect lower-income economies with larger imported energy needs to face the highest shortage risks," it said, while adding that Thailand, India stand out as lower per capita income economies with high energy imports.

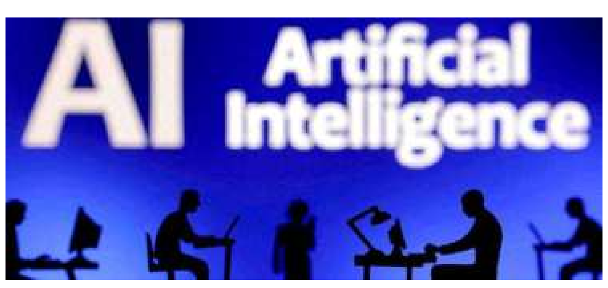
**DEFICIT WORRIES**

With higher crude prices, the expectation is that current account deficit (difference between payment received and made in US dollar) will go up. "Our forecasts now imply 2026 current account deficits of 2 per cent of GDP or larger for India, Indonesia, the Philippines, and New Zealand," the agency said.

Further it said inflation target for India was revised by 40 basis points to 4.6 per cent. The Monetary Policy Committee under the Chairmanship of RBI Governor will meet early next week to review growth outlook, inflation and policy rates.

# AI drives surge in data, cloud, cyber spends despite tight tech budgets

**Sanjana B**
Bengaluru




**NEW FRONTIERS.** AI is opening fresh areas of addressable work, including cybersecurity, core operations, custom systems integration and even mainframe modernisation

AI-led transformation is emerging as a key growth driver for IT services, with companies seeing a surge in adjacent spending on data modernisation, cloud, and cybersecurity, even as overall technology budgets remain constrained.

Julie Sweet, Chair and CEO of Accenture, highlighted this pattern during the company's Q2 FY26 earnings call, adding that AI is emerging as a key tailwind for the company's growth.

"Clients are implementing foundational programmes with our ecosystem partners to capture the full opportunity of AI. These typically involve cloud, security, and data modernisation, often combined with operating model and talent transformation. We continue to see that at least one out of every two advanced AI projects leads to a data project," she observed.

A report by Emkay Global Financial Services explained that Advanced AI is opening new areas of addressable work, including cybersecurity, core operations, custom systems integration, and even mainframe modernisation.

> **AI is making some previously uneconomic** or technically difficult modernisation work feasible

AI is making some previously uneconomic or technically difficult modernisation work feasible, while also enabling more complex use cases in areas such as KYC in banking, claims in insurance, prior authorisation in healthcare, and manufacturing. "AI is causing a significant spike in spending in the data modernisation area. The increased attack surface due to AI is also causing a spike in cybersecurity spending. Cloud is a function of consumption and scales linearly with workloads in the cloud. We continue to see bundled deals where clients are signing larger data modernisation deals, even as they create larger and more integrated deals in cyber/cloud," said Yugal Joshi, Partner, Everest Group.

**SIGNIFICANT WORK**

A similar pattern is being observed across Indian IT firms. Breakthrough AI transformation creates additional significant work in terms of process re-design, data modernisation, skill upgrades, and tech of the future — all of which require a robust consulting layer.

**GROWTH DRAG**

This is also compounded by ongoing revenue compression in the traditional segments, which creates a drag on growth.

That said, this momentum doesn't mean a notable increase in technology budgets just yet. Given the current environment, technology budgets are increasingly modest at low to mid-single digits, even as AI budgets are almost doubling on-year, Joshi noted.

thehindubusinessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25, 2026

## Selling strategy

*Larger stake offer, better pricing can aid IDBI Bank sale*

**Recent reports on the aborted strategic sale of IDBI Bank have raised questions about the structuring and pricing of the offer. The strategic sale seems to have been scrapped after bids from the two prospective buyers — Emirates NBD Bank and Fairfax India — fell short of the reserve price. An earlier attempt to privatise IDBI Bank in 2016 fell through due to high valuations demanded by the Centre.**

Given the existing client base and business of the bank, it may not be hard to find a strategic buyer wanting a foothold in the fast growing Indian banking industry. But the Centre should be more reasonable about the price and be open to giving full control to the buyer. IDBI Bank has turned around its operations since LIC bought a majority stake for ₹21,624 crore in 2019 to bail out the bank. Asset quality has improved, with net NPAs at 0.18 per cent and gross NPAs at 2.57 per cent towards the end of December 2025. The bank is well capitalised with Tier 1 capital at 23.53 per cent. Business growth is steady with credit growth of 15 per cent and deposit growth of 9 per cent in the third quarter of FY26 compared with the same quarter last fiscal year. While net interest margin has been squeezed slightly due to RBI's rate cuts, it still stands at a steady 3.52 per cent. Even so, there has been a sharp rise in stock price over the last six months, ahead of the proposed disinvestment. The IDBI stock has been ruling at about twice the levels of other mid-cap private sector banks. This market distortion needs to be recognised by the committee advising on reserve price for the disinvestment. If the stock price and market capitalisation were to be factored into the reserve price, it would be much higher than the fundamental value of the bank.

Advisers to the IDBI Bank disinvestment could have considered offering a higher stake to the strategic buyer. Offering 60.72 per cent stake, with the Union Government continuing to hold 15 per cent and the LIC 19 per cent, may not have been acceptable to the buyer, who may have been worried about undue interference in operations. The Centre and LIC can consider offloading their entire stake in IDBI Bank, as was done in some earlier strategic disinvestments two decades ago. This gives the buyer greater visibility on managing the business.

Alternatively, if the Centre is loathe to let go of control, it may be a good idea to divest partial stake through the offer for sale route. With the public shareholders holding only 4.6 per cent stake, the floating stock is quite small, leading to distortion in pricing of the IDBI stock. Increase in the floating stock can help improve price discovery and prevent stock price manipulation by speculators, which can aid pricing of future strategic sales. Broadly speaking, disinvestment should be seen as a structural reform exercise, and not a mere Budget entry to plug the fiscal deficit.

## POCKET

RAVIKANTH


# Lessons from China's AI plans

**DIGITAL EXCHANGES.** New marketplaces for datasets could give China a headstart. India can organise datasets differently

NISHANT SAHDEV

While Washington debates how artificial intelligence may influence the next phase of warfare, and New Delhi focuses on attracting global technology investment, Beijing is building that may sound almost dull: data exchanges.

In cities such as Shanghai and Shenzhen, marketplaces are growing where companies, universities and government agencies can buy and sell datasets. Industrial production records, logistics flows, medical images and transport patterns are all becoming tradable assets. Though officials describe these platforms as part of China's digital economy strategy. Analysts estimate that the country's data economy could exceed $1 trillion before the end of the decade.

On the surface, it looks bureaucratic — the sort of institutional machinery China often creates when it wants to organise a sector at scale. But look closer and the logic begins to reveal itself. China appears to be building the infrastructure to treat data as a national resource for machine intelligence. Over the past two years, more than 20 government-backed data exchanges have opened across Chinese cities. The Shanghai Data Exchange alone lists hundreds of tradable datasets, ranging from logistics flows and industrial production records to medical imaging and urban transport patterns.

And this is where much of the global conversation about artificial intelligence begins in the wrong place.

**3 AI INGREDIENTS**

Behind every impressive AI system sit three basic ingredients: advanced chips, specialised talent and vast quantities of structured data. Remove any one of these and the system weakens. Right now, the US dominates the first two.

American companies design the processors that power modern AI systems. Silicon Valley still attracts much of the world's top AI talent and investment. Washington has also begun to defend that position aggressively. In recent years the US government has imposed export controls on advanced semiconductor technologies, restricting China's access to some of the most powerful AI chips.

China, however, seems to be pursuing a different advantage. The country

**TRADING DATA.** Beijing is experimenting with marketplaces where datasets can be standardised and traded GETTY IMAGES

produces roughly 30 per cent of global manufacturing output, more than the US, Japan and Germany combined. Its digital platforms process extraordinary volumes of commercial activity.

Every transaction produces information — about consumer behaviour, supply chains, pricing and logistics. AI thrives on exactly this kind of data.

Machine-learning systems learn by detecting patterns across enormous datasets. The richer the data, the smarter the system becomes. Yet in most countries, this information remains scattered. It gets limited inside databases only.

China's emerging data exchanges are an attempt to change that. Instead of letting information remain fragmented, Beijing is experimenting with marketplaces where datasets can be standardised and traded. Companies can monetise data products. Researchers can access information for machine-learning projects. Government agencies can verify and catalogue data before it enters the exchange.

**Unlike China's centralised system, India must design ways for data to move across sectors while preserving privacy, consent and democratic accountability.**

China is trying to turn the everyday information generated by its economy into training material for artificial intelligence. China appears to be asking a different question: what happens if an entire economy becomes a training environment for AI? History suggests that this kind of systems thinking often matters more than individual inventions.

The decisive advantage may not lie with the country that produces the smartest algorithm. It may lie with the country that builds the largest ecosystem capable of absorbing and learning from intelligent machines.

From that perspective, China's data exchanges start to look less like administrative tools and more like infrastructure for intelligence.

The US continues to dominate frontier research and semiconductor design. China is exploring ways to convert its industrial scale and digital activity into a continuous learning resource for AI systems.

Both approaches reflect the same underlying recognition: artificial intelligence is no longer just a technology sector. It is becoming part of the architecture of national power.

**INDIA'S CHALLENGES**

For India, the more interesting question is not whether the country has enough data for artificial intelligence. It almost certainly does. India has become one of the largest generators of digital activity in the world, as the experience with Aadhaar and UPI payments proves.

These systems generate something unusual: a constantly updating digital record of how a billion-person economy actually behaves.

Many advanced digital economies are built around private data ecosystems. In the US, vast amounts of behavioural data sit inside large technology firms such as Google, Amazon and Meta. In Europe, strong privacy frameworks like the GDPR protect citizens but also make large-scale data sharing across institutions slow and complicated.

China, by contrast, has moved toward a more centralised model, experimenting with government-backed data exchanges that allow datasets to be standardised and traded across industries.

India sits somewhere between these models. Rather than relying purely on corporations or centralised state systems, India built much of its digital foundation as public infrastructure. Aadhaar provides identity, UPI enables real-time payments, and the broader India Stack allows banks, start-ups and government services to operate on shared digital rails.

In effect, India has created something resembling a national digital nervous system. Every digital payment, subsidy transfer, logistics transaction or online service leaves behind structured information about economic activity.

Yet much of this information still remains locked inside institutional silos. Banks hold financial transaction histories. Hospitals store medical records. Telecom firms manage communication data. Government databases track agriculture, welfare and infrastructure systems.

Very little of this data circulates in ways that allow artificial intelligence systems to learn from it.

This is India's real AI challenge. Not producing data, but organising it intelligently.

Unlike China's centralised system, India must design ways for data to move across sectors while preserving privacy, consent and democratic accountability. If it succeeds, the result could be something rare: a trusted data ecosystem where public infrastructure allows innovation without concentrating power entirely in either the state or large corporations.

Artificial intelligence ultimately learns from how societies organise their information. The countries that solve that institutional puzzle most effectively will build the technological landscape of the 21st century.

The writer is a Physicist at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, US

# India must aim to become a global aviation hub

The present war opens up an opportunity for India to model its airports and airlines along the lines of Dubai and Singapore

Jitamitra Desai

India, as the world's third-largest domestic aviation market and projected to become the third largest globally by 2030, the potential for growth is immense.

Yet much of the value generated by Indian passenger traffic bypasses the national economy, flowing instead into the sophisticated ecosystems of Dubai (DXB), Singapore (SIN), and Doha (DOH). Every year, millions of Indian travellers detour through these cities, enriching their airlines, MRO facilities, fuelling stations, and retail sectors.

Given the current geopolitical trends in the Middle East, the time is ripe for Indian aviation firms to swiftly occupy this space and transform India into a global aviation hub.

The highly successful models of Emirates Airlines/DXB and Singapore Airlines/SIN represent a holistic strategy that "integrates the airport with a strong anchor airline", driven by competitive policies, world-class infrastructure, and government-backed economics. In both Dubai and Singapore, aviation is seen as a strategic growth lever.

It begins with these hubs boasting infrastructure designed for seamless, high-volume transit. DXB and SIN are engineered for minimal connection times, with immigration (typically a bottleneck in most airports) being mostly automated, smooth in-transit security checks, and baggage handling that enables quick international-to-international transfers, all of which are cornerstones of the "hub-and-spoke" model.

A dominant "home/anchor carrier" is crucial for feeding any hub-and-spoke system. Singapore Airlines and Emirates Airlines operate extensive wide-body fleets, linking global cities to their "hubs" and then distributing passengers to smaller "spoke" destinations. They also invest heavily in MRO facilities and aircraft financing onshore, keeping the value within their respective ecosystems.

**TAX INCENTIVES**

In terms of costs, Dubai treats aviation turbine fuel (ATF) as a zero-tax export input, while Singapore exempts it from value-added tax (VAT), thereby directly linking prices to international benchmarks and significantly reducing operating costs. Another example is DXB that benefits from not having any "night-flying" restrictions, allowing Emirates Airlines to achieve industry-leading aircraft utilization rates.

To facilitate transfers from flights across the globe, Singapore has signed over 80 "open sky" agreements, allowing unlimited flights and fifth-freedom

**AVIATION.** Flying high

rights, thereby increasing connectivity dominated by Singapore Airlines. This aviation strategy is also seamlessly integrated with national tourism and trade goals. Changi Airport's "Jewel" complex and Dubai's transit tours exemplify this market model.

The combinations of Singapore Airlines (controlling stake owned by Temasek Holdings) and Changi Airport Group (wholly controlled by the Singapore Government) as well as Emirates Airlines and Dubai Airport (owned entirely by the Investment Corporation of Dubai) are essentially state-owned entities. However, with India adopting the public-private partnership (PPP) model for its large metropolitan airports, a state-owned entity mechanism is not viable and therefore this hub airport-anchor airline combination can only be implemented by a private operator who owns either an airport or an airline.

The largest private firms operating in the aviation space in India are Adani Airports Holding Ltd (which controls eight airports in India, with the largest being Mumbai airport), GMR Group (which controls six airports in India and two internationally, with the largest being New Delhi airport), InterGlobe Aviation that owns IndiGo airlines (65 per cent domestic market share) and the Tata Sons that controls Air India (25 per cent domestic market share). If India aspires to be a global transit hub in the near future, the mantle of execution rests on one of these four companies.

Adopting this hub airport - full-service carrier airline synergistic model through a consortium of private firms is a strategic imperative, a path to transforming India from a major origin-destination (O-D) market into a global transit destination via a hub-and-spoke model, capturing significant economic dividends and strengthening global connectivity. A strong aviation hub along with an anchor carrier also strengthens India's geopolitical influence and "soft power", providing resilient connectivity and reliable cargo services crucial for trade and supply chains.

The writer is Professor, IIMB Chair of Excellence and Professor of Decision Sciences at IIM Bangalore

## LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

### Pro-flyer moves

Apropos, the Editorial 'Plane truths', (March 24), the DGCA's recent directives are a decisive step toward protecting passenger rights.

In a near-duopoly by IndiGo and Air India regulatory intervention becomes essential.

Seat selection, once limited to premium rows, had expanded to cover nearly 85-95 per cent of seats, imposing unfair costs on travellers. With about 500,000 domestic passengers flying daily, this move offers tangible relief while reinforcing airline accountability in delays, cancellations, and denied boarding.

**N Sadhasiva Reddy**
Bengaluru

### Institutional credibility

With reference to the news item 'SEBI board clears tighter conflict code, FPI fund netting" (March 24), the slew of internal compliance reforms of the team adopted by the regulator, obliterates the policy shortcomings emanated earlier in some suspected quid pro quo transactions involving the top management and re-establishes the credibility. While the new investment restrictions involving the spouses and dependent family members of employees may pose some legal challenges, the periodical disclosures and recusals imposed in potential conflicts, would help people handling the sensitive matters.

It would be prudent, if the new ethics and code, extensively covers disclosure norms of any moral turpitude, malfeasance in previous employment, pending taxation compliances, violation of public policy norms, accountability and the penal actions for mis-representation and non-compliances etc. of the top management, to retain the public trust in the institution.

**Sitaram Popuri**
Bengaluru

### Yuan's tactical benefits

Ram Singh's analysis is careful to separate signal from system, which is precisely the distinction most commentary on this subject misses. The petroyuan is not a rival reserve currency — it lacks the institutional depth, capital account openness, and legal framework that would make it one. But as a tactical instrument for sanctions evasion and corridor-specific settlements, it is already functional and growing.

For India deepening rupee-based trade arrangements, expanding currency swap agreements, and building cross-border payment infrastructure are necessary adjustments to a financial landscape that is already shifting.

Excessive dependence on China's state-managed financial ecosystem, however, would simply replace one vulnerability with another.

**M Barathi**
Bengaluru

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# PSUs and insolvency

## Some invoke 'sovereign' function to bypass IBC

Pramod Srihari

**NO CLARITY.** On what is sovereign function under IBC ISTOCK

The recent admission of insolvency proceedings against Cauvery Neeravari Nigam Limited (CNNL) by the NCLT has brought back the discussion of insolvency of public sector enterprises (PSEs). While the order was immediately stayed by the High Court of Karnataka and subsequently by the NCLAT, Chennai, it has reopened a larger institutional question — can state-owned enterprises invoke sovereign character to insulate themselves from a statute that is otherwise ownership-neutral? Can fiscal imprudence within PSEs can be shielded under the disguise of "sovereign functions," leaving contractors, vendors and lenders exposed to prolonged uncertainty.

The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code 2016 (IBC) provides an option for re-hauling before destruction. There appears to be a recurring effort by certain PSEs to resist this by positioning themselves within the protective boundary of sovereign function.

**NATURE OF ENTITY**

The issue surfaced prominently in *Hindustan Construction Company Limited v. Union of India*, where the Supreme Court observed that the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), being an extended limb of the government functioning as a statutory body, could neither be operated by a resolution professional under the IBC nor be subjected to liquidation. The reasoning was rooted in the nature of the entity and the essential public functions it discharged.

It rests on the proposition that the IBC was conceived as a resolution framework and not a debt recovery tool, and therefore non-payment by a government enterprise, when linked to discharge of sovereign or public obligations, ought not to trigger insolvency consequences that may disrupt those functions.

The Code does not distinguish between private companies and government companies at the stage of admission, nor does it confer superlative discretion upon tribunals to carve out exemptions based on ownership or functional character.The 16th Finance Commission Report for 2026-31 paints a sobering picture of the financial health of State and Central PSEs. Nearly half of the SPSEs — 541 out of 1,107 — are either loss-making or report zero net profits, with a significant number remaining non-operational. During 2022-23, aggregate losses across SPEs amounted to ₹1.14 lakh crore.

Loss-making CPSEs recorded annual losses of ₹51,419 crore in the same period. In the electricity distribution segment alone, outstanding debt has reached ₹7.08 lakh crore in 2023-24. The report also suggests that Cabinet takes cognisance of enterprises incurring losses in three out of four consecutive years and consider closure, privatisation or continuation of them. It is also in the interest of the government to monetise the assets or to choose IBC as a route to provide closure of loss making or non-operational PSEs.

NCLT, born out of Companies Act 2013, has ostensibly been converted into a tribunal to adjudicate matters relating to insolvency. Whether it is constitutionally structured to conduct an expensive inquiry into the sovereign character of governmental functions so as to balance public law considerations against creditor rights requires further clarity. The High Courts in such circumstances become a natural forum to examine sovereign function claims, but the result is a fragmentation of the insolvency timeline that the Code was intended to compress.

A substantial proportion of PSEs operate in sectors that are sensitive and closely linked to public interest — irrigation, electricity distribution, transport infrastructure and other essential services. The insolvency framework now requires clarity and fine balance, ensuring that PSEs facing insolvency risk exercise financial prudence and contractual compliance, and clarity on what constitutes sovereign function under IBC. Clarity in this area will shape not only the future of distressed PSEs but also the balance between public purpose and commercial discipline.

*The writer is a chartered accountant and insolvency professional*

# THE WIDER ANGLE.

PARAN BALAKRISHNAN

# The world's most unlikely peacemaker

Amid missile strikes and drone attacks, Pakistan's Field Marshal Asim Munir offers himself as negotiator in Middle East talks

REUTERS

It's difficult to imagine a more unlikely peacemaker emerging to halt the barrage of missiles and drones streaking across the Middle East skies. Step forward Pakistan army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir. Fresh from fighting the Four-Day War with India last May and now overseeing strikes in Kabul and Kandahar, he now sees himself as the man of the moment who could broker peace between two deadly rivals, Israel and Iran.

Munir isn't the only would-be mediator hoping to end the fighting. Egypt and Turkey have also signalled interest, while the usual candidates like Qatar and Oman are sidelined, drawn into the frontlines of the conflict themselves. Could India have offered its services? Possibly, but Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Israel just before the war erupted may have ruled New Delhi out of this particular peacemaking game.

Negotiating peace between Israel, the US, and Iran is a particularly tricky business. Former President Donald Trump tore up the last nuclear agreement struck by President Barack Obama with Iran. Understandably, Tehran now seeks cast-iron guarantees that any new deal will be honoured and Iran won't be attacked again. Meanwhile, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu wants nothing less than Iran's destruction, envisioning a fractured state resembling Libya, where rival factions battle in perpetual chaos.

Will Netanyahu try to scuttle peace efforts? Sadly, that scenario seems all too likely. It's almost certain Netanyahu convinced Trump bombing Iran was essential, even though the US president had insisted Washington had eliminated Iran's nuclear-bomb-making capacity last year. Netanyahu knows that the hour is now and he's unlikely to be able to persuade Trump or any other US president to bring out the B2 bombers again. Iran, for its part, remains a tough customer, isolated regionally and unwilling to compromise. Even as diplomatic efforts gain momentum, Iranian missiles continue to strike Israel, one landing in a bustling Tel Aviv street, a stark reminder for Israelis of the stakes at play.

Can Munir serve as an effective interlocutor between such implacable foes? The task seems almost impossible. Yet Munir has proven he should not be underestimated, even if India remains wary. Questions abound about how he secured a White House lunch with Trump. Was it through promoting cryptocurrency and leveraging ties to Zachary Witkoff, whose father, Steve Witkoff, acts as Trump's chief negotiator with Iran, Israel, and Russia? Munir has also bolstered Pakistan's regional position through a defence pact with Saudi Arabia and diplomatic talks led by Foreign Minister Ishaq Dhar with other Islamic nations in Riyadh.

Pakistan's relations with Iran have fluctuated. In January 2024, missile strikes followed attacks by the extremist group Jaish al-Adl on Iranian territory. Yet the row appears to have been smoothed over, with Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif speaking recently with his Iranian counterpart.

> **Can Munir serve as an effective interlocutor between such implacable foes?** The task seems almost impossible. Yet Munir has proven he should not be underestimated

**ROOTS OF THE CONFLICT**

The roots of this Middle East conflict stretch back decades. Israel's long-standing security concerns revolve around Iran's nuclear ambitions and its support for Hezbollah in Lebanon and militias in Syria. Tehran, in turn, views Israel as an existential threat. The Persian Gulf, crucial for crude oil transportation, has become a flashpoint, with drone and missile attacks threatening shipping lanes and sending oil prices surging.

Complicating matters further, *The New York Times* reports that while Trump may be keen to wind down military action, Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman has been urging Trump to press on with the fight against Iran, arguing that destroying Tehran's hard-line government is vital to remove a long-term threat to Gulf security.

Looking back six decades to the Cuban Missile Crisis of 1962, the world teetered on the brink as Soviet ships approached Cuba carrying nuclear missiles. The crucial difference then was the presence of steady-handed, rational actors: Nikita Khrushchev and John F Kennedy. Today, US leadership under Trump is wildly erratic, Netanyahu is pursuing the near-impossible goal of dismantling Iran, and the US and Israel have killed many of Iran's top leaders, leaving everyone unsure who calls the shots. Even Trump now seems to recognise Iran, population 93 million, isn't a state like Venezuela, population 29 million, where a single leader could be captured quickly.

Amid all these contradictions, global financial markets are on a daily roller-coaster.

In the end, whether Munir or any other mediator can navigate this labyrinth of mistrust, ambition, and regional tension remains to be seen. The stakes are enormous, and the players are unpredictable, but one truth stands clear: in a region where old grudges run deep and miscalculations could mean catastrophe, the world will be watching every move closely and hoping that reason, however improbable, can still prevail.

# STATISTALK.

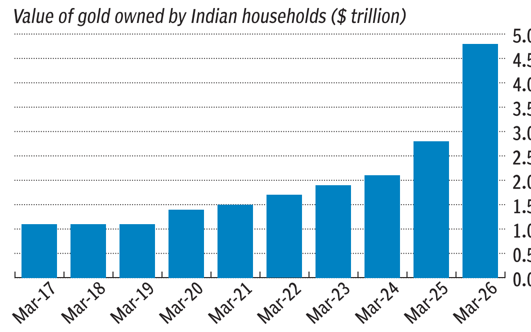
Compiled by **Dhuraivel Gunasekaran** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

## Gold rally lifts household wealth to new highs

Indian household gold holdings have surged to nearly $5 trillion, propelled by a sharp rise in prices, a Kotak report shows. Gold has emerged as a dominant non-property asset class for households, outpacing the growth of equities and deposits. Households earning below ₹5 lakh hold nearly 70% of India's gold stock. Despite the recent surge in gold loan portfolios, such loans account for only about 5% of total lending, reflecting gold's underutilisation as a productive financial asset. India's net imports of gold and precious stones over the past 16 years are 2.5 times cumulative FPI inflows. This massive external outflow poses persistent macroeconomic and liquidity challenges. Key facts:

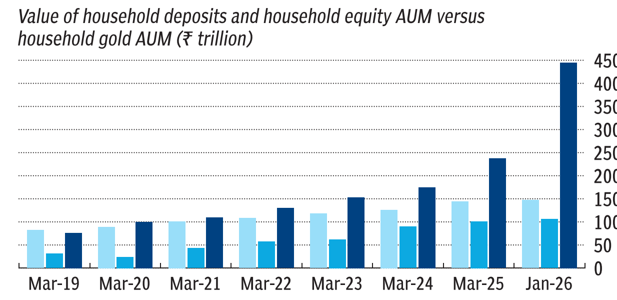
### Indian household gold stock surges to $5 trillion

*Value of gold owned by Indian households ($ trillion)*



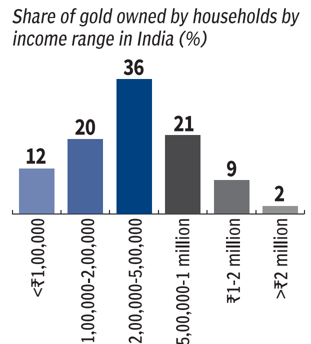

### Gold dominates household financial mix

*Value of household deposits and household equity AUM versus household gold AUM (₹ trillion)*



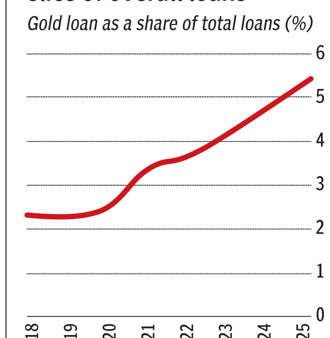

### Low-income households hold bulk of gold

*Share of gold owned by households by income range in India (%)*




### Gold loans remain a small slice of overall loans

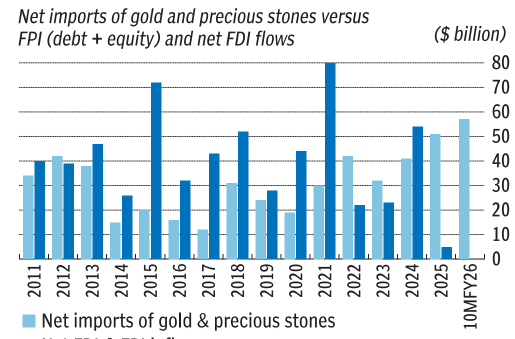
*Gold loan as a share of total loans (%)*




### Gold imports swallow 85% of foreign capital inflows

*Net imports of gold and precious stones versus FPI (debt + equity) and net FDI flows*

($ billion)




Source: Kotak Institutional Equities

## On businessline.in

### The planet's water ledger in deficit

Large parts of the world are facing 'water bankruptcy'. This calls for a re-examination of water rights, subsidies, pricing mechanisms and land-use practices, says **Priyanka Vadrevu**

https://tinyurl.com/2w9pnwyz

### Navigating India's looming water scarcity

While making rainwater harvesting mandatory for all households, the government must prioritise the restoration of traditional water bodies to increase storage and recharge aquifers, suggests **A Narayanamoorthy**

https://tinyurl.com/ku4wa8s4

### Problems in cross-selling by banks

Bank staff seldom explain satisfactorily the complex features of non-bank products like insurance and mutual funds to potential buyers, says **Manas R Das**

https://tinyurl.com/ke8t9hux

# thehindu businessline.

## TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

March 25, 2006

**HCL wins ₹804-cr case**

In a significant ruling in favour of Shiv Nadar-owned HCL Corporation, the Income-Tax Appellate Tribunal (ITAT) has set aside the ₹804-crore demand raised by the Income-Tax Department in a dispute relating to capital gains computation on sale of shares. HCL Corporation confirmed that its appeal before the ITAT has now been decided in its favour and termed the Tribunal's order as a vindication of its stand.

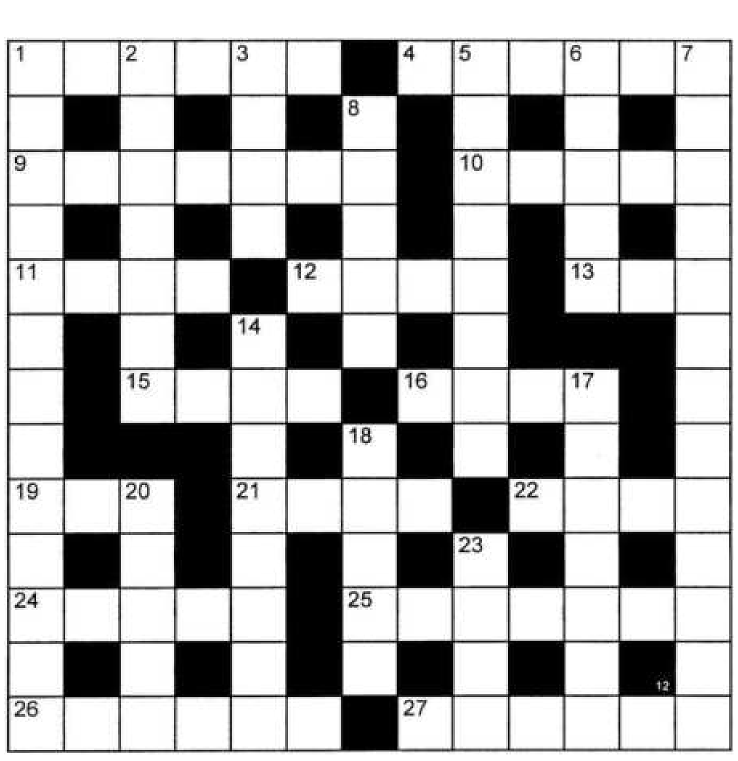
**4 in race for coal PF assets management**

The Coal Mines Provident Fund Organisation (CMPFO) is considering a bid by US-based Templeton to manage its assets. CMPFO's assets had a face value of ₹37,300.27 crore as of January this year. Apart from Templeton, three domestic fund managers too are in the race, namely HDFC, ICICI and the present fund manager IDBI.

**Jet to pay Sahara ₹500 cr advance**

Jet Airways has agreed to pay an advance of ₹500 crore to Air Sahara as part-payment for buying out the latter, thereby, putting at rest speculation that the deal had run into rough weather.

# BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2643



## EASY

**ACROSS**

1. Agricultural implement (6)
4. Beat soundly (6)
9. Edible crustacean (7)
10. Wretched dwelling (5)
11. Put to sea (4)
12. Leg joint (4)
13. Resin produced by coccid insects (3)
15. Call a greeting (4)
16. Record (4)
19. Chest bone (3)
21. Money-drawer (4)
22. Fragrant healing ointment (4)
24. Exact likeness (5)
25. Continue steadfastly (7)
26. State of undress (6)
27. Fevered (6)

**DOWN**

1. Old ten-shilling coin (4-9)
2. Trash (7)
3. Swear-word (4)
5. Vigorous, sporting (8)
6. Flat, smooth (5)
7. Many-coloured (13)
8. Lifting machine (5)
14. To treat ill (8)
17. A god's car (7)
18. Scions, cuttings (5)
20. Trademark (5)
23. Constant, faithful (4)

## NOT SO EASY

**ACROSS**

1. Where boys may learn to distress one (6)
4. How soundly one can thrash the beer (6)
9. It could bolster the former British soldier (7)
10. Poor place to live came in sight at top of lane (5)
11. Part of a windmill one can get through effortlessly (4)
12. King, born a woman, may have been bent (4)
13. There's almost a shortage of dark red resin (3)
15. It may come down hard on one to call from a distance (4)
16. Sort of break, one is told, the record (4)
19. Spare a bone for the wife (3)
21. Work the land and put one's money in it (4)
22. Lamb could have written something soothing (4)
24. Picture of a gem one could make up (5)
25. Persevere in handing out the stripes (7)
26. The raw state achieved in duty perhaps (6)
27. Feverish way he got critic to leave the right one out (6)

**DOWN**

1. Old coin - KI or NG? (4-9)
2. Criticise one for being trumpery (7)
3. Bit of bad language on which one's bound to speak true (4)
5. Strong and vigorous, he lit out with cat maybe (8)
6. It's flat either way up (5)
7. With many colours, it's policy to march out of it (13)
8. Bird that may give one a lift (5)
14. Star given time out will handle it badly (8)
17. Horse-drawn vehicle 'H' spelled out - or a version of it (7)
18. Positions in the field are made in error (5)
20. Make one's mark as ringleader in the gang (5)
23. Faithful to nothing less, roué has nothing to lose (4)

## SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2642

**ACROSS** 1. Fast-days 7. Pride 8. Icicles 9. Manacle 10. Haul 12. Nuances 14. Abscond 17. Stir 18. Take-off 21. Furlong 22. Cling 23. Despised

**DOWN** 1. Fright 2. Stimulus 3. Dole 14. Yes-man 5. Disc 6. Revers 7. Pinnace 11. Prolong 13. Controls 114. Antics 15. Duffle 16. Frigid 19. Knit 20. Trip

CHENNAI
businessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25 - 2026

## QUICKLY.

### Tata AIA Life Insurance launches three ULIP funds


**Mumbai:** Tata AIA Life Insurance has opened subscriptions for three unit-linked funds — the Large Mid Cap Innovation Fund, Large Mid Cap Innovation Pension Fund and Global AI & Technology Leaders Fund — with the new fund offer running from March 24-31. Units will be issued at ₹10 for the two domestic funds and $10 for the global fund. The two domestic funds will invest in Indian large and mid-cap companies in innovation-driven sectors, with an equity allocation of 60 per cent to 100 per cent and the remainder in debt and money market instruments. Both are benchmarked against the NSE 500 Index. The pension variant is exclusively available through Tata AIA's unit-linked pension solutions, targeting policyholders building a retirement corpus. OUR BUREAU

### ICICI Pru Life launches Smallcap 250 ULIP Fund

**Mumbai:** ICICI Prudential Life Insurance has launched the ICICI Prudential Life Smallcap 250 Index Fund under its unit-linked insurance plans. The fund enables customers to participate in a broad basket of emerging listed companies and build wealth over the long-term through a disciplined, index-based approach. The fund tracks the Smallcap 250 Index, which represents 250 companies ranked 251st to 500th in the Nifty 500 universe. It provides exposure to an array of smaller listed businesses that are at an early stage of their growth journey and have the potential to scale over time. OUR BUREAU

# Sensex, Nifty post strong gains on Iran war pause, but remain volatile

**GOOD SHOW.** Sectoral and broad-based market-cap indices close the day sharply higher in relief rally

**Anupama Ghosh**
Mumbai

Benchmark indices staged a sharp relief rally on Tuesday, with the Nifty 50 surging 399.75 points to close at 22,912.40 and the BSE Sensex climbing 1,372.06 points to settle at 74,068.45, a day after one of the market's most punishing sell-offs in recent memory.

The catalyst was US President Donald Trump's announcement of a five-day pause on strikes targeting Iranian energy infrastructure, which triggered a swift unwinding of geopolitical risk premiums across global markets. Crude oil prices fell more than 11 per cent following the announcement, providing immediate relief to import-dependent economies like India. However, the recovery remained fragile. Iran denied any negotiations were underway, and fresh strikes were reported across Gulf regions, keeping the energy markets on edge. Brent crude subsequently rebounded around 2.4 per cent.

The session was volatile, with Nifty swinging between 22,624.20 and 23,057.30.

Bank Nifty closed at 52,605, up 2.27 per cent, but also failed to hold above 52,900. The broader market outperformed the benchmarks. Nifty Midcap 100 and Nifty Smallcap 100 each rose over 2.6 per cent and market breadth turned decisively positive, with 2,968 advances against 1,295 declines on BSE. Sectorally, the rally was broad-based with all indices closing in the green. Nifty media, private banks and auto were the top sectoral gainers. IndiGo surged 5.5 per cent, L&T rose 5.2 per cent and Bajaj Finance gained 5.0 per cent. Coal India fell 3 per cent, while Power Grid and Adani Enterprises declined 1.4 per cent and 0.4 per cent, respectively.


**KEY TRIGGER.** US President Donald Trump's announcement of a five-day pause on strikes targeting Iranian energy infrastructure revived sentiment across counters

**WORD OF CAUTION**

As many as 456 within the Nifty 500 universe closed in positive territory. India VIX eased toward the 25 mark from near-27 levels seen in the prior session. Hariprasad K, Founder, Livelong Wealth, characterised the move as "a relief bounce rather than a confirmed trend reversal," cautioning that "conviction at higher levels is still limited" unless backed by stronger triggers.

Looking ahead, Vishal Goraddia, Fund Manager at Aikyam Capital Group, cautioned that "this should be seen as a reprieve rather than a structural shift," adding that "softer oil prices and improving risk appetite create a supportive near-term window for India, but the underlying geopolitical situation remains fluid, and volatility is likely to persist".

# Manipal Health files IPO papers to raise ₹8,000 crore

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

**Issue consists of OFS of 4.32 crore shares by promoters and existing investors**

Temasek-backed Manipal Health Enterprises Ltd has filed its draft red herring prospectus with SEBI, setting the stage for what is expected to be one of the marquee healthcare listings of the year.

The IPO comprises a fresh issue of ₹8,000 crore and an offer for sale of up to 4.32 crore shares by promoters, Imperius Healthcare Investments Pte Ltd and Manipal Education and Medical Group India Pvt Ltd, and existing investors including TPG and Novo Holdings.

The company has also indicated it may undertake a pre-IPO placement of ₹1,600 crore which, if completed, would proportionally reduce the size of the fresh issue.

**USE OF FUNDS**

The proceeds from the fresh issue will be primarily deployed towards repayment of outstanding borrowings of its material subsidiary, Manipal Hospitals Private Ltd (₹5,378 crore), acquisition of a minority stake in step-down subsidiary Sahyadri Hospitals Private Ltd (₹574 crore) and for general corporate purposes.

Manipal Health operates a pan-India network of 38 hospitals, 48 on a pro forma basis, spanning 14 States and Union Territories as of September 2025.

Kotak Mahindra Capital, Axis Capital, Goldman Sachs, Jefferies, JP Morgan, UBS and DBS Bank are the book-running lead managers, while KFin Technologies is the registrar of the offer.

# GSP Crop Science ends 11% higher at ₹356.10 on listing day

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Shares of GSP Crop Science Ltd extended the listing gains to settle 11.28 per cent higher at ₹356.10 on the BSE over the issue price of ₹320. On the NSE, the stock closed at ₹356.25.

The stock debuted at ₹332.30 on the BSE, a premium of 3.8 per cent and at ₹328 on the National Stock Exchange, up 2.5 per cent. Buying interest intensified as the session progressed, pushing the stock 14 per cent higher to hit an intra-day high of ₹364.


**ON FERTILE GROUND.** The management team of GSP Crop Science at the listing ceremony in Ahmedabad. The stock remained resilient through out the day

The ₹400 crore IPO (₹240 crore fresh issue and ₹160 crore offer-for-sale) of the agrochemical firm was subscribed 1.61 times. The price band for the issue was ₹304-320. Ahead of the IPO, it raised ₹120 crore from anchor investors. Proceeds from the fresh issue, amounting to ₹170 crore, will be used for debt repayment and the rest for general corporate purposes.

# Central Mine IPO sails through only on QIB support

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

The initial public offering of Central Mine Planning and Design Institute sailed through, fetching 1.05 times overall demand, thanks to institutional investors. Only the qualified institutional buyers segment was subscribed by 3.48 times, while the quota for non-institutional investors (0.35 time) and retail investors (0.33 time) was under-subscribed. Even the employee (0.21 time) and shareholder categories (0.36 time) saw lukewarm response. The ₹1,842-crore IPO was priced at ₹163-172 a share.

# Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust units up 7% on Day 1 over IPO price of ₹100

**Press Trust of India**
New Delhi

The State-owned National Highways Authority of India-sponsored Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust units ended nearly 7 per cent higher in debut trading on Tuesday.

The unit started trading at ₹108, up 8 per cent from the issue price of ₹100 on the BSE. It later ended at ₹106.83, registering a jump of 6.83 per cent.

At the NSE, it jumped 7 per cent after starting the trade at ₹107. The unit later ended at ₹106.88, up 6.88 per cent. The company's market valuation stood at ₹6,409.80 crore.


**STRONG FOUNDATION.** Nitin Gadkari, Minister of Road Transport & Highways, at the listing of Raajmarg InvIT, sponsored by NHAI. The units closed at ₹106.83 on the BSE

The initial public offering of Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust was subscribed 13.74 times on March 13.

The ₹6,000-crore IPO had a price band of ₹99-100 per unit.

# SEBI's conflict code reform pragmatic, but transparency concerns linger

**Akshata Gorde**
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India's revised conflict-of-interest framework is being seen as a pragmatic attempt to tighten internal governance, though legal experts have raised concerns around limited public disclosures, reliance on recusal mechanisms and gaps in enforceability.

The framework brings the chairman and whole-time members (WTMs) under insider trading norms, aligns the definition of "family" and extends investment restrictions to spouses and dependents. "Bringing the chairman and WTM under the insider definition and extending restrictions to spouses and dependents was overdue," said Hardeep Sachdeva, Senior Partner, AZB & Partners.

**KEY CONCERNS**

However, the board's decision to keep detailed disclosures of assets and liabilities internal, while limiting public disclosure to immovable property, has emerged as a key concern.

"Limiting public disclosure to immovable property follows civil services practice, but SEBI's role is materially different... Financial assets and market-linked instruments are far more relevant from a conflict-of-interest standpoint than im-


movable property," Pranav Bhaskar, Senior Partner, SKV Law Offices said, adding that internal disclosure does not meaningfully enhance external accountability or public confidence.

Akshaya Bhansali, Managing Partner, Mindspright Legal, said, "There is no harm in being transparent and prevent a situation being questioned." Disclosure requirements should ideally extend across all officials performing such functions, she added.

"Given the heightened expectations from a market regulator, there is merit in exploring whether a slightly broader, yet carefully structured, public disclosure framework could further enhance confidence without compromising personal security or confidentiality," said Tushar Kumar, advocate, Supreme Court of India.

Another key theme is the framework's reliance on recusal mechanisms alongside investment restrictions. "The framework leans heavily on recusal mechanisms rather than outright investment bans, which are workable only if backed by a robust digital ethics infrastructure and vigilant oversight," Sachdeva said, adding that recusals have not worked the best internationally as well.

There are also potential gaps around indirect holdings, particularly through pooled or offshore investment routes.

"The challenge lies in monitoring informal influence, side arrangements or expectations that are difficult to document... where ongoing supervision and periodic audits will matter more than formal rule design," Bhaskar said.

While such investments are typically treated as arm's length, the evolving sophistication of financial products does warrant continued vigilance, Kumar said.

The decision to adopt parts of the framework voluntarily rather than codify them into binding regulations has also drawn criticism. Bhansali said this was a "missed opportunity" to address concerns around enforceability, adding that the earlier code's lack of legal backing had been flagged by the high-level committee itself.

Overall, while the framework is seen as progressive in design and implementable, experts said its credibility will hinge on how SEBI addresses transparency concerns, strengthens oversight of recusals and monitors indirect exposures over time.

# MSE appoints market makers for equity segment from April

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

The Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India (MSE) has appointed market makers for its equity segment from April 1. The move is aimed at strengthening market depth, supporting efficient price discovery and enhancing the overall trading experience. Market makers will provide continuous buy and sell quotes for 130 stocks.

An LES is a framework deployed by exchanges and regulated by SEBI to increase trading volumes in securities that are otherwise difficult to buy or sell quickly.

MSE will initiate liquidity enhancement measures as part of its efforts to deepen market participation and create a vibrant trading ecosystem. The steps reflect MSE's commitment to foster a transparent, efficient and competitive marketplace for all stakeholders, the exchange said. In 2025, the MSE raised ₹1,000 crore through a private placement to Peak XV Partners, Jainam Broking, Monarch Networth and Trust Investment Advisors. In 2024, it raised ₹240 crore from Rainmatter (Zerodha), Billionbrains (Groww) and Share India Securities through a rights issue. The NSE holds about 90-92 per cent market share in the equity cash trading segment, while the BSE commands 8-10 per cent share.

## BROKER'S CALL.

### Avendus Spark

**DR AGARWAL'S HEALTH (BUY)**
Target: ₹495
CMP: ₹417.65

Founded in 1957 in Chennai as a standalone eye hospital, Dr Agarwal's Health Care (DAHL) has evolved into the largest integrated pan-India eye care network, managed by the third-generation doctor-promoter family. The company operates 272 facilities (253 in India, 19 in Africa) with an estimated about 25 per cent market share among organised eye care chains in India. DAHL offers a full spectrum of ophthalmic services, with surgeries contributing about 67 per cent of revenue, followed by diagnostics and consultations (around 12 per cent) & optical and pharma products (around 21 per cent). DAHL delivered a 32 per cent revenue CAGR in FY22-26E, driven by aggressive network expansion (about 105 surgical center additions since April 2021 including 50 acquired facilities).
We believe DAHL's leadership position, scalable hub-and-spoke model, and premiumization-led growth underpin its structurally strong operating model. Supported by network expansion and consolidation in a fragmented market, DAHL is well-positioned to sustain industry-leading growth and improve return ratios. Factoring in equity dilution (5 per cent) from issuance of about 1.5 crore shares in DAHL for minority holders in AEHL (currently around 73 per cent owned subsidiary), we estimate EPS CAGR of 42 per cent in FY26-28E and RoCE improvement to 13 per cent in FY28E vs. 10 per cent in FY26E. We value the stock at 25x our FY28 pre-Ind AS EBITDA of ₹650 crore to arrive at a target price of ₹495;

### PL Capital

**PARADEEP PHOSPHATES (ACCUMULATE)**
Target: ₹120
CMP: ₹110.35

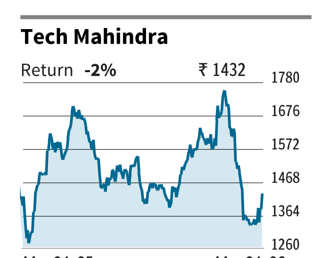
We initiate coverage on PPL with 'Accumulate' rating and TP of ₹120, based on 10x FY28E EPS. PPL is positioning itself to capitalise on the import substitution opportunity in India's chemicals sector, through backward integration, product mix optimisation and capacity expansion. It is expanding phosphoric and sulfuric acid capacity (+57 per cent and +100 per cent, respectively) and targets to achieve full backward integration by FY29. Further, it is shifting its portfolio toward high-value complex fertilizers, thus reducing reliance on DAP. PPL is expanding its fertilizer capacity to reach about 5.0 mmtpa by early FY29. Also, the MCFL merger will strengthen PPL's presence in South India. While elevated raw material prices may exert near-term margin pressure, we believe the company's integrated operations, expanding scale and merger synergies will drive sustained earnings growth over the medium term. We estimate revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of about 10/18/23 per cent over FY25–28E, driven by capacity additions, product mix improvement and integration benefits. At CMP, PPL trades at about 9x FY28E EPS and around 6x FY28E EV/EBITDA.
India's reliance on imports for phosphatic nutrients (49 per cent of DAP, 16 per cent in NPK), underscores import-substitution opportunity. With likely ramp-up in utilisation and volumes post-expansion, PPL will be able to capture the domestic supply gap in phosphatic and complex fertilizers and scale market share to 16 per cent from 12 per cent.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

## TODAY'S PICK.

### Tech Mahindra (₹1,432.90): BUY

**Gurumurthy K**
bl. research bureau




The short-term outlook is bullish for Tech Mahindra. The price action since the last week of February this year indicates a rounding bottom formation. The 3.5 per cent rise on Tuesday and the rise above ₹1,400, a key resistance, confirms that a bottom is in place.

Key supports are at ₹1,400 and ₹1,360. The chances are high for the stock to sustain above ₹1,400 itself. Tech Mahindra share price can rise to ₹1,520-₹1,530 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Tech Mahindra shares now at ₹1,433. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,405. Keep the stop-loss at ₹1,370 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹1,445 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,465. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,460 and ₹1,495 when the share price touches ₹1,485 and ₹1,510 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹1,520.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

## Day trading guide

**22976 » Nifty 50 Futures**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 22800 | 22650 | 23060 | 23220 | Go long on a break above 23060. Keep the stop-loss at 22980 |

**₹767 » HDFC Bank**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 759 | 750 | 774 | 787 | Go long only above 774. Stop-loss can be placed at 772 |

**₹1280 » Infosys**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1270 | 1250 | 1305 | 1330 | Go long on dips at 1275. Keep the stop-loss at 1265 |

**₹292 » ITC**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 290 | 288 | 293 | 296 | Take fresh longs above 293. Keep the stop-loss at 292 |

**₹269 » ONGC**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 265 | 263 | 273 | 276 | Wait for dips. Go long at 266 with a stop-loss at 264 |

**₹1414 » Reliance Ind.**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1400 | 1390 | 1430 | 1445 | Go long on dips at 1410 and 1405 with a stop-loss at 1395 |

**₹1038 » SBI**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1020 | 1000 | 1050 | 1070 | Take fresh shorts below 1020. Keep the stop-loss at 1025 |

**₹2401 » TCS**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2375 | 2350 | 2440 | 2480 | Go short on a break below 2375. Keep the stop-loss at 2385 |

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

## Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 399.75 pts.

| | Close(₹) | Pts | PE | Wt(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| HDFC Bank | 764.90 | 69.63 | 15.20 | 11.20 |
| L&T | 3516.80 | 44.93 | 25.49 | 3.95 |
| ICICI Bank | 1251.20 | 44.66 | 15.80 | 8.56 |
| Bajaj Finance | 849.00 | 21.20 | 28.83 | 2.16 |
| Eternal Ltd. | 237.94 | 17.31 | 994.03 | 1.64 |
| Kotak Bank | 366.85 | 16.62 | 19.41 | 2.58 |
| Infosys | 1278.30 | 16.52 | 18.51 | 4.29 |
| M&M | 3031.30 | 14.79 | 22.30 | 2.59 |
| Axis Bank | 1192.70 | 13.90 | 14.02 | 3.27 |
| UltraTech Cement | 10764.00 | 10.45 | 41.39 | 1.22 |
| IntGlobeAvi | 4150.80 | 10.19 | 49.98 | 0.90 |
| Asian Paints | 2217.30 | 9.52 | 54.39 | 0.96 |
| Shriram Finance Ltd. | 903.60 | 7.96 | 18.59 | 1.21 |
| Bharat Elec | 414.45 | 7.03 | 50.81 | 1.42 |
| Tech Mahindra | 1432.70 | 6.78 | 30.57 | 0.87 |
| Adani Ports | 1344.20 | 6.57 | 24.78 | 0.95 |
| Tata Steel | 190.79 | 6.56 | 26.11 | 1.51 |
| Hind Unilever | 2085.00 | 6.39 | 48.72 | 1.77 |
| Apollo Hosp | 7413.00 | 6.05 | 57.13 | 0.73 |
| Reliance Ind | 1411.80 | 5.92 | 19.54 | 9.13 |
| Eicher Motors | 6871.00 | 5.72 | 35.18 | 0.91 |
| JSW Steel | 1133.70 | 4.97 | 35.70 | 1.02 |
| Jio Financial Services Ltd. | 232.70 | 4.75 | 92.12 | 0.73 |
| Hindalco | 854.65 | 4.57 | 11.95 | 1.18 |
| TataConsumerProduct | 1053.10 | 4.21 | 70.82 | 0.66 |
| Titan | 3899.50 | 4.20 | 72.64 | 1.54 |
| Bharti Airtel | 1802.10 | 3.79 | 27.73 | 4.81 |
| Bajaj Finserv | 1704.40 | 3.63 | 14.18 | 0.93 |
| HCL Tech | 1373.30 | 3.40 | 22.63 | 1.39 |
| TCS | 2398.80 | 3.36 | 18.10 | 2.35 |
| NTPC | 375.55 | 3.28 | 14.67 | 1.70 |
| Maruti Suzuki | 12464.00 | 3.14 | 26.24 | 1.57 |
| Bajaj Auto | 8898.00 | 2.97 | 27.97 | 0.94 |
| Tata Motors PV | 311.20 | 2.73 | 42.32 | 0.62 |
| NestleIndia | 1183.20 | 2.58 | 69.95 | 0.81 |
| HDFC Life | 603.00 | 2.57 | 68.83 | 0.62 |
| ONGC | 268.05 | 2.22 | 7.50 | 1.00 |
| Max Healthcare | 969.20 | 2.01 | 66.43 | 0.69 |
| ITC | 291.25 | 1.69 | 17.62 | 2.69 |
| Grasim Ind | 2549.40 | 1.53 | 18.32 | 0.93 |
| Dr Reddys Lab | 1259.60 | 0.84 | 19.03 | 0.73 |
| Wipro | 188.74 | 0.75 | 14.85 | 0.52 |
| Trent Ltd. | 3365.60 | 0.43 | 73.86 | 0.71 |
| SBI Life | 1836.00 | 0.36 | 74.27 | 0.79 |
| Cipla | 1219.40 | -0.30 | 21.73 | 0.66 |
| Adani Enter | 1817.90 | -0.86 | 14.85 | 0.45 |
| State Bank | 1030.80 | -1.00 | 11.00 | 4.09 |
| Sun Pharma | 1753.30 | -1.18 | 38.41 | 1.78 |
| PowerGrid Corp | 299.00 | -3.08 | 17.91 | 1.30 |
| Coal India | 442.10 | -6.55 | 9.16 | 0.96 |

Pts: Impact on index movement

## Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 945.80 pts.

| | Close(₹) | Pts | PE | Wt(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bpcl | 282.25 | 63.68 | 4.98 | 2.63 |
| Samvardmothersoninternatl | 111.13 | 60.50 | 32.23 | 2.37 |
| Indian Hotels Co. . | 604.05 | 56.92 | 39.72 | 2.55 |
| Cholamandalamin&Fin | 1418.90 | 48.22 | 24.70 | 2.89 |
| Tvs Motor Cmp . | 3479.70 | 47.34 | 54.14 | 3.93 |
| United Spirits . | 1328.00 | 46.79 | 56.16 | 1.89 |
| Avenuesuper | 3756.50 | 44.58 | 85.35 | 2.66 |
| Canara Bank | 133.15 | 36.31 | 6.56 | 2.16 |
| Vedanta | 651.60 | 29.77 | 15.38 | 5.32 |
| Ltimindtree | 4211.50 | 29.46 | 26.43 | 1.88 |
| Adani Power . | 150.11 | 26.75 | 25.62 | 2.85 |
| Bank Of Baroda | 270.50 | 25.60 | 7.12 | 2.41 |
| Varun Beverages . | 388.35 | 25.25 | 42.89 | 2.56 |
| Bosch | 30080.00 | 24.60 | 32.18 | 1.26 |
| Shree Cement | 23325.00 | 24.07 | 46.86 | 1.50 |
| Bajaj Holdings | 9337.00 | 22.73 | 11.59 | 1.94 |
| Ambuja Cements | 407.55 | 22.32 | 20.47 | 1.20 |
| Adanigreenenergy | 839.55 | 21.24 | 74.51 | 1.24 |
| Adani Energy Solutions . | 967.30 | 21.23 | 48.75 | 1.61 |
| Zyduslifesciences | 886.40 | 19.37 | 17.75 | 1.07 |
| Abb India | 6162.00 | 18.96 | 77.43 | 1.55 |
| Gail (India) | 137.67 | 18.37 | 10.52 | 1.79 |
| Indian Railway Finance Corp | 92.87 | 18.33 | 17.32 | 0.80 |
| Punjab Natl Bank | 107.26 | 17.69 | 6.90 | 1.78 |
| Rural Elec | 320.80 | 16.30 | 4.90 | 1.93 |
| Jindal Steel | 1120.60 | 16.14 | 56.70 | 2.01 |
| Pidilitind | 1332.20 | 16.12 | 58.59 | 1.99 |
| Info Edge I | 987.40 | 14.80 | 38.00 | 1.85 |
| Torrent Pharma | 4256.60 | 13.40 | 63.41 | 2.14 |
| Lic | 758.70 | 12.45 | 9.05 | 0.81 |
| Hindus Zinc | 497.05 | 12.23 | 17.80 | 1.04 |
| Dlf | 521.00 | 12.03 | 29.12 | 1.61 |
| Hindustanaeronautics | 3654.00 | 11.04 | 27.47 | 3.34 |
| Mazagoan Dock | 2253.00 | 10.55 | 37.76 | 0.82 |
| Solar Industries | 12554.00 | 9.06 | 74.41 | 1.47 |
| Britannia Ind | 5513.50 | 8.32 | 54.96 | 3.13 |
| Indian Oilcorp | 138.70 | 6.61 | 5.31 | 2.49 |
| Cg Power & Ind Sol | 667.30 | 6.59 | 94.72 | 2.20 |
| Icici Lombard Gic | 1730.10 | 5.74 | 31.50 | 2.01 |
| Godrej Consumer | 1006.90 | 5.43 | 56.56 | 1.95 |
| Divis Lab | 6026.00 | 4.77 | 64.53 | 3.68 |
| Siemens | 3001.80 | 3.58 | 67.42 | 1.28 |
| Power Finance | 398.75 | 3.28 | 3.94 | 2.79 |
| Havells | 1234.20 | 2.42 | 52.21 | 1.50 |
| Jsw Energy . | 484.00 | 2.09 | 32.49 | 1.25 |
| Bajaj Housing Finance . | 78.75 | 0.67 | 26.48 | 0.35 |
| Macrotech Developers . | 726.40 | -1.27 | 21.69 | 0.98 |
| Siemens Energy India . | 2688.00 | -2.15 | 81.03 | 1.14 |
| Hyundai Motor India . | 1859.50 | -3.42 | 26.09 | 1.28 |
| Tata Power | 384.75 | -11.08 | 24.55 | 3.11 |

Pts: Impact on index movement

ELECTION MANIFESTO

# AIADMK unveils 297 poll promises

**FOR THE PEOPLE.** Party outlines schemes to reduce financial burden, boost income and improve living standards of the people

**T E Raja Simhan**
Chennai

It's raining cash assistance and welfare promises as the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), the principal Opposition party in Tamil Nadu, unveiled a sweeping set of announcements ahead of the Assembly elections to be held on April 23.

As part of its 297 poll promises, the party proposed a ₹10,000 special assistance to every family to offset rising prices and taxes, which it attributes to the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) government. It will also provide a ₹25,000 subsidy for Amma two-wheelers, targeting five lakh women beneficiaries.

On Tuesday, AIADMK General Secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami said that if voted to power, all rice card holders would be provided with refrigerators to ease the workload of housewives.

The manifesto outlines a range of schemes aimed at reducing financial burden, boosting income and improving living standards for families, women, youth and the marginalised groups. Palaniswami said the promises were based on extensive consultations and were "achievable schemes".

It also reiterated past commitments, such as continuing free rice for family card holders, providing 1 kg of pulses and 1 litre of cooking oil free of cost, and increasing medical college seat reservation for government school students from 7.5 per cent to 10 cent.

### STATE DEBT

The manifesto alleged that despite a significant increase in government revenue over the past five years, the State had accumulated over ₹5 lakh crore in debt, translating to an estimated ₹1.25 lakh burden per person.

On the industrial development front, the AIADMK proposed a streamlined single window system under the direct control of the Chief Minister, headed by a senior IAS officer, to facilitate faster clearances for investors.

The existing Guidance TN will be brought under this mechanism, it noted.

**KEY POINTS**

- ₹10,000 special assistance to each family to offset rising prices and tax
- ₹2,000 monthly assistance to women via Kula Vilakku Scheme
- ₹25,000 subsidy for Amma two-wheelers for 5 lakh women
- Three free gas cylinders annually for rice cardholders
- Refrigerator, free rice, dal and oil for families

### INDUSTRIAL GROWTH

It also lays down plans to promote industrial growth in the southern districts by developing industrial corridors and estates. For micro, small and medium enterprises, it proposed urging the Centre to reduce the GST on job work contracts to 5 per cent.

### POWER TARIFF

The industrial power tariff rate will be restructured in a way that does not affect entrepreneurs, and additional subsidies will be provided to encourage MSMEs to use solar power, said the manifesto.

Political analyst Ramu Manivannan described the manifesto as a "heady mix of populist and welfare policies".

He cautioned that measures such as free refrigerators could mirror past controversies such as the television distribution scheme, and stressed the need for more focused interventions in health, education, food and agriculture.

# Bhabanipur set for high-stakes Mamata-Adhikari showdown

**Mithun Dasgupta**
Kolkata

A towering banner proclaiming 'She was in power, she is in power, she will remain in power' greets passers-by in South Kolkata's Harish Mukherjee Road, a stone's throw from the residence of West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, signalling the high-stakes battle unfolding in her political backyard.

Banerjee is set to face her arch-rival Suvendu Adhikari, the Leader of the Opposition, who has chosen to contest from Bhabanipur, the Chief Minister's home turf, setting the stage for one of the most closely watched contests in next month's Assembly elections.

The constituency has turned into a theatre of intense campaigning, with both the ruling All India Trinamool Congress and the Opposition Bharatiya Janata Party stepping up door-to-door outreach and street-level mobilisation.

**LARGER THAN LIFE.** An artist painting the Trinamool Congress' campaign graffitti in the Bhabanipur Assembly constituency in West Bengal PTI

### 'MAMATA WILL WIN'

At a Trinamool Congress party office, septuagenarian local leader Asish Ghosh dismissed the BJP challenge, predicting a decisive victory for Banerjee. "Didi knows her constituency like the back of her hand. She has always been available for the people here. People are getting support from her government through welfare schemes like Lakshmir Bhandar, Kanyashree and Yuva Sathi," said Ghosh.

He alleged voter disenchantment over the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. "People are very angry with the Election Commission and the BJP due to the harassment voters are facing. In Bhabanipur, many genuine voters' names were deleted. The Narendra Modi government has also failed to deal with the LPG shortage issue," he added.

During the revision exercise, over 47,000 names were deleted from electoral rolls in the constituency, while about 14,000 electors remained under adjudication pending judicial verification as of February 28. Adhikari had months earlier declared his intent to contest from Bhabanipur and repeat his earlier electoral success against Banerjee.

In the 2021 Assembly elections, Adhikari defeated Banerjee in Nandigram in Purba Medinipur district by a slender margin of 1,956 votes.

However, Banerjee led the Trinamool Congress to a sweeping victory statewide and later re-entered the Assembly through a byelection in Bhabanipur, winning by a margin of 58,000 votes, reaffirming the seat as one of her strongest bastions.

The BJP, however, draws confidence from the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, when the Trinamool Congress secured a relatively modest lead of 8,291 votes from the Bhabanipur Assembly segment, amid allegations of corruption and signs of anti-incumbency.

"We will win this time from Bhabanipur seat without an iota of doubt," said local BJP leader Rabindra Chowdhury. "When we meet voters, we are witnessing anger towards Banerjee and her government over corruption, from the School Service Commission recruitment scam to money laundering linked to the coal scam. Several Trinamool leaders are involved in big scams," he said.

He also referred to the RG Kar Hospital rape-murder case, saying concerns over women's safety remain a key campaign issue.

## QUICKLY.

### VD Satheesan predicts 100+ seats for Team UDF

**Kochi:** Opposition leader VD Satheesan has expressed the confidence that Team UDF will return to power in Kerala with a tally exceeding 100 seats. Addressing a public rally at the UDF election convention in Thrikkakara, Satheesan said the coalition is poised for victory, citing the decisive majority secured in the recent civic body polls as an indicator of public sentiment.

He asserted that there is a strong anti-incumbency wave against the ruling LDF, and claimed that the people are eager to "dethrone this corrupt government". The UDF has consistently exposed alleged corruption by the government, and promised that the front would offer alternative welfare-oriented programmes if voted to power. Accusing the government of misusing public funds for election campaigning, he alleged that PR agencies were being deployed to project baseless achievements. V SAJEEV KUMAR

### VCK gets 8 seats in DMK-led alliance

**Chennai:** The Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) has signed a seat-sharing agreement with the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) for the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly elections. The party has been allotted eight seats, with six reserved constituencies and two general constituencies. The agreement was signed after VCK founder-president and Member of the Lok Sabha, Thol. Thirumavalavan (*in picture*), met Chief Minister MK Stalin at the DMK headquarters on Tuesday. VCK had contested six seats in the 2021 Assembly elections, of which it had won four. OUR BUREAU

### Rajeev Chandrasekhar's nomination cleared

**Kochi:** The nomination of Kerala BJP State President Rajeev Chandrasekhar for the Nemom constituency has been accepted after initial concerns over the alleged non-disclosure of assets were resolved. The Congress had raised objections to his election affidavit, alleging improper declaration of a Bengaluru property valued around ₹200 crore. The complaint was filed by Congress candidate KS Sabarinathan, who claimed that a 49,000 sq ft residence in Koramangala was not fully disclosed. However, Chandrasekhar's affidavit reportedly listed the property with a market value of ₹15.07 crore, not ₹200 crore. After reviewing the objections, election authorities cleared the nomination, rejecting the complaints. OUR BUREAU

# Twenty20's partnership with NDA aims to rewrite Kerala's electoral playbook

**V Sajeev Kumar**
Kochi

In a move that could shake up Kerala's traditionally bipolar politics, business-backed outfit Twenty20 has aligned with the BJP-led NDA, aiming to convert its local governance success into a broader electoral breakthrough.

Twenty20, the political organisation spearheaded by Kitex Garments Managing Director Sabu M Jacob, has formally joined the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) to contest the Kerala elections. The development signals a renewed attempt by the BJP-led alliance to disrupt the long-standing dominance of the LDF and the UDF across the State.

The alliance comes on the heels of the NDA's modest gains in the recent local body elections, and is expected to alter voter dynamics in select constituencies. Twenty20's influence, particularly in industrial pockets where it has demonstrated governance capability, could complement the NDA's broader political network and outreach.

### DISILLUSIONED VOTERS

Political observers believe the partnership could appeal to voters disillusioned with both the LDF and the UDF, especially amid concerns about governance and economic management.

Twenty20's corporate-style administrative approach — credited with tangible results in local bodies — may resonate with sections seeking efficiency and accountability over traditional political rhetoric.

Speaking to *businessline* at the NDA's campaign office in Kochi, Jacob criticised successive governments led by the Congress and the CPI (M), blaming them for Kerala's rising public debt.

"At a time when the entire India is progressing, Kerala is falling behind. If the NDA comes to power, Kerala will definitely move forward along with other States," he said, drawing comparison with NDA-ruled States such as Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh, which have transitioned to major investment destinations attracting millions of dollars.

Twenty20 plans to contest 20 seats across Kerala, stretching from Thiruvananthapuram to Kasaragod. However, Jacob was cautious about predicting electoral success of the candidates, saying it is too early for an assessment.

"Our manifesto is yet to come out, and when it does, it will create a favourable momentum among voters. The manifesto will differ significantly from conventional ones and focus on practical solutions to Kerala's pressing issues," he said.

The party has fielded a mix of candidates, including film and television actors. While this has drawn scepticism from some BJP members regarding winnability, Jacob defended the choices. "We selected prominent and talented candidates from diverse fields, including the film industry. At the end of the day, politics is serving the country and the people. Their chances of winning will depend ultimately on Kerala voters."

GROUND ZERO

# Charting the BJP's electoral ascent in Kerala's capital

**Vinson Kurian**
Thiruvananthapuram

Thiruvananthapuram has long exhibited a discernible historical and ideological affinity with strands of organised Hindu political mobilisation, shaped by temple-centred institutions, caste alignments and urban social networks.

This underlying current has periodically translated into electoral opportunities for formations aligned with the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh and later the Bharatiya Janata Party, particularly during moments of communal or political churn.

One such turning point followed the Chalai market riots of the 1980s, when the Hindu Munnani sought to channel majority community sentiment into electoral politics. However, the roots of this mobilisation run deeper than episodic unrest.

The legacy of the Travancore royals, who declared the Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple the spiritual and economic nucleus of the kingdom in the 18th century, created a socio-religious ecosystem that continues to shape political alignments in the city's Old Fort precincts, an area widely regarded as an enduring organisational base for RSS-linked networks.

### ALL STAR CANDIDATES

The battle lines are clearly drawn a day after the nominations were filed. All three fronts are caught in tight, multi-cornered contests, with each fielding star candidates. In Thiruvananthapuram, the LDF waited till the last minute to announce actor Sudhir Karamana, son of late actor Karamana Janardanan and a teacher by profession, as its candidate. Sudhir will take on Karamana Jayan, city district president of the BJP, and CP John of the UDF, former leader of the SFI and the CPM.

Race for Thiruvananthapuram

| Year (including byelections) | Lok Sabha (%) | Assembly (%) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Thiruvananthapuram Central (since 2008 delimitation) | Nemom (since 1957) | Vattiyoorkavu (since 2008 delimitation) | Kazhakkoottam (since 1965) |
| 1984 | 19.6 | - | - | - | |
| 1989 | 7.5 | - | | - | |
| 1991 | 11.3 | - | 16 | - | 2.17 |
| 1996 | 10.6 | - | 8.18 | - | 8.81 |
| 1998 | 12.4 | - | - | - | - |
| 1999 | 20.9 | - | | - | - |
| 2001 | | - | 13.81 | - | - |
| 2004 | 29.9 | - | - | - | - |
| 2006 | - | - | 5.59 | - | 2.28 |
| 2009 | 11.4 | - | - | - | - |
| 2011 | - | 10.76 | 37.49 | 11.98 | 6.86 |
| 2014 | 32.4 | 36 | 42.1 | 37.1 | 37.1 |
| 2016 | - | 27.54 | 47.46 | 32.19 | 31.9 |
| 2019 | 31.4 | 36 | 42.1 | 37.1 | 37.1 |
| 2021 | - | 27.29 | 35.54 | 28.77 | 29.06 |
| 2024 | 35.5 | 40.58 | 45.8 | 42.02 | 40.56 |

BJP State President Rajeev Chandrasekhar hopes to continue his creditable Lok Sabha outing in neighbouring Nemom, pitted against a formidable V Sivankutty, sitting MLA and Minister, and S Sabarinathan, young but seasoned Congress candidate.

Vattiyoorkavu features Congress strongman K Muraleedharan, former MP and Minister and son of the late Chief Minister and towering leader K Karunakaran. The BJP is represented here by R Sreelekha, the first woman IPS officer from the State and a former DGP. Last but not least is Kazhakkoottam, where sitting MLA and former LDF Minister Kadakampally Surendran will take on former Central Minister and top BJP leader V Muraleedharan

Historians, including MG Sasibhooshan, have pointed to the city's Tamil- and Tulu-speaking Brahmin communities, originally brought by the Travancore rulers to conduct temple rituals, as among the earliest cohesive voting blocs receptive to such mobilisation. They were complemented by sections of the erstwhile Nair brigade, forebears of the upper-caste Nair communities, forming a second axis of political consolidation.

Against this backdrop, the 1984 Lok Sabha election marked a defining moment when P Kerala Varma Raja entered the fray as a candidate of the Hindu Munnani.

The significance lay not merely in his candidature, but in the support he generated. Raja secured roughly 1.1 lakh votes, translating into a 19.6 per cent vote share, a substantial performance for a formation still on the margins of mainstream electoral politics. In statistical terms, this represented an early consolidation threshold that demonstrated the viability of a structured Hindu political vote in an otherwise Left-leaning urban constituency.

**The battle lines are clearly drawn a day after** the nominations were filed. All three fronts are caught in tight, multi-cornered contests with each fielding star candidates

Over the subsequent decades, this trend persisted, albeit unevenly, across four Assembly segments — Thiruvananthapuram Central, Nemom, Vattiyoorkavu and Kazhakkoottam — within the district's 14-seat matrix. For years, the BJP struggled to breach what strategists describe as the psychological 30 per cent voteshare threshold, widely seen as the minimum marker of electoral competitiveness in Kerala's fragmented political terrain. That barrier was eventually crossed when Kummanam Rajasekharan secured 31.4 per cent in the 2019 Lok Sabha election in Thiruvananthapuram, followed by Rajeev Chandrasekhar pushing the figure to 35.5 per cent in 2024.

### VOTES OF MINORITIES

In electoral arithmetic, a voteshare in the 30-35 per cent band signals the arrival of a credible challenger but not necessarily a winner. In such scenarios, even a 1-2 per cent swing among floating voters or the minority communities can decisively tilt outcomes, explaining why both Rajasekharan and Chandrasekhar emerged as strong runners-up rather than victors. The breakthrough moment came earlier in 2016 when veteran leader O Rajagopal secured an unprecedented victory from the Nemom Assembly constituency.

At 86 years, Rajagopal won 47.46 per cent of the vote, registering a +9.97 percentage point swing, a statistically significant shift that altered perceptions of the BJP's electoral ceiling in Kerala. Notably, the leader had previously lost 13 elections, attributing his eventual success to increased participation from the youth and women voters, demographic groups that later became central to the BJP's urban strategy.

In 2021, Rajasekharan characterised Nemom as Kerala's Gujarat, drawing national attention to the constituency's evolving political profile. Although he fell short of victory, his 35.7 per cent voteshare against the winner's 38.4 per cent underscored the persistence of a competitive bipolar contest in pockets once considered impregnable Left strongholds. Neighbouring constituencies Vattiyoorkavu, Thiruvananthapuram Central and Kazhakkoottam gradually mirrored Nemom's trajectory, aided by sizeable Nair and Ezhava populations.

However, electoral outcomes continued to hinge on the voting patterns of the Muslim and Christian communities, whose consolidation frequently determined the final margins.

## QUICKLY.

### Robin Liu steps down as OnePlus India CEO

**New Delhi:** The CEO of Chinese mobile device maker OnePlus India, Robin Liu, has stepped down, the firm said on Tuesday. The development comes as the company works to recover from the ongoing decline in shipments. Under Liu, OnePlus recorded a 32 per cent decline in shipments in 2025, according to Cybermedia Research. IDC estimates a 38.8 per cent decline in the company's shipments in 2025 on a year-on-year basis. PTI

### QatarEnergy declares *force majeure*

**Bengaluru:** QatarEnergy on Tuesday declared *force majeure* on some of its affected long-term LNG supply contracts, with counterparties including customers in Italy, Belgium, South Korea and China. REUTERS

# Iran dismisses Trump's talk of negotiation as 'fake news'

**RADIO SILENCE.** No talks held with the US, says Iran's Parliament Speaker

Reuters
Washington/Jerusalem/Tel Aviv

**FIRING ON.** Iran continued to pound parts of Israel on Tuesday, triggering air raid sirens REUTERS

Iran launched multiple waves of missiles at Israel, the Israeli military said, after US President Donald Trump postponed a threat to bomb the Islamic Republic's power grid because of what he described as productive talks with Iranian officials.

The missiles triggered air raid sirens in parts of Israel, including Tel Aviv where blasts from interceptions were heard. In one attack, homes in northern Israel were damaged by falling debris following an interception. No deaths were reported.

Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform on Monday that the US and Iran had held "very good and productive" conversations about a "complete and total resolution of hostilities in the Middle East". As a result, he said, he was postponing for five days a plan to hit Iran's energy grid. His announcement sent share prices higher and oil prices sharply lower to below $100 a barrel.

Those gains were in jeopardy on Tuesday however, after Iran's powerful parliament speaker Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf said no negotiations had taken place.

"No negotiations have been held with the US, and fake news is used to manipulate the financial and oil markets and escape the quagmire in which the US and Israel are trapped," he wrote on X.

Iran's elite Revolutionary Guards (IRGC) said they were launching fresh attacks on US targets, and described Trump's words as "psychological operations" that were "worn out" and having no impact on Tehran's fight.

**POINTS OF AGREEMENT**

Trump told reporters his special envoy Steve Witkoff and son-in-law Jared Kushner had held discussions with a top Iranian official into the evening on Sunday and would continue on Monday.

"We have major points of agreement, I would say, almost all points of agreement," he said on Monday.

A European official said that while there had been no direct negotiations between the two nations, Egypt, Pakistan and Gulf states were relaying messages.

A Pakistani official and a second source told *Reuters* that direct talks on ending the war could be held in Islamabad as soon as this week. Although there was no immediate confirmation of talks, Iran's foreign ministry described initiatives to reduce tensions.

It said Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi had reviewed developments related to the Strait of Hormuz with his Omani counterpart and agreed to continue consultations between the two countries.

# ₹ remains vulnerable to further fall

Gurumurthy K
bl Research Bureau

The Indian rupee has been knocked down badly in the past week. The direct currency tumbled to a new low of 93.98 against the dollar. Crude oil price spiking back to $119 per barrel last week coupled with strong foreign money outflows dragged the rupee lower.

**WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.**

The rupee recovered slightly from its low and closed at 93.87 on Tuesday

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) have been on a selling spree since the beginning of this month. The Indian market has seen a net outflow of about $12.5 billion so far this month. The rupee has recovered slightly from its low and has closed at 93.87 on Tuesday.

**RUPEE OUTLOOK**

There is no major support visible on the charts. Resistance is at 93.20 and then in the 93-92.90 region. If the rupee manages to sustain above 94, there are good chances to see some recovery towards 93.20-93 this week. This recovery is also possible if the Centre intervenes to limit the downside in the domestic currency.

However, from a big picture, as long as the rupee stays below 92.90, the bias will remain negative. There is a danger of the rupee falling to 95.30 in the coming months. A strong break below 94 can trigger this fall.

Rupee will now have to rise above 93 to get some breather. Only then a strong recovery towards 92 is possible. Such a move is possible only if the central bank intervenes. In the absence of that, a fall to 95.30 cannot be ruled out.

**STRONG DOLLAR**

The dollar index (99.33) has come down below 100 last week. However, there is a strong support in the 99-98.80 region which can be tested in the near term. But thereafter, the dollar index can rise back above 100 and go up to 101 initially. From a medium-term perspective, the dollar index has potential to see 103-104 on the upside. A strong dollar can keep the rupee under pressure.

**VOLATILE OIL**

Crude oil price has been volatile. We can expect the Brent Crude Oil ($103 per barrel) to oscillate in a wide range of $90-$120 per barrel for some time now. The price has to decline below $90 to give some relief for the rupee. That looks less likely now. So, elevated oil prices will continue to drag the rupee lower.

# India awaits delivery of 2.3 lakh tonnes of LPG

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Five tankers filled with roughly 2.30 lakh tonnes of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) are idling in the Persian Gulf west of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) awaiting a go-ahead from Iran to transit the world's most critical energy chokepoint.

Speaking during the daily briefing on West Asia on Tuesday, Rakesh Kumar Sinha, Special Secretary to the Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways, said that two Indian LPG vessels — *Pine Gas* and *Jag Vasant* — have crossed the Strait of Hormuz last night and are heading towards India carrying LPG cargo.

*Pine Gas* (about 45,000 tonnes LPG) is bound for New Mangalore with ETA on the morning of March 27, while *Jag Vasant* (about 47,612.59 tonnes LPG) is bound for Kandla with ETA on March 26.

Of the remaining 20 vessels in the west of the Strait, five LPG-laden tankers with around 3.2 lakh tonnes await safe passage through the Strait. One another empty LPG vessel will be loaded in 3-4 days, Sinha added.

**CRISIS MANAGEMENT**

Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG) Joint Secretary Sujata Sharma said, "No dry-outs have been reported at distributorships. Panic bookings showed a marginal increase yesterday (Monday), while delivery of domestic LPG cylinders continues as normal," she added.

Twenty-four States and Union Territories have issued orders to allocate the non-domestic LPG in line

with the Centre's guidelines.

For the rest of the States/Union Territories, PSU oil marketing companies (OMCs) are releasing commercial LPG cylinders.

A total of 18,784 tonnes of LPG has been uplifted since March 14 by commercial entities in the States/UTs.

Enforcement actions continue across States to curb hoarding and black marketeering, with about 3,400 raids conducted and around 1,000 cylinders seized in the past 24 hours. Major actions were reported in Andhra Pradesh, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Telangana.

The PSU OMCs conducted over 1,500 surprise inspections at retail outlets and LPG distributorships on Monday. So far, 642 FIRs have been registered and 155 people arrested.

# Trump, Modi discuss Strait of Hormuz

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

US President Donald Trump on Tuesday spoke with Prime Minister Narendra Modi to discuss the situation in West Asia, with a focus on ensuring that the Strait of Hormuz stays open, according to US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor.

"President Donald Trump just spoke with PM Modi. They discussed the ongoing situation in the Middle East, including the importance of keeping the Strait of Hormuz open," Gor said in a brief post on social media platform 'X'.

India supports de-escalation and restoration of peace at the earliest, Modi said in his social media post after his call with Trump. "Ensuring that the Strait of Hormuz remains open, secure and accessible is essential for the whole world. We agreed to stay in touch regarding efforts towards peace and stability," Modi said.

**A TURN FROM THREATS**

Last weekend, Trump had threatened to "hit and obliterate" Iran's power stations and energy infrastructure if the country did not allow shipping to move freely through the Strait of Hormuz.

On Monday, Trump eased his threat and said the US military would postpone strikes on Iranian power plants and energy infrastructure for five days following "productive" talks between Washington and Tehran.

The Strait of Hormuz is one of the world's most critical maritime chokepoints with around a fifth of the world's oil supply passing through it every day. Major producers like Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Kuwait and United Arab Emirates export most of their crude through this narrow passage. The disruption in the strait has led to great volatility in global crude prices.

India, heavily dependent on crude imports, has consistently called for stability in the region and the protection of key maritime corridors.

# Unincorporated sector grew 8% in 2025

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Unincorporated non-agricultural sector showed an impressive performance in 2025 as the number of establishments grew by around 8 per cent, to 7.92 crore, a survey results released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) showed.

Results are based on data collected from over 6.7 lakh establishments.

The number of such enterprises was 7.34 crore during previous Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) 2023-24. Unincorporated non-agricultural enterprises comprise small manufacturers, service providers, and trading unit. These are neither incorporated nor registered under Companies Act. These are situated in a single location, where either a single productive activity is carried out, or where the principal productive activity accounts for most of the value added.

**MORE JOBS**

According to the survey, the sector employed about 12.81 crore workers during January-December 2025, adding over 74.52 lakh jobs from 2023-24 (October 23-September 24). 'Other Services' sector showed the highest growth of 7.4 per cent generating about 35 lakh jobs. The emolument per hired worker increased by 3.88 per cent in 2025. The highest increase in this metric was observed in trade sector which recorded a growth of about 8.5 per cent.

The number of establishments in the 'Other Services' sector grew over 10 per cent followed by manufacturing sector (6.5 per cent) and trade (6 per cent). "This reflects broad-based expansion across sectors and highlights the steady growth of the unincorporated non-agricultural sector," stated the survey report. The percentage of female-owned proprietary establishments increased marginally from 26.2 per cent to 27 per cent.

Gross value added (GVA) per worker rose to over ₹1.56 lakh from around ₹1.5 lakh, up 4.54 per cent. During the same period, GVA per establishment increased from around ₹2.53 lakh from ₹2.46 lakh.

# Gulf tensions squeeze India's alcobev sector as input costs soar

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Volatility in crude and fuel prices, along with disruptions in shipping routes due to escalating geopolitical tensions in West Asia, is impacting India's alcoholic beverage industry, which was experiencing sustained cost pressures across its value chain before the Iran war.

**STEEP INCREASE**

According to industry bodies like the Confederation of Indian Alcoholic Beverage Companies (CIABC) and Brewers Association of India (BAI), primary inputs have experienced sharp inflation in the last three weeks. Prices of glass bottles have risen by approximately 20 per cent, paper cartons by almost 100 per cent, while the cost of materials such as LDPE, BOPP, and adhesives by 20-25 per cent. Freight and logistics costs have also gone up by 10 per cent.

The rupee has fallen by almost 3 per cent against the US dollar. The impact of these increases is estimated to be 12-15 per cent more in costs for brewers.

Manufacturers are also witnessing significant cost escalations in packaging materials such as PET, aseptic formats, and other polymer-linked inputs.

"With base prices of products in several markets largely unchanged, manufacturers have had limited ability to absorb these increases, resulting in sustained pressure on margins and overall business viability. This is unlike other industries, as they are devoid of government price control mechanisms," said Anant S Iyer, Director General, CIABC.

**POSSIBLE SHUTDOWNS**

Further, the war has affected aluminium supplies from West Asia; some suppliers have warned that prolonged disruption could impact production volumes and even lead to the shutdown of plants. Glass bottle manufacturers also face partial or full shutdown of units due to commercial LNG supply crunch. This could strain glass and can supplies.

A prolonged disruption could trigger *force majeure* clauses in contracts between suppliers and brewers, and between brewers and beer buyers, including private and government entities.

**EXCISE'S ROLE**

BAI warns brewers may prioritise supplies to States with pricing flexibility — Maharashtra, Karnataka and Goa — while struggling to sustain volumes in States that restrict price hikes, potentially impacting excise tax revenues.

"The current crisis highlights the need for a flexible and pragmatic policy environment. Inability to pass on cost increases disincentivises a supplier to maintain supplies, especially during a shortage. Reduced supplies also mean lower tax collection. Low prices mean lower tax collection per unit. It is time the governments take steps to allow pricing freedom to brewers to safeguard industry viability, ensure stable consumer supply, and protect long-term State revenues," said Vinod Giri, Director General, BAI.

CIABC is writing to State governments seeking price revisions of IMFL products to maintain stable supply.

# 'AI tokenisation pricing will outweigh human effort'

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

As Hexaware gears up to launch a host of AI solutions in 2026, Siddharth Dhar, President & Global Head, Digital IT Operations & AI, Hexaware, spoke about how employees should navigate in an agentic world with pricing models and headcount adjusting for new AI models working on a token-costing format.

*Edited excerpts:*

**What are your expectations with Agentverse Enterprise AI in terms of returns?**

Agentverse will have an impact both on our top line and bottom line. By year-end, productivity gains will be reflected in the bottom line because of the agents deployed.

Revenue gains will be reflected in the top line. These solutions have come due to customer demand.

All 600+ agents were already deployed either in PoCS (proof of concept) or in production with an existing customer, but we aggregated that and allowed access through Agentverse.

**Is Hexaware thinking of an AI+human model for its pricing framework?**

Yes, 100 per cent. A lot of our pricing will move to headcount plus tokens. In fact, all the platforms that we are deploying have an in-built token cost in the platform.

**Could you share details of how this pricing model works?**

All the models in IT are priced into quantity. So, the price was determined by headcount, hourly billing rate.

Now, there will be two 'Q's and two 'P's. Wherever there is a human in the loop, there is a human price and a token cost.

So, every time the agents run, an inference is made, there is a token cost. There is a separate swim lane of work for the agents and for the human world.

Both get billed based on their inherent costing mechanism. For the human, the costing mechanism is the hours that the human spent for the work, and for AI it's the number of tokens it spent to do the work.

> As an organisation, our stance always has been that AI is essentially an augmentation of the human capacity, not a full replacement
>
> SIDDHARTH DHAR
> President & Global Head, Digital IT Operations & AI, Hexaware

**Does the tokenisation outweigh the human effort from a costing perspective?**

Right now, it's quite balanced. Overtime, definitely there'll be more token utilisation, less human intervention because AI learns things and you develop more confidence in it. It will increase in the future.

**Is there any particular task or agenda that most of the customers use AI for?**

There's software development lifecycle as a business case that all customers are deploying.

Similarly, deploying agents in managing and IT operations is something that sees a lot of traction. Legal is a great use case; getting contracts reviewed, built up. We're also seeing traction for using AI as an enterprise chatbot, replacing the traditional interface with things like service desk.

**Have your AI solutions affected workforce rationalisation?**

It has and it will continue to do so. As an organisation, our stance always has been that AI is essentially an augmentation of the human capacity, not a full replacement.

We don't know where it'll go six months from now but it's a pretty fast-evolving field. For the moment, I foresee a much slower need to hire and better utilisation of existing folks.

Six months from now we may have a different opinion, but for the moment it's clearly an augmentation and capacity expansion play and not a human replacement play.

**Are you worried that this might possibly affect or lead to any sort of revenue cannibalisation?**

There will be revenue cannibalisation but we're not worried about that because of our size.

There's a lot larger market share that we can gain by being ahead of the curve on something like this. That's the advantage of being the size that we are — there's a lot more to gain than to lose.

**What are your plans going ahead?**

We have a whole calendar of agentic announcements laid out for the rest of the year. Everything will be done by industry or customer. This is the year for agent AI for Hexaware.

# 'Ramraj Cotton sprucing up systems and tech with 2030 IPO in mind'

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Ethnic wear brand Ramraj Cotton, widely recognised for popularising the humble *dhoti*, is in the process of setting up systems and processes with an initial public offering (IPO) as a goal by 2030.

"We have already built a large brand, and now it is time to preserve it for future; we are bringing in lot of professional systems and fine tuning our technologies. We are also getting a lot of interest from bankers and investors," KR Nagarajan, Founder & Chairman, Ramraj Cotton, told *businessline*.

While the entrepreneur does not have a target turnover to go public, he said they would like to be at ₹10,000 crore turnover by the time they go for an IPO, which he feels will be likely by 2030. "We want to promote the brand further, want to take our culture wider and for these we need funds and a larger brand name," he said.

He did not disclose the group's current revenue.

KR Nagarajan, Founder & Chairman, Ramraj Cotton

The Founder is supported in the professional management by his two son-in-laws, who have started to put software systems and standard operating procedures (SOPs) in place. The company has also made key appointments of senior executives across technology, human resources, marketing, and operations.

"I consider myself a 'culturepreneur' more than an entrepreneur; ours will be the first time of a 'culture IPO'," said Nagarajan.

Founded in 1983, the brand has transformed the *dhoti* (or *veshti*) from a simple apparel into a symbol of cultural pride. What started out as a small *dhoti* business in Tiruppur, catapulted into a household name in Tamil Nadu. The entrepreneur's motivation, however, came from a desire to help the weaver community and bring a cultural renaissance to the garment sector.

**EXPANSION PLANS**

Ramraj Group has around 375 stores across Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, Andhra, and Telangana. They also have over 15,000 dealers across India.

Ramraj is also training its eyes on North India, where it is currently retailing via dealers.

The Group also has stores in Malaysia, Singapore, and Colombo. Their products are in high demand in the US, UK, and other countries, where they are sold in Indian stores and online. "Demand is not something that is met, but something that is created. We have made sure to create a demand for our culture wherever we go," said Nagarajan.

## QUICKLY.

**BEL, RRP ink pact for defence tech business**

**New Delhi:** Navratna defence public sector undertaking Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) on Tuesday signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the RRP Group to jointly explore business opportunities in advanced defence and technology domains. The RRP Group of companies — RRP Electronics Ltd and RRP Defense Ltd — which inked the MoU specialise in semiconductor manufacturing and aerospace and defence systems. OUR BUREAU

**RBI plans ₹1.25 lakh crore year-end VRR boost**

**Mumbai:** The Reserve Bank of India will conduct two Variable Rate Repo auctions under the Liquidity Adjustment Facility aggregating ₹1.25 lakh crore for the end of the financial year to provide flexibility to the banking system in year-end liquidity management. The central bank provides liquidity to banks to overcome short-term liquidity mismatches via VRR. OUR BUREAU

# Tech firms pivot to lateral hiring, ready-to-deploy talent

**COMMON APPROACH.** Shift towards niche skills hiring, especially in AI/ML and cloud

**Vallari Sanzgiri**
Mumbai

**NEW MANTRA.** Lateral hiring is now the engine, and freshers are the pipeline, says expert

The IT sector has turned its attention towards lateral rather than fresh hires in the first three months of 2026, as per Instahyre data, as companies look to deploy experienced employees, with ready-made skills on critical projects. After enforcing opposing strategies in the past quarters, India's tech giants and mid-sized firms have arrived at a common strategy of lateral hiring.

In March, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) sent mails to employees encouraging them to bring in "buddies" potential lateral hires to win bonus payments. Infosys is running an aggressive lateral push with over 1,000 open technical roles. Tech Mahindra faces over 1,000 delayed onboardings. Instahyre said the trend persists from Q3 when companies like Wipro added around 6,500 employees, while onboarding only around 400 freshers and cutting its FY26 fresher target to 7,500–8,000.

Meanwhile, mid-tier firms Hexaware, Coforge, Mphasis, Persistent Systems, and KPIT reported an even sharper structural shift. Persistent Systems and KPIT are clearly experience-first, hiring for 2–15 years roles in cloud, embedded, and automotive, with fresher intake limited to around 20 niche roles or small-batch programmes.

In terms of annual hiring target as well, companies like Hexaware remain heavily lateral-led, while Coforge runs at 78–82 per cent lateral hiring, with freshers forming 18–22 per cent.

**LATERAL HIRING**

"The pattern is consistent: lateral hiring is now the engine, freshers are the pipeline. There is a lot of high-intent hiring concentrated in AI, cloud, data, and cybersecurity, with companies prioritising ready-to-deploy talent over train-and-deploy models," said Sarbojit Mallick, Co-Founder, Instahyre. While the trend indicates that firms are now looking for capability, Sanchit Vir Gogia, Founder and Chief Analyst at Greyhound Research said that lateral hiring comes at the cost of higher salaries.

**EXPERIENCED TALENT**

"As firms bring in more experienced talent, their cost base rises. At the same time, clients expect efficiency gains from AI and push for better pricing," said Gogia.

Lateral talent also leads to more intense competition and over time weakens the internal pipeline for future leadership. This is why some firms are bringing freshers back but in smaller batches, through more targeted hiring and shorter, more focused training.

According to CIEL HR, there is a noticeable shift towards niche skills hiring, especially in AI/ML, cloud, cybersecurity, and data engineering. Some firms lean more aggressively into AI-focused hiring and others hire considering active project demand.

# ED detects ₹36,000 crore in cybercrime proceeds across 257 cases: Govt

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has identified proceeds of crime amounting to nearly ₹36,000 crore in 257 cybercrime cases investigated till February 28 this year, the Centre informed the Lok Sabha on Tuesday.

In a written reply, Minister of State for Home Affairs Bandi Sanjay Kumar said the agency has traced ₹35,925.58 crore linked to cyber offences under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA).

He noted that the ED works in close coordination with other law enforcement agencies through an established information-sharing mechanism involving designated nodal officers.

Highlighting the technological tools being used, Kumar said the ED leverages platforms such as SAHYOG, Samanvaya and the cyber police portal operated by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under the MHA. While the ED has taken up 257 cybercrime cases so far, it does not maintain State-wise data on the proceeds of crime identified.

# Nikon India eyes ₹1,000 cr revenue in FY26, 8% growth


Sajjan Kumar, Managing Director, Nikon India, at the inauguration of Nikon's second experience zone in Chennai BIJOY GHOSH

**Rohan Das**
Chennai

Nikon India, a subsidiary of Japan's Nikon Corporation, is eyeing to close the financial year ending March 2026 with revenues of ₹1,000 crore, a growth of about 8 per cent from the last fiscal.

The company is expecting a steady growth of about 5 per cent in FY27, Sajjan Kumar, Managing Director, Nikon India, told *businessline* on the sidelines of Nikon Experience Zone inauguration at a retail outlet here on Tuesday.

The experience zone displays Nikon's range of photography and imaging products, including mirrorless Z camera, DSLR cameras, COOLPIX range and its Nikkor brand of lenses and accessories. This is Nikon's second experience zone in Chennai and sixth in Tamil Nadu. Across India, the company operates 140 such experience zones. On the wider camera business, Kumar said the rise of the creator economy has led to an increase in demand for photography and videography products. "Though vloggers and content creators use smart devices when they start off, over time they migrate to Nikon when they want to upgrade as it is easier to shoot, has content clarity, and smooth update facilities," he said. Overall, Nikon has a market share of about 30 per cent in the mirrorless camera segment in India.

**BEYOND CAMERAS**

Beyond photography, the company also has a presence in the healthcare sector with microscopes. Kumar said that this vertical has seen significant growth in recent years and now contributes to nearly 7 per cent of the company's topline.

On the distribution front, the company sells its cameras and related accessories in over 1,500 retail outlets across the country. While it lacks a direct-to-consumer online presence, Kumar noted that 10-15 per cent of sales are estimated to come via e-commerce channels of partner distributors. On the manufacturing side, Nikon products sold in India are currently imported from Japan. The volumes do not justify local manufacturing, though the company will continue to evaluate opportunities in this area.

# Prosus, Accel back 6 deep-tech start-ups under Atoms X LeapTech cohort

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Global technology investor Prosus and venture capital firm Accel have unveiled six start-ups as part of the inaugural Atoms X LeapTech cohort, signalling a sharper push toward funding science-led, long-gestation innovation from India.

Selected from over 2,000 applications, the cohort focuses on "LeapTech" — a category spanning breakthroughs in climate infrastructure, space communications, aerospace systems and next-generation healthcare. The initiative is designed to back founders from "Day Zero", particularly those building in areas that require deep scientific research and long-term capital.

Under the partnership, Prosus will match Accel's investment in each company, providing founders with capital certainty as they pursue complex, high-risk ideas. The programme also offers mentorship and access to global networks.

"LeapTech requires conviction to build companies years before there is consensus. The quality of applications exceeded our expectations ... showing how Indian founders around the world are building breakthroughs to commercialise science and create all-new categories," said Pratik Agarwal, Partner at Accel.

Ashutosh Sharma, Head of India ecosystem at Prosus, said the strong response to the inaugural cohort underscores a key gap in the ecosystem.

**PATIENT CAPITAL**

"Innovation in India is not constrained by ideas or inspiration. It is constrained by the right backing at the right time," he said, adding that Prosus aims to provide patient capital and global operating expertise to help founders "think in decades, not quarters."The selected start-ups reflect a wide range of frontier technologies.

These include Praan, which is building full-stack air infrastructure to optimise indoor environments; QOSMIC, focused on ultra-high-speed optical communication between satellites and Earth; and Dognosis, which is developing cancer detection using breath analysis powered by canine olfaction, robotics and AI.

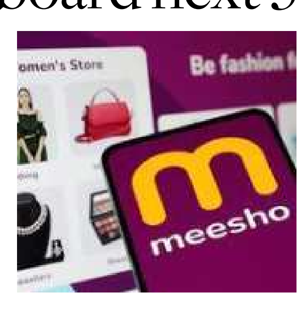
Space-tech startup Ethereal Exploration Guild is working on fully reusable orbital launch vehicles aimed at sharply reducing launch costs, while Ferra is developing a guided home-based strength training system targeted at ageing populations. One start-up in the cohort remains in stealth mode and is building brain-computer interface technology.

The announcement builds on Accel's broader Atoms programme, launched in 2021, which has backed more than 50 start-ups that have collectively raised over $300 million in follow-on funding.

With applications for future cohorts already under evaluation, the Accel-Prosus partnership reflects a growing shift in India's start-up ecosystem toward deep-tech bets, where global capital is increasingly aligning with scientific innovation to build category-defining companies.

# Meesho bets on AI voice assistant 'Vaani' to onboard next 500 m users

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru




Meesho is positioning its newly launched AI-powered voice shopping assistant, Vaani, as a key driver to bring India's digitally hesitant consumers onto e-commerce platforms, as the company sharpens its focus on the next phase of user growth.

The Bengaluru-based firm said the assistant has already seen early traction, with 1.5 million users within a month of launch and a 22 per cent increase in conversion rates among those who engaged with it. Repeat usage trends indicate growing user comfort, pointing to habitual adoption rather than one-time experimentation.

**NEW USERS**

"This technology is so important for new users that we are investing in it. In the future, I expect that the orders that come through our Shopping Assistant will be a big chunk of orders from new users," said Sanjeev Kumar, Co-founder and CTO, Meesho. The company is targeting a segment it believes remains largely underserved by digital commerce — users who are not defined by age or geography, but by their limited comfort with technology.

Meesho estimates that nearly 500 million Indians primarily use apps, such as WhatsApp, Instagram and Facebook, but find typical e-commerce interfaces complex.

Vaani aims to address this gap by replicating the conversational nature of offline shopping. Users can interact through voice, ask follow-up questions, and refine their preferences in real time, reducing reliance on typing, filters, and structured navigation. Built in-house, the assistant combines proprietary speech-to-text, a fine-tuned large language model, and a custom text-to-speech engine, layered on top of off-the-shelf LLM infrastructure. The system also uses edge computing to enable low-latency interactions and optimise costs, alongside a multi-agent framework to handle complex queries across the shopping journey.

"At Meesho, AI has always been at the core of how we build for scale. With over 251 million annual transacting users, we have a deep understanding of how India shops," Kumar said, adding that AI and machine learning are embedded across discovery, pricing, logistics, and seller growth.

The push has broader commercial implications. Meesho's user base continues to skew towards cash-on-delivery, impacting margins. Kumar indicated that conversational interfaces like Vaani could help build trust and accelerate prepaid adoption, particularly among first-time users.

# J&K Bank gets ₹200 crore demand order for GST liability

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

The Jammu and Kashmir Bank on Tuesday said it has received a demand order for GST liability of ₹200.20 crore from the Additional Commissioner, Central GST Commissionerate, Jammu.

The demand order pertains to the period beginning from February 23, 2020 till March 2024 for transactions under the Banks Transfer Price Mechanism (TPM), according to the private sector bank's regulatory filing.

The bank said it has a strong case on merits and has reasonable belief on the basis of expert opinion that the demand is without legal justification and will be set aside by Court of appropriate jurisdiction. The bank said it believes the demand order will not have material impact on its financials, operations or other activities.

CHENNAI
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WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25 - 2026

## QUICKLY.

### Gold extends decline on interest rate expectations

Gold prices extended their decline on Tuesday, weighed down by West Asia tensions that fanned worries of inflation and expectations of higher interest rates globally. Spot gold fell 0.6 per cent to $4,377.93 per ounce by 9:00a.m. ET (1300 GMT). US gold futures for April delivery lost 0.6 per cent to $4,378.80. REUTERS

### Copper falls after Iran denies talks to end war

London copper slipped on Tuesday, giving up most of the previous session's relief rally, after Iran denied holding talks with the US to end the war in West Asia and launched fresh missile attacks on Israel. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME fell 1.4 per cent to $11,991.50 a tonne as of 1000 GMT. REUTERS

### Palm slides more than 1% on weaker rival oils

**Kuala Lumpur:** Malaysian palm oil futures ended more than 1per cent lower on Tuesday after a long Eid holiday break, as weaker rival edible oils weighed on the market and the West Asia war kept traders cautious. The benchmark palm oil contract for June delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange slid 72 ringgit to 4,539 ringgit ($1,148.24) a tonne at the close. REUTERS

# China rejects rice cargoes, citing GMOs

**STRATEGIC TRADE PLANNING?** Rejection comes despite prior-shipment certification by Chinese agency

**Prabhudatta Mishra**
New Delhi

China has turned away three shipments of Indian rice, alleging the presence of genetically modified organisms (GMO) in what appears to be a calculated attempt to gain leverage in trade talks. The rejection comes despite the fact that the non-basmati rice consignments were tested and cleared by a Chinese agency before they were shipped.

India has yet to permit the commercial cultivation of any GM food crops, with cotton remaining the only genetically modified one authorised in the country. The affected companies have taken up the matter with India's agri-export promotion body, Apeda, as well as the Indian Council of Agricultural Research, according to industry sources.

**GROWING MARKET.** India exported 1,80,805 tonnes of non-basmati rice worth $79.43 million to China in 2024-25

In its representation to ICAR, Nagpur-based Shriram Food Industry said Chinese buyers and authorities were demanding an official declaration confirming that rice grown in India is non-GMO, even though only non-GMO paddy is cultivated nationwide. The company requested that ICAR issue a general statement or declaration confirming this.

"This would be extremely helpful for exporters like us as several shipments to China are currently facing difficulties during clearance due to the absence of such a document," the firm noted in its communication.

Anup Goyal, Chairman and Managing Director of Shriram Food, said the India office of the China Certification & Inspection Group (CCIC), a Chinese State-owned company, had inspected and certified the shipments, yet they were rejected by Chinese customs upon arrival.

Goyal stated that they had requested Apeda to investigate how these consignments were rejected on grounds of GMO presence after receiving prior clearance.

Industry sources pointed out the irony in the situation, noting that China itself grows GM rice. In 2006, the European Union even flagged concerns regarding GM contamination in Chinese rice exports.

**WHY ONLY INDIA?**

Foreign trade policy expert S Chandrasekaran wondered why China is demanding GM-free declarations specifically from India and not from competitors like Thailand, Vietnam, Pakistan or Myanmar. He said China may be engaging in strategic trade planning regarding its rice supply.

Data show that India exported 1,80,805 tonnes of non-basmati rice worth $79.43 million to China in 2024-25. During the April-January period of the current fiscal year, the volume was higher at 1,86,013 tonnes, though the value was lower at $65.59 million. Because China previously restricted Indian rice through non-tariff barriers, exports were minimal until 2019-20, totalling only 567 tonnes, but surged to 3,31,571 tonnes in 2020-21 after the curbs were removed.

USDA data indicate that China's rice imports are estimated to rise to 3.1 mt in 2025-26 from 2.3 mt in 2024-25. Chandrasekaran said while India had deregulated certain modern breeding techniques to enhance climate resilience, China maintains a high-security, process-based approach that may view these techniques as a biosafety risk.

# *Zaid* crop coverage drops 2% as paddy acreage trails

Slip in area

(lakh hectare)

| | 2025* | 2026* | % Change |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Paddy** | **28.65** | **27.86** | **-2.8** |
| **Pulses** | **3.47** | **4.09** | **17.9** |
| Moong | 2.18 | 2.57 | 17.9 |
| Urad | 1.14 | 1.28 | 12.3 |
| **Nutri/Coarse Cereals** | **6.84** | **6.04** | **-11.7** |
| Bajra | 1.35 | 1.38 | 2.2 |
| Maize | 5 | 4.24 | -15.2 |
| **Oilseeds** | **4.73** | **4.69** | **-0.8** |
| Groundnut | 2.97 | 2.98 | 0.3 |
| Sesamum | 1.42 | 1.35 | -4.9 |
| **All crops** | **43.69** | **42.68** | **-2.3** |

*As of March 20

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

With a coverage of over 16 lakh hectares (lh) in the past month, sowing of summer (*zaid* season) crops, which will end by May, have reached 42.68 lh as of March 20. This is 2 per cent less than 43.69 lh reported in the year-ago period. The crop is grown before kharif sowing and after rabi harvest.

Though the area under pulses and bajra is up, they are not able to make up for the overall drop in summer acreage as both paddy and maize crop acreage is lower this time.

Farmers seemed to be opting for pulses as per the government plan as all the thrust is on crop diversification.

The government has fixed a target of 19.67 million tonnes (mt) of foodgrain production from the summer crops which include 12.15 mt of rice, 4 mt of maize, 1.14 mt of nutri cereals and 2.39 mt of pulses in the 2025-26 crop year (July-June). The target for bajra (millet) is set at 1.1 mt, urad (black gram) 0.32 mt, moong 2.07 mt and oilseeds 1.37 mt.

Last year, the summer season's production was 19.11 mt of foodgrains — 11.28 mt of rice, 3.85 mt of maize, 1.26 mt of nutri cereals and 2.72 mt of pulses. Besides, the output of bajra was 1.23 mt, urad 0.35 mt, moong 2.37 mt and oilseeds 1.33 mt.

The share of summer crops was 5.3 per cent in the total foodgrain production of 357.73 mt in 2024-25.

Per the weekly update released by the Agriculture Ministry, paddy sowing was down 3 per cent at 27.86 lh from 28.65 lh, while nutri/coarse cereals area was 12 per cent down at 6.04 lh against 6.84 lh year-ago.

Among the nutri/coarse cereals, maize area is 15 per cent lower at 4.24 lh from 5 lh, while bajra has reached 1.38 lh against 1.35 lh, and ragi and jowar are at 0.20 lh as of March 20.

**MP URAD BONUS**

Area under summer pulses reached 4.09 lh from 3.47 lh, in which coverage of moong reached 2.57 lh and urad 1.28 lh. The key growers of summer pulses are Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Odisha, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat.

Madhya Pradesh, the main producer of summer moong, recently announced a bonus on the urad crop grown in summer.

Announcing the bonus of ₹600 per quintal over and above the minimum support price (MSP) of ₹7,800/quintal for urad, the State government said the step was aimed at encouraging farmers to shift from moong during the summer (*zaid*) season.

# Chilli turns hot on strong domestic demand, low crop

**Vishwanath Kulkarni**
Bengaluru

Despite sluggish demand from the largest buyer China, dry red chilli prices are ruling high on strong domestic demand. This comes amidst a 20-30 per cent decline in the crop on lower acreage. Chinese buyers have largely stayed away from the Indian chilli market this year due to ample carry-forward stocks. However, strong demand from masala companies and a lower crop are keeping prices firm, trade sources said.

"China's demand is very low this year. Last year, up to March 31, about 9,000 containers of chillies were exported to China. This year only 2,000 containers have been exported," said Velagapudi Sambasiva Rao, President, Chilli Exporters Association, in Guntur.

However, the trade from North India and masala companies are purchasing in big quantities, he said, adding that arrivals are likely to extend till May on delayed sowing.

**PILED UP STOCKS**

Sandeep Voddepalli, General Manager, BigHaat Agro Pvt Ltd, said: "China is not buying much as compared to last year. In fact, in the last three months, it is almost 400 times lower than what they bought last year." China made large purchases last year and piled up huge stocks because last year the price was at ₹100-110 per kg.

Voddepalli said the chilli crop is short by almost 30-35 per cent and that's reflecting in the prices, which are running on an average of ₹200 per kg for the normal varieties such as Teja, 334 and 341, almost double than last year.

**LOWER BUY.** Chinese buyers have stayed away from the Indian chilli market this year due to ample carry-forward stocks

"We are expecting the crop to be completed by the end of April, mostly. And from June onwards, prices are expected to go up again. This is because the carryover stocks are very less. In fact, it is 35-40 per cent less than last year," Voddepalli said.

"Currently, we are not seeing any demand from the Europe, US or Thailand markets among others. We are expecting some demand from June," he said, adding that current active buyers include Bangladesh, Sri Lanka and Malaysia. Velagapudi expects Chinese demand to come later in the year.

**BYADGI CHILLI**

Prices of chillies that have high colour content, such as Byadgi varieties, have been ruling high since the beginning of the season this year on account of an around 40 per cent decline in production, said Basavaraj Hampali of Hampali Traders. Prices of the top quality Byadgi Dabbi variety are ruling at ₹62,000 per quintal, while KDL is ruling around ₹55,000, more than double over last year.

Overall chilli output for 2025-26 is seen lower by around a third on lower acreages as a section of farmers had shifted to crops like maize and pulses this year.

# Facing crisis, EU rice millers seek protection

**Subramani Ra Mancombu**
Chennai

The European Union (EU) may resort to imposing safeguard duties on rice imports, including from India, as it is under pressure from the rice industry that is facing a crisis.

Trade organisations, led by the Federation of Rice Millers (FERM), are seeking a review of the trade agreements with the EU and safeguard mechanisms to protect the domestic industry. They say EU rice production is becoming economically unviable, while producers and exporters are facing mounting burden that is crushing businesses.

According to EU agri-food group Copa-Cogeca, rice imports into the EU reached around 1.7 million tonnes a couple of weeks ago, with a significant share of the year's exports entering the EU market at reduced or zero tariffs under existing trade deals.

**ZERO TARIFFS.** Rice imports into the EU reached around 1.7 million tonnes a couple of weeks ago

**SENSITIVE PRODUCTS**

Led by Copa-Cogeca and backed by other trade groups, FERM has sought measures, particularly raising EU tariffs on imported rice, to protect the producers and processors.

At a meeting of the European Parliament and the European Council last week to discuss safeguard clauses of the EU's trade deals, it was resolved to protect sensitive products in the agriculture sector. This would be done by limiting preferences to tariff rate quotas.

The meeting listed a dozen sensitive items and included rice among them. "It is necessary to lay down procedures to guarantee the effective implementation of the bilateral safeguard clauses for agricultural products," the EU said.

S Chandrasekaran, an expert in trade and author of *Basmati Rice - The Natural History Geographical Indication*, said once imports reach about 5,52,000 tonnes (the baseline plus the 45 per cent surge), the safeguard mechanism would be triggered without needing a new legal investigation.

# US trade deal to increase agricultural exports in areas of strength, says Jitin Prasada

**Our Bureau**
Mangaluru

The Centre has said the recently announced trade deal with the US will provide opportunities to the farming sector to increase exports in its areas of strength.

In a written reply in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday, Jitin Prasada, Union Minister of State for Commerce and Industry, said the trade agreement with the US will provide opportunities to farmers and fishermen to enhance exports in their areas of strength, such as marine products, basmati rice, spices, tea and coffee, oilseeds and certain fruits.

It will also provide preferential tariff access to a big market for agro forestry-linked products, such as vegetable saps, waxes, nuts, plating material, coconut, poppy seeds, vegetables and certain roots, along with processed fruit products such as juices, pulp and jams.

Jitin Prasada, Union Minister of State for Commerce and Industry

The tariff concessions will create a conducive environment for farmers to sell to a huge American annual import market of more than ₹14 lakh crore, he said.

**FULLY PROTECTED**

India has fully protected its agricultural sectors through a carefully designed exclusion category, ensuring no tariff concessions are provided in the agreement on key products such as rice, wheat, poultry, dairy, soymeal, maize, millets, groundnuts, honey and tobacco. Overall, the terms of concessions are expected to benefit farmers and open new export opportunities, he said.

On products such as apples, walnuts and soybean oil, where India imports in significant quantities due to domestic demand exceeding production, concession is limited and quota-based so that imports help in diversification of sourcing. The quotas are well within current global imports so that supply gaps are met without adversely affecting farmers.

Similarly, in the backdrop of growing demand, animal feed-related products, such as DDGS and non-GM red sorghum, have been considered in limited quantities and with partial tariff concessions.

Cotton has been offered in a calibrated quota-based concession, considering India's existing trade pattern of both importing and exporting cotton and cotton products to meet quality requirements, he said.

# DeHaat rolls out NHB-supported grape cluster development scheme in Nashik

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Agritech firm DeHaat, in partnership with the National Horticulture Board (NHB), Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, has launched the Grapes Cluster Development Programme in Nashik. DeHaat has established export operations in Nashik under the Frestrop brand.

For grape growers in Nashik, the programme comes at a pivotal stage. As global demand increasingly shifts toward premium, differentiated varieties, early adopters of these new-generation, export-oriented varieties are likely to gain a clear advantage in market access, buyer preference and price realisation, the company said in a statement.

Global grape markets are increasingly moving toward premium, licensed varieties, while India remains largely dominated by traditional open varieties, such as Thompson Seedless.

This shift is redefining how farmers access high-value markets, with greater emphasis on varietal selection, quality consistency and traceability, the company said.

**FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE**

Ravindra Dangi, Deputy Director, National Horticulture Board, said the programme is structured to provide targeted financial assistance and end-to-end value chain support, enabling farmers to adopt improved practices and integrate more effectively with organised and export markets.

The programme will support farmers across key components, such as area expansion under new varieties, drip irrigation, GAP and IPM compliance, canopy and orchard rejuvenation, and post-harvest and export linkages. Financial assistance of up to 30–50 per cent will be available across eligible components, subject to applicable NHB cost norms and scheme guidelines.

Karen Smit-Lotriet of Bloom Fresh, sharing a global perspective, highlighted that international markets are increasingly favouring new-generation grape varieties that offer consistency, longer shelf life and consumer-preferred traits, making varietal transition important for long-term competitiveness.

DeHaat will implement the programme through its integrated Seeds to Market platform, combining advisory, input delivery, aggregation and market linkage capabilities, anchored by its export presence in Nashik, the company said.

# Aluminium futures: Go short at ₹330 and ₹332

**Gurumurthy K**
bl.research bureau

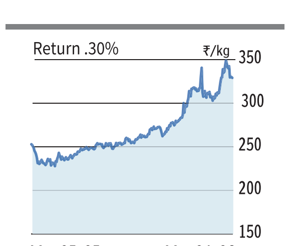
Aluminium prices are coming down for over a week now. The contract traded on the MCX made a high of ₹352 per kg earlier this month, on March 12.

**COMMODITY CALL.**

From there, the price has come down by over 6 per cent to ₹330 per kg now. There is room for the prices to fall more. For now, this just looks like a corrective fall within the broad uptrend. We will have to wait and watch.

The short-term picture looks weak. Key resistances are at ₹333 and ₹338. As long as the contract trades below ₹338, the downtrend will remain intact. The contract can fall to ₹320-317 in the coming days.

This ₹320-317 is an important support zone. A bounce from here can take the contract higher to ₹330-




335 again. That, in turn, will keep the broader uptrend intact. A break above ₹338 will then open the doors for a revisit of the ₹350 levels.

On the other hand, if the contract breaks below ₹317, it will come under more selling pressure. Then the contract can fall further to ₹305-302 thereafter. For now, allow for a fall to ₹320-317 and then watch the price action to see what happens.

**TRADE STRATEGY**

Traders can go short now at ₹330 and ₹332. Keep the stop-loss ₹337. Trail the stop-loss down to ₹328 as soon as the contract falls to ₹326. Revise the stop-loss down to ₹325 when the price touches ₹323. Exit the shorts at ₹320.

# Nutraceutical market set for exponential growth, says Synthite's Viju Jacob

**V Sajeev Kumar**
Kochi

The domestic nutraceuticals and food supplements sector is poised for exponential growth, with the market expected to reach ₹1.1 lakh crore by 2030, according to Viju Jacob, Executive Chairman of Synthite Industries.

The company, a global leader in spice oleoresins, entered the food supplements segment eight years ago with its brand NatXtra, and has since built a ₹70 crore business in this vertical.

**FOCUS ON GUT HEALTH**

Synthite has expanded its international footprint, with NatXtra products now available in Walmart stores in the US and across West Asia.

The brand has launched around 30 products, spanning multiple categories and has emerged as a market leader in the diabetic supplement segment, driven by its flagship product NatXtra Gymne-Mag D.

Viju Jacob, Executive Chairman, Synthite Industries

Strong digital marketing strategies have played a key role in NatXtra's growth.

While the company continues to scale globally, its primary focus remains on the Indian market, supported by rising health awareness and robust demand, he said, adding that the nutraceutical division is targeting a turnover of ₹400 crore within the next two years.

NatXtra has also entered the fast-growing gummy supplements category with products focused on *ashwagandha*, gut health, PCOS and vitamin C.

The gut health segment, in particular, has emerged as a top-performing category.

The global gut health market is valued at $18.36 billion and is projected to exceed $36 billion by 2033, driven by growing awareness of the importance of gut health in overall wellbeing, he said.

The PCOS category is another major focus area, reflecting the increasing need to address women's health through targeted nutritional solutions.

Each NatXtra product is science-backed and research-driven, supported by Synthite's strong foundation, FDA-approved facilities, and world-class R&D capabilities of over 50 years.

"The awareness about the need for food supplements, which began in the West several years ago, is now rapidly catching up in the domestic market as well. Modern lifestyles, which are characterised by irregular eating habits and reduced exposure to sunlight, have created a growing need for supplementation. Indian consumers are increasingly recognizing this need," said Jacob.

## QUICKLY.

**NTPC Green inks MoU with Nxtra Data for RE supply**

**Mumbai:** NTPC Green Energy Ltd (NGEL) has signed a memorandum of understanding with Nxtra Data Ltd on Tuesday to develop renewable energy projects for supplying round-the-clock (RTC) power to Nxtra's data centres across India. Under the MoU, the two companies will explore business opportunities for developing renewable energy projects to meet Nxtra's captive power requirements on a pan-India basis. OUR BUREAU

**Euler Motors raises ₹437.5 cr in funding round**

**New Delhi:** Electric commercial vehicle maker Euler Motors said it has raised ₹437.5 crore ($47 million) in a funding round led by Lightrock, with participation from existing investors Hero MotoCorp and Blume Ventures. The Series E round also had an additional ₹250 crore of debt funding from BlackSoil, Trifecta, InnoVen and Alteria Capital, the company said in a statement. PTI

# Oppn calls for all-party meet on govt's plan for 33% reservation for women

**DELIMITATION TOO.** Once Bill is amended, the number of Parliament seats will increase to 816 from 543

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

The Opposition parties have sought an all-party meeting to discuss the government move to bring in a constitutional amendment to the Nari Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023, (Women's Reservation Bill) to provide 33 per cent reservation to women in Parliament ahead of the 2029 general elections.

The move comes as Union Home Minister Amit Shah reached out to opposition leaders on Monday to discuss the Nari Shakti Vandan Act amendment and for carrying out delimitation exercise for redrawing constituency boundaries and seat redistribution on the basis of Census 2011, and not the proposed 2027 Census.

This would take the strength of the Lok Sabha from 543 to 816 to accommodate reserved seats for women MPs.

The Phase 1 House listing and Housing Census will begin from April 1, 2026, and get completed by September 30, 2026.

### WORKING TOGETHER

Following the opposition leaders' meeting on Tuesday to opt for a combined strategy on the issue ahead of polls to the Assembly elections, including West Bengal and Tamil Nadu, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge wrote to Union Minister for Parliamentary Affairs Kiren Rijiju urging for an all-party meeting to ascertain the government's latest plan on Nari Vandan Adhiniyam, passed in September 2023.

Kharge demanded that the government should circulate a note on the exact proposals to make the meeting productive.

**SEEKING CLARITY.** Through the letter, Mallikarjun Kharge demanded that the government circulate a note on the exact proposals to make the meeting productive ANI

He also requested the government that the all-party meeting be held after the current round of Assembly elections.

Other than amending the Nari Vandan Adhiniyam, the government is learnt to be contemplating bringing in a separate delimitation Bill, with both legislation seeking constitutional amendments for providing reservation to women.

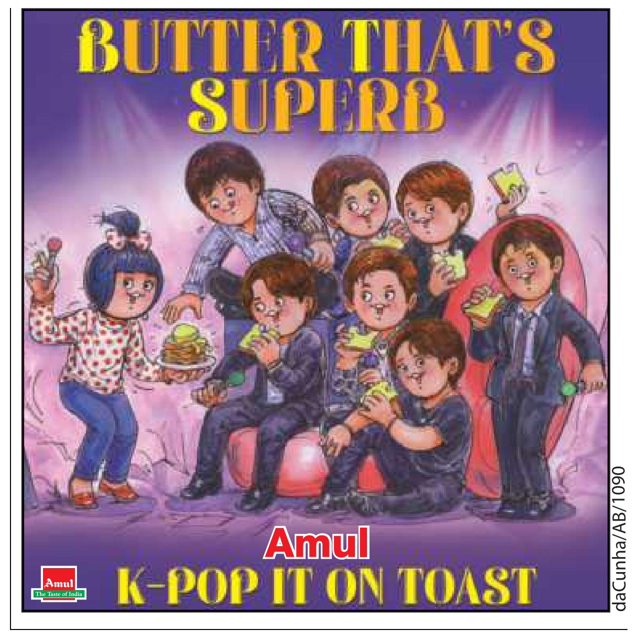
### TN CONCERNED

Raising concerns over the government initiative, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister and DMK leader MK Stalin said recent news reports indicated that women's representation in Parliament and the Legislative Assemblies is being considered based on the 2011 Census.

"This step is not in line with The Constitution (128th Amendment) Bill, 2023, passed by the Union BJP Government and its earlier position to take up this historic initiative only after delimitation is carried out based on the Census conducted after 2026," Stalin posted on X.

"This is most probably aimed at securing electoral gains in the forthcoming Assembly elections in four major States. Pushing such an important step when the Model Code of Conduct is already in force is unprecedented," he added.

"Having said that, as the President of the DMK and the proud inheritor of the Dravidian legacy that has spearheaded women's empowerment for more than a century, I fully support this initiative of #WomensReservation without any preconditions, while at the same time stressing our right to fair delimitation," the TN Chief Minister observed.




# No person other than a Hindu, Buddhist, Sikh can claim Scheduled Caste status: SC

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday held in a judgment that a person professing any religion other than Hinduism, Buddhism or Sikhism should not be considered a member of a Schedule Caste community.

The court concluded that conversion to any other religion would result in "immediate and complete loss of Scheduled Caste status from the moment of conversion, regardless of birth".

### CLAUSE INVOKED

A Bench of Justices

Prashant Kumar Mishra and NV Anjaria invoked Clause 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950, which mandates that "no person who professes a religion different from Hinduism shall be deemed to be a member of a Scheduled Caste".

"This bar under Clause 3

> **The court held that conversion to any other religion would result in "immediate and complete loss of Scheduled Caste status from the moment of conversion"**

of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 is categorical and absolute," Justice Mishra, who authored the judgment, said.

The court was hearing an appeal filed by Chinthada Anand, who was born a Hindu-Madiga (Scheduled Caste) but converted to Christianity to become a pastor. Anand had filed a case under the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act of 1989 after he alleged to have suffered repeated attacks and caste slurs.

The Andhra Pradesh High Court, in a decision in April last year, quashed the criminal proceedings on the ground that Anand could no longer claim protection under the 1989 Act as he professed Christianity and had been a pastor for about a decade. The High Court was of the view that the caste system was not recognised in Christianity.

Confirming the High Court decision in the appeal filed by Anand, the top court drew attention to the term 'profess' in Clause 3 of the 1950 Order.

"The term 'profess' connotes to publicly declare or practice a religion. The essence of the word lies in the open avowal of one's religious beliefs in a manner discernible to the public at large. It is not merely a question of personal belief or private conviction, but requires an outward manifestation of one's faith. It may be observed that Christianity, by its very theological foundation, does not recognise or incorporate the institution of caste," Justice Mishra said, agreeing with the High Court.

### ELIGIBILITY DENIED

The top court said a convert who did not profess any of the three religions — Hinduism, Buddhism and Sikhism — in Clause 3 of the 1950 Order could not claim any "statutory benefit, protection, reservation or entitlement" of a Scheduled Caste member. Justice Mishra said the bar admitted no exception.

A person cannot simultaneously profess and practice a religion other than the ones specified in Clause 3 and claim membership of a Scheduled Caste at the same time, the court said.

# Stick to delivery timelines, tap exports, CDS Anil Chauhan tells the defence industry

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

Chief of Defence Staff General Anil Chauhan urged the defence industry to focus on timely and priority delivery of contracts, which is "critical to strengthening operational preparedness".

In an interaction with defence industry representatives organised by the Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM), General Chauhan underlined that the present geopolitical environment remains dynamic and increasingly complex, as per a statement by the CII.

### UNIFIED APPROACH

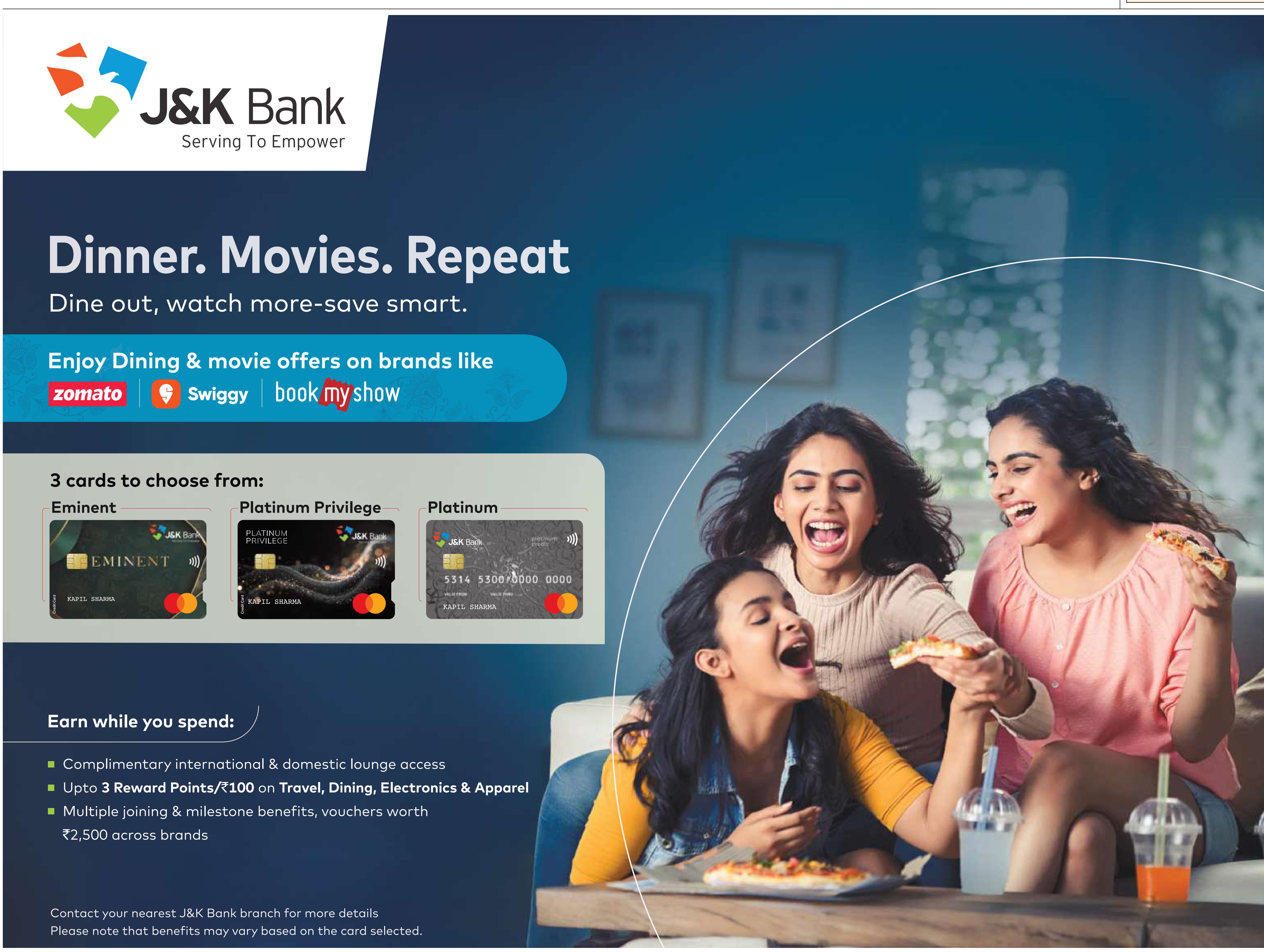
Highlighting the importance of a unified effort, the CDS stressed the need for a whole-of-nation approach towards national security. He encouraged industry to actively leverage emerging export opportunities arising from the evolving geopolitical scenario and position itself as a reliable global partner.

A key takeaway from the interaction was the emphasis on joint ventures as a gateway for Indian companies to access and expand into markets across Europe and West Asia. The leadership highlighted that collaborative models will be instrumental in building scale, capability and global competitiveness.

The session served as a direct outreach by the tri-services, enabling clear articulation of their forward-looking requirements and strategic priorities. These insights were shared with Defence Public Sector Undertakings, foreign OEMs, and Indian industry representatives.

The interaction was attended by Samir V Kamat, Secretary, DD(R&D) and Chairman, DRDO, and Air Marshal PK Vhora, Deputy Chief of Integrated Defence Staff (Policy Planning & Force Development).





CHENNAI
businessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25 - 2026

# Presumption about short careers hurting women officers, says SC

**FIGHTING BIAS.** Ruling affirms women's right to equal opportunities and permanent commission

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday declared that systemic and long-held presumption that women officers had no substantive or long-term career in the armed forces led to an uneven playing field, crippling their chances for permanent commission.

A three-judge Bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, upheld permanent commission and consequent pensionary benefits for batches of women officers in the Indian Army, the Indian Air Force and the Indian Navy. The court upheld the women officers' right to equal opportunity and treatment and dignity in three separate judgments, all authored by the Chief Justice.

The appellant-women officers were represented by senior advocates Rekha Palli, V Mohana and Menaka Guruswamy, and advocates

**EQUAL RIGHTS.** The Supreme Court said women officers were routinely assigned "average or middling scores"

Pooja Dhar, Abhimanue Shrestha, Anshuman Ashok and Sudhanshu S Pandey. Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati represented the Centre.

### CAREER PROGRESSION

The judgment found that the annual confidential reports (ACRs) of Short Service Commission Women Officers (SSCWOs) were graded casually for years, without adjudging their suitability for career progression, affecting their overall comparative merit with their male counterparts.

"Since they (SSCWOs) had no scope for career progression, the assessing officers graded their ACRs casually and gave them lower scores," Chief Justice Kant observed.

"This assumption resulted in a casual approach towards assessment, with higher grades being informally reserved for male SSCOs who were eligible for permanent commission (PC) and for whom such grades would materially affect their future prospects," he said.

The Supreme Court said women officers were routinely assigned "average or middling scores".

The cumulative consequence of the systemic low grading given to them found them in dire straits when events led to the Supreme Court's multiple interventions and judgments upholding SSCWOs' rights.

"This phenomenon (low grading) came back to haunt the SSCWOs as they were subsequently and quite abruptly placed in a competition for PC with their male counterparts, who did not undergo such hindrances in grading over the course of their decade-long service. It is, therefore, not surprising to us that the differential treatment meted out to officers 'with a future' in the Army and those deemed to be without one has resulted in an unequal playing field," Chief Justice Kant observed.

### SERVICE PROFILE

The Chief Justice agreed with the SSCWOs that they were neither incentivised nor recommended for various career-enhancing courses during their service. The result was a diminished service profile.

"The inclusion of SSCWOs in the zone of consideration for PC is not a matter of discretion, but of constitutional obligation. Any expectation to the contrary is inherently illegitimate," the top court held.

### VACANCY CAP

"In the instant case, when SSCWOs have been found to suffer the cumulative effects of an unfair evaluative regime, the invocation of the vacancy cap as a shield against remedial action would be unfair to sustain. Owing to this, the respondents' (Union government) plea regarding the sanctity of the ceiling on vacancies falls flat," Chief Justice Kant noted. It said the armed forces need not hold any annual cap on PC vacancies "neither sacrosanct nor immutable".

# Agnikul test-fires pioneering 3D printed booster engine

**Sindhu Hariharan**
**Rohan Das**
Chennai

Chennai-based Agnikul Cosmos has successfully test-fired Agnite, a first-of-its-kind, fully 3D printed, more powerful booster-stage engine. The tested engine is a full metre long — the largest Inconel rocket engine ever built as a single piece and the first of its scale to be tested with electric motor-driven pumps, Agnikul said.

Validated at the space tech start-up's in-house test facility in Chennai, this milestone will now support faster launch readiness and consistent execution. Bigger than the company's previous models, Agnite is meant for the more demanding lower stages of rocket launches.

Speaking to *businessline*, Srinath Ravichandran, Co-founder and CEO of Agnikul Cosmos, said Agnite is the world's first fully 3D-printed lower stage engine.

"The 3D printed single piece architecture means that production time can be reduced to as low as seven days, enabling faster response to customer launch demand. 3D printing also means the repeatability in building these engines increases, which is an important metric in this industry," he said. "Traditional engines take months to build due to the machining, welding, assembly and other processes," he added.

The engine also comes with electric motor pumps, which according to Ravichandran, will give better control over the engine, leading to a more precise orbital injection of the payloads.



# Railways set for new refund rules to tackle black tickets

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

In a significant development, the government has announced that passengers will soon be able to change their train boarding station up to 30 minutes before departure.

This initiative, coupled with a revamped refund system, aims to curb last-minute speculative bookings and prioritise genuine travellers by ensuring ticket availability at no additional cost.

The steps are part of the five new reforms under 'Reform Express' — Cargo, Construction, and Passenger Convenience in Focus — announced by the government on Tuesday.

### PUBLIC CONVENIENCE

These are in line with the Railways' resolve to undertake reforms during 2026, and with the approval of these new reforms, the total number of reforms for the year 2026 has reached nine.

"Under the ongoing 'Reform Express' initiative, four

**REFORM PUSH.** The Railways said counter tickets can now be cancelled from any railway station in the country

reforms had already been announced and five new reforms are being introduced. Out of the five new reforms, two are related to cargo, one to construction and two to passenger convenience," Ashwini Vaishnaw, Minister for Railways, said.

On ticket cancellation and refund, he said ticket black marketing and misuse of the Tatkal system had been a major concern.

To address this, the earlier cancellation time windows of 48, 12 and 4 hours before departure have been revised to 72, 24 and 8 hours, aligned with the advance preparation of reservation charts, which now happens 9-18 hours before departure instead of 4 hours.

### NEW REFUND TIERS

Under the revised cancellation system, passengers cancelling tickets more than 72 hours before departure will receive the maximum refund, with only a flat cancellation charge per passenger applied. For cancellation made between 72 hours and 24 hours, 25 per cent of the fare will be deducted, subject to the minimum charge. The penalty increases for late cancellations. If a ticket is cancelled between 24 hours and 8 hours before departure, 50 per cent of the fare will be deducted, subject to the minimum charge. For cancellation made less than 8 hours before departure, no refund will be permitted.

"This will be done at no extra cost from passengers. Advance reservation charts improves passenger convenience by reducing uncertainty, enabling better planning for waitlisted travellers and supporting passengers from remote locations. Early charting allows alternative travel arrangements, optimises vacant berth utilisation and boosts transparency," he said.

### CANCEL ANYWHERE

The Minister also announced that soon counter tickets can be cancelled from any railway station across the country, removing the earlier restriction of cancellation only at the originating station.

He said the requirement of filing a Ticket Deposit Receipt (TDR) for e-tickets has been removed, and refunds will now be processed automatically upon cancellation.

In another passenger measure, passengers can now upgrade their travel class up to 30 minutes before departure, whereas earlier changes were restricted to before chart preparation.

### BOARDING DECISION

In another reform, passengers can change their boarding station digitally up to 30 minutes before departure of the train from its origin station.

Under the new provision, if a passenger is unable to board from the original station, they can select the next convenient station and board the train without losing their confirmed seat.

In the reform in automobile transportation, Vaishnaw said the Railways is allowing special wagon designs while giving flexibility to the industry. Manufacturers can now design wagons based on specific origin-destination routes with high capacity.

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| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Gific Bio Sc [1] | 281.45 | 278.95 | 283.50 | 290.40 | 273.40 | 88.66 | 409.00 | 268.65 | 55 | 281.45 |
| Gillette (I) | 7788.00 | 7725.50 | 7978.00 | 7978.00 | 7685.50 | 38.21 | 11505.00 | 7551.05 | 41 | 7745.95 |
| Ginni Filamm | 35.99 | 36.13 | 37.00 | 37.42 | 35.14 | 75.77 | 57.71 | 18.94 | 6 | 36.11 |
| GK Energy L | 98.12 | 100.69 | 102.00 | 102.46 | 98.51 | 965.79 | 239.60 | 96.01 | - | - |
| Gland Pharma | 1612.50 | 1670.20 | 1630.30 | 1679.60 | 1616.30 | 83.88 | 2131.00 | 1277.80 | - | - |
| Glaxo Pharma | 2279.20 | 2309.10 | 2301.00 | 2340.00 | 2284.60 | 51.35 | 3515.95 | 2220.00 | 39 | 2308.00 |
| Glenmark P [1] | 2089.00 | 2095.70 | 2103.00 | 2137.10 | 2078.30 | 540.49 | 2297.20 | 1336.95 | 40 | 2096.20 |
| Glo.Surfaces | 54.77 | 53.66 | 54.00 | 56.00 | 52.05 | 269.57 | 144.40 | 52.05 | - | - |
| Global Hlth | 969.60 | 973.80 | 999.00 | 1010.00 | 971.40 | 507.03 | 1456.50 | 965.00 | - | - |
| GLOBE INTL C | 39.13 | 31.36 | 40.00 | 40.99 | 31.31 | 1076.29 | 52.40 | 31.31 | - | - |
| GLOBUS SPR | 858.65 | 889.15 | 867.25 | 898.00 | 846.30 | 73.03 | 1303.95 | 802.15 | 32 | 888.60 |
| Glottis Ltd | 40.78 | 40.68 | 41.94 | 42.40 | 40.16 | 213.73 | 93.00 | 40.16 | - | - |
| GM Breweri | 991.55 | 1039.00 | 1020.00 | 1059.30 | 1002.50 | 147.84 | 1328.00 | 591.05 | 14 | 1039.95 |
| GMM Pfaud [2] | 821.00 | 831.40 | 829.45 | 838.70 | 816.00 | 71.46 | 1416.30 | 810.05 | 54 | 832.65 |
| GMR Airports | 84.77 | 89.02 | 88.00 | 90.34 | 86.95 | 15094.84 | 110.36 | 74.96 | - | - |
| GMR P&U Inf. | 100.19 | 100.69 | 102.49 | 104.90 | 100.02 | 1616.57 | 141.01 | 97.22 | - | - |
| GNA | 355.90 | 371.85 | 362.00 | 377.40 | 362.00 | 68.14 | 470.70 | 269.80 | 14 | 371.05 |
| GNFC | 383.45 | 391.10 | 390.70 | 396.00 | 384.35 | 368.36 | 573.25 | 380.25 | 9 | 390.35 |
| GNG Elect | 374.15 | 390.20 | 389.00 | 392.85 | 379.00 | 292.36 | 401.70 | 239.00 | - | - |
| Go Digit | 324.25 | 322.75 | 330.35 | 330.40 | 318.35 | 129.18 | 381.40 | 264.60 | - | - |
| GO Fashion | 254.60 | 266.45 | 257.45 | 278.80 | 255.45 | 638.64 | 943.75 | 237.05 | - | - |
| GOCL Corp [2] | 225.00 | 264.25 | 247.10 | 270.00 | 247.10 | 6688.04 | 417.00 | 223.60 | 9 | 264.45 |
| Godavari Bio | 302.35 | 307.75 | 309.00 | 314.70 | 302.55 | 254.79 | 348.70 | 145.00 | - | - |
| Godawari [1] | 251.85 | 263.40 | 259.50 | 264.85 | 251.45 | 2274.33 | 290.00 | 170.00 | 22 | 263.60 |
| Godfrey Phil [2] | 1844.00 | 1897.50 | 1901.00 | 1912.70 | 1846.50 | 388.12 | 3945.00 | 1832.65 | 23 | 1897.60 |
| Godrej Agro | 552.50 | 557.20 | 557.95 | 567.95 | 542.90 | 175.23 | 876.30 | 506.70 | 20 | 559.30 |
| Godrej Con [1] | 1002.40 | 1006.90 | 1016.00 | 1027.80 | 999.10 | 1683.09 | 1308.40 | 988.00 | 74 | 1007.15 |
| Godrej Ind [1] | 786.85 | 791.20 | 795.90 | 803.45 | 775.90 | 80.30 | 1391.50 | 774.05 | - | 791.80 |
| Godrej prop [5] | 1497.20 | 1540.50 | 1525.00 | 1562.00 | 1518.30 | 715.59 | 2505.00 | 1476.05 | 111 | 1540.75 |
| Gokaldas [5] | 563.40 | 595.25 | 592.00 | 609.95 | 567.30 | 949.01 | 1060.00 | 531.60 | 23 | 595.10 |
| Gokul Agro [1] | 178.36 | 186.30 | 181.99 | 189.00 | 178.50 | 1094.75 | 221.40 | 96.00 | 22 | 186.15 |
| Goldiam Int [2] | 281.95 | 286.75 | 292.30 | 294.00 | 277.25 | 504.90 | 444.35 | 252.00 | 77 | 286.60 |
| Good Luck S [2] | 919.80 | 972.70 | 956.00 | 993.00 | 936.70 | 140.06 | 1352.80 | 608.00 | 19 | 969.30 |
| Gopal Snacks | 258.35 | 262.40 | 261.55 | 264.60 | 257.90 | 216.00 | 398.00 | 255.90 | - | - |
| GPPL | 144.07 | 148.20 | 147.58 | 149.40 | 146.31 | 1196.59 | 200.00 | 121.30 | 16 | 148.10 |
| GPT Health. | 118.85 | 119.27 | 120.60 | 122.00 | 118.45 | 105.16 | 185.00 | 118.00 | - | - |
| GPT Infra | 100.50 | 103.62 | 106.00 | 106.00 | 100.34 | 312.84 | 149.75 | 96.00 | 14 | 103.95 |
| GR Infrapro | 844.50 | 822.00 | 899.25 | 920.00 | 808.00 | 1972.91 | 1444.40 | 808.00 | - | - |
| Granules Ind [1] | 580.15 | 606.35 | 589.00 | 610.00 | 574.55 | 1179.61 | 627.45 | 412.05 | 38 | 608.55 |
| Graphite [2] | 563.70 | 570.85 | 576.00 | 580.00 | 558.95 | 781.85 | 747.00 | 413.00 | 27 | 570.85 |
| Grasim Ind. [2] | 2531.10 | 2549.40 | 2565.50 | 2600.70 | 2523.00 | 2303.24 | 2980.05 | 2464.80 | 450 | 2545.85 |
| Gravita Ind [2] | 1306.70 | 1392.70 | 1349.00 | 1416.90 | 1320.20 | 553.08 | 2169.90 | 1291.85 | 34 | 1391.70 |
| Great Easte | 1360.00 | 1398.70 | 1405.00 | 1418.10 | 1373.00 | 558.25 | 1509.15 | 817.20 | 12 | 1397.80 |
| Greaves Cot [2] | 128.01 | 131.60 | 131.50 | 132.85 | 127.63 | 1785.03 | 244.55 | 126.60 | 13 | 131.40 |
| Green pwr | 8.72 | 8.91 | 8.90 | 9.44 | 8.77 | 4466.42 | 15.80 | 8.70 | - | 8.91 |
| Greenlam [1] | 204.38 | 212.63 | 211.90 | 215.00 | 204.15 | 26.80 | 279.95 | 187.00 | 40 | 211.90 |
| Greenpanel I | 178.68 | 180.64 | 180.05 | 182.72 | 177.56 | 107.75 | 335.20 | 177.40 | - | - |
| Greenply Ind [1] | 181.14 | 194.14 | 184.60 | 195.60 | 182.82 | 323.93 | 351.55 | 179.10 | 28 | 193.95 |
| Grind Nor [5] | 1364.20 | 1385.10 | 1374.80 | 1391.70 | 1355.40 | 30.70 | 1881.35 | 1330.00 | 40 | 1382.00 |
| GRM Overseas | 152.12 | 149.61 | 153.60 | 153.61 | 137.75 | 1876.31 | 517.70 | 137.75 | - | - |
| GRSE | 2136.20 | 2155.00 | 2200.00 | 2249.00 | 2120.50 | 1178.82 | 3535.00 | 1366.05 | 36 | 2154.70 |
| GSFC [2] | 147.02 | 148.43 | 149.80 | 151.11 | 145.38 | 1273.00 | 220.75 | 145.50 | 9 | 148.60 |
| GSP CROP SC | 320.00 | 356.25 | 328.00 | 364.00 | 328.00 | 8598.10 | 364.00 | 328.00 | - | - |
| GTL Infra | 0.99 | 1.02 | 1.02 | 1.04 | 0.99 | 51889.38 | 2.16 | 0.98 | - | 1.02 |
| GTPL | 57.09 | 57.06 | 57.55 | 58.46 | 56.62 | 784.61 | 133.75 | 55.22 | 28 | 56.80 |
| Guj Apollo | 427.10 | 422.95 | 435.00 | 438.95 | 408.90 | 27.91 | 555.00 | 294.30 | - | 423.95 |
| Guj Fluoro | 3248.20 | 3199.10 | 3284.00 | 3300.00 | 3181.00 | 82.17 | 4083.55 | 2916.60 | - | - |
| Guj Petronet | 235.30 | 231.25 | 240.45 | 243.00 | 230.10 | 677.60 | 360.00 | 230.30 | 18 | 231.35 |
| Guj. Alkali | 615.10 | 625.95 | 610.10 | 669.30 | 585.10 | 51038.03 | 700.00 | 410.00 | 134 | 627.85 |
| Guj. Mineral [2] | 569.05 | 574.00 | 584.00 | 587.45 | 566.55 | 3569.63 | 651.45 | 251.65 | 28 | 573.50 |
| Gujarat Amb [1] | 127.98 | 128.71 | 129.10 | 133.00 | 127.16 | 514.78 | 149.45 | 101.40 | 29 | 128.55 |
| Gujarat Gas [2] | 335.30 | 328.65 | 342.10 | 346.45 | 327.05 | 2429.15 | 508.60 | 327.30 | 20 | 328.45 |
| Gujarat Hea | 422.00 | 429.10 | 426.60 | 436.20 | 419.45 | 223.50 | 668.00 | 419.15 | 8 | 429.85 |
| Gujarat Kidn | 101.79 | 102.20 | 103.25 | 103.94 | 101.32 | 266.55 | 123.00 | 98.36 | - | - |
| Gujarat Them | 258.30 | 264.35 | 265.00 | 271.00 | 260.00 | 314.71 | 479.00 | 222.05 | - | - |
| GujIndl Pow | 126.78 | 128.94 | 129.00 | 130.36 | 127.10 | 528.43 | 224.00 | 125.70 | 14 | 129.10 |
| Gulf oil Lub [2] | 870.20 | 929.70 | 885.80 | 942.30 | 875.60 | 115.45 | 1331.20 | 864.50 | 12 | 928.85 |
| Gulshan P [1] | 141.88 | 144.96 | 145.00 | 148.39 | 142.03 | 132.90 | 220.00 | 121.75 | 12 | 144.10 |
| **H** | | | | | | | | | | |
| HAL [5] | 3634.60 | 3654.00 | 3700.00 | 3723.30 | 3620.70 | 1309.46 | 5166.00 | 3610.00 | 28 | 3651.85 |
| Handson GBL | 53.85 | 53.27 | 59.99 | 60.80 | 52.31 | 227.28 | 82.40 | 42.70 | - | - |
| Happi.Minds | 392.65 | 399.40 | 400.45 | 405.90 | 385.25 | 1870.41 | 674.85 | 330.20 | - | - |
| HappyForging | 1208.50 | 1203.00 | 1225.00 | 1248.90 | 1185.60 | 50.04 | 1370.00 | 724.10 | - | - |
| Hariom Pipe | 302.90 | 310.00 | 309.45 | 316.60 | 304.05 | 115.52 | 572.20 | 298.55 | - | - |
| Harsha Eng | 328.25 | 333.15 | 335.00 | 346.15 | 325.25 | 33.24 | 451.85 | 323.10 | - | - |
| HATHWAY [2] | 9.31 | 9.45 | 9.37 | 9.60 | 9.26 | 2666.12 | 17.95 | 9.25 | - | 9.41 |
| HATSUN A [1] | 890.15 | 924.65 | 907.00 | 937.45 | 899.10 | 29.81 | 1178.80 | 731.05 | 54 | 923.85 |
| Havell's Ind [1] | 1231.00 | 1234.20 | 1249.40 | 1261.00 | 1221.00 | 561.10 | 1673.20 | 1217.50 | 51 | 1234.20 |
| HBL Engg L | 625.60 | 660.25 | 640.00 | 667.50 | 639.00 | 2485.44 | 1122.00 | 440.10 | - | - |
| HCG | 521.75 | 527.15 | 527.50 | 544.00 | 524.10 | 116.77 | 799.35 | 497.72 | 296 | 526.50 |
| HCL Infosys [2] | 10.84 | 10.78 | 11.44 | 11.44 | 10.37 | 887.85 | 24.39 | 10.60 | - | 10.81 |
| HCL Tech. [2] | 1358.60 | 1373.30 | 1380.00 | 1394.00 | 1360.00 | 3555.66 | 1770.00 | 1275.70 | 30 | 1373.35 |
| HDB FinSer | 606.50 | 605.45 | 614.85 | 614.85 | 590.20 | 1861.78 | 891.90 | 590.20 | - | - |
| HDFC Bank [1] | 744.15 | 764.90 | 755.00 | 772.75 | 747.70 | 61269.99 | 1020.35 | 740.95 | 16 | 765.15 |
| HDFCAMC [5] | 2254.60 | 2351.70 | 2300.00 | 2361.70 | 2284.30 | 822.86 | 2965.00 | 1762.53 | 35 | 2352.60 |
| HDFCLIFE | 592.10 | 603.00 | 597.00 | 607.65 | 590.05 | 3644.51 | 820.50 | 583.95 | 69 | 603.30 |
| HEG [2] | 477.25 | 488.35 | 488.00 | 494.80 | 482.55 | 680.50 | 672.20 | 405.40 | 33 | 488.40 |
| HEIDEL CEM | 148.25 | 149.52 | 151.70 | 151.70 | 146.41 | 104.45 | 224.60 | 141.95 | 24 | 149.05 |
| Hemisphere | 126.99 | 127.99 | 128.60 | 130.20 | 127.02 | 623.79 | 190.69 | 111.03 | - | - |
| Heranba Ind | 169.90 | 174.75 | 171.00 | 176.80 | 169.55 | 76.35 | 403.70 | 167.00 | - | - |
| HeritageFo [5] | 301.10 | 308.85 | 307.00 | 312.00 | 302.30 | 210.29 | 541.60 | 296.15 | 20 | 308.55 |
| Hero Moto [2] | 5065.00 | 5253.00 | 5185.00 | 5317.00 | 5124.50 | 435.05 | 6390.00 | 3322.60 | 21 | 5252.00 |
| HexawareTech | 436.00 | 437.15 | 450.00 | 461.00 | 427.25 | 616.06 | 900.00 | 400.20 | - | - |
| HG Infra | 467.60 | 474.35 | 485.95 | 485.95 | 467.70 | 320.18 | 1272.10 | 457.90 | 7 | 474.25 |
| HGSL | 354.05 | 353.40 | 355.55 | 360.90 | 351.00 | 52.55 | 628.80 | 341.60 | - | 353.00 |
| Highway Infr | 46.00 | 47.21 | 46.50 | 47.50 | 46.25 | 292.37 | 131.40 | 45.75 | - | - |
| Hikal [2] | 156.53 | 161.93 | 160.91 | 163.20 | 155.16 | 483.76 | 456.60 | 155.15 | 80 | 161.95 |
| HILTON MET | 14.52 | 14.38 | 15.00 | 15.23 | 13.43 | 400.55 | 70.69 | 13.50 | 10 | 14.46 |
| HIMACHAL F [1] | 66.49 | 69.58 | 68.10 | 70.39 | 66.55 | 18090.05 | 93.95 | 59.83 | - | 69.74 |
| Himadri Sp [1] | 438.15 | 445.65 | 439.85 | 451.90 | 431.00 | 3325.54 | 534.35 | 351.40 | 31 | 446.05 |
| Himat.Seide [5] | 73.25 | 76.14 | 76.00 | 77.65 | 74.13 | 791.60 | 168.85 | 73.00 | 6 | 75.90 |
| Hind Rectifi [2] | 1435.30 | 1512.60 | 1479.00 | 1521.20 | 1455.00 | 43.33 | 2101.00 | 817.25 | 50 | 1509.95 |
| Hind Uni [1] | 2052.20 | 2085.00 | 2070.00 | 2115.00 | 2066.00 | 1702.42 | 2734.31 | 2033.00 | 46 | 2084.70 |
| HIND.CONST [1] | 14.23 | 14.69 | 14.79 | 14.84 | 14.24 | 23607.53 | 31.47 | 14.17 | 11 | 14.68 |
| HIND.COPP [5] | 449.15 | 463.55 | 463.60 | 468.55 | 447.00 | 10804.36 | 759.20 | 183.90 | 67 | 463.55 |
| Hind.Foods | 467.15 | 497.30 | 472.40 | 507.95 | 465.15 | 142.34 | 608.00 | 421.50 | - | - |
| Hind.oil Exp | 122.26 | 125.94 | 122.61 | 127.20 | 121.14 | 1262.79 | 197.80 | 117.90 | 9 | 125.65 |
| Hind.Zinc [2] | 487.65 | 497.05 | 499.00 | 501.55 | 484.75 | 8285.87 | 732.60 | 385.05 | 18 | 497.05 |
| HINDALCO [1] | 840.25 | 854.65 | 849.00 | 864.50 | 843.50 | 3526.97 | 1029.60 | 546.25 | 22 | 854.55 |
| Hindware HME | 180.69 | 172.94 | 186.69 | 186.69 | 170.55 | 670.63 | 392.70 | 170.55 | - | - |
| Hitech Pipes | 72.01 | 77.21 | 73.45 | 77.80 | 72.60 | 1247.68 | 235.00 | 117.30 | 30 | 136.50 |
| HLE Glascoat | 277.35 | 278.20 | 285.05 | 286.00 | 272.20 | 110.08 | 661.95 | 230.00 | - | - |
| HLV | 6.60 | 6.63 | 6.80 | 6.86 | 6.54 | 474.98 | 15.75 | 6.45 | - | - |
| Home FirstFi | 905.20 | 929.50 | 920.10 | 932.90 | 897.00 | 280.93 | 1519.00 | 878.40 | - | - |
| Honasa Cons. | 281.05 | 288.30 | 282.60 | 292.00 | 280.35 | 359.82 | 334.20 | 212.51 | - | - |
| Honda Siel | 1951.70 | 2009.30 | 1978.00 | 2047.00 | 1930.50 | 10.96 | 3251.00 | 1827.20 | 25 | 2000.80 |
| HONEYWELL | 27215.00 | 27640.00 | 27600.00 | 27985.00 | 26955.00 | 4.67 | 41599.80 | 27000.00 | 48 | 27635.55 |
| HPCL | 319.15 | 336.80 | 331.00 | 338.45 | 319.60 | 11512.64 | 508.45 | 316.20 | 5 | 336.85 |
| HPL | 269.15 | 280.75 | 276.70 | 283.40 | 269.00 | 246.10 | 639.50 | 265.90 | 20 | 280.40 |
| Hubtown | 184.85 | 185.81 | 189.80 | 192.08 | 183.50 | 777.38 | 366.00 | 149.90 | 22 | 185.75 |
| HUDCO | 165.11 | 169.16 | 168.80 | 169.69 | 164.87 | 3053.83 | 253.80 | 164.15 | 12 | 169.20 |
| Huhtamaki In | 153.60 | 162.33 | 154.00 | 163.70 | 154.00 | 205.45 | 272.65 | 151.70 | - | - |
| HyundaiMotor | 1867.50 | 1859.50 | 1882.60 | 1887.00 | 1826.00 | 620.47 | 2890.00 | 1541.70 | - | - |
| **I** | | | | | | | | | | |
| ICE Make Ref | 707.40 | 712.40 | 724.90 | 734.50 | 704.00 | 45.75 | 1088.75 | 666.30 | - | - |
| ICICI Bank [2] | 1222.70 | 1251.20 | 1237.10 | 1253.90 | 1223.70 | 20617.78 | 1494.10 | 1218.00 | 18 | 1251.70 |
| ICICI PRUD AMC | 2690.30 | 2793.30 | 2768.00 | 2807.60 | 2680.40 | 419.69 | 3193.00 | 2530.00 | - | - |
| ICICIGI | 1722.20 | 1730.10 | 1750.00 | 1758.00 | 1703.20 | 603.52 | 2074.85 | 1660.20 | 32 | 1730.30 |
| ICICIPruLife | 531.25 | 537.50 | 539.95 | 542.90 | 525.00 | 1014.76 | 706.50 | 517.00 | 56 | 537.45 |
| ICRA | 5135.00 | 5118.50 | 5270.00 | 5270.00 | 5084.50 | 6.38 | 7135.35 | 5070.00 | 37 | 5112.40 |
| IDBI | 67.39 | 67.07 | 70.00 | 70.00 | 65.00 | 28229.99 | 118.45 | 65.05 | 8 | 67.10 |
| IDEA CELL | 8.70 | 8.88 | 9.08 | 9.08 | 8.72 | 544357.11 | 12.80 | 6.12 | - | 8.89 |
| Ideaforge | 397.60 | 404.45 | 410.00 | 411.00 | 396.00 | 330.55 | 659.85 | 304.20 | - | - |
| IDFCFirstBnk | 60.24 | 62.09 | 61.63 | 62.45 | 60.95 | 24090.88 | 87.00 | 52.46 | - | - |
| IEX [1] | 115.38 | 119.62 | 117.80 | 120.00 | 115.50 | 5996.52 | 215.40 | 114.80 | 23 | 119.55 |
| IFB | 923.90 | 980.60 | 938.00 | 996.30 | 935.60 | 91.06 | 2024.90 | 920.00 | 30 | 978.90 |
| IFB Agro | 725.45 | 746.55 | 732.85 | 761.70 | 711.25 | 19.01 | 1795.00 | 441.00 | 14 | 746.30 |
| IFCI | 50.56 | 52.02 | 52.49 | 52.64 | 50.90 | 11965.79 | 74.50 | 35.67 | 46 | 52.05 |
| IFGL | 136.85 | 139.05 | 140.10 | 144.25 | 138.00 | 84.56 | 339.50 | 135.10 | 21 | 138.05 |
| IG Petro | 360.05 | 366.80 | 364.80 | 373.10 | 358.35 | 77.01 | 519.00 | 317.80 | 162 | 367.65 |
| Igarshi Mot | 298.05 | 296.65 | 305.30 | 305.30 | 293.10 | 76.10 | 665.45 | 292.85 | 68 | 296.00 |
| IIFL [2] | 453.50 | 455.90 | 464.50 | 465.00 | 441.35 | 2078.66 | 674.95 | 305.55 | 28 | 455.95 |
| IIFL Capital | 255.05 | 260.10 | 264.95 | 268.40 | 253.45 | 1032.16 | 411.30 | 180.00 | - | - |
| IKIO Light. | 107.79 | 107.79 | 110.00 | 111.12 | 107.00 | 146.65 | 289.95 | 106.35 | - | - |
| IL & FS INVE [2] | 6.41 | 6.52 | 6.74 | 6.74 | 6.30 | 360.30 | 10.65 | 6.03 | - | 6.57 |
| Imagica Wrld | 37.58 | 37.79 | 39.00 | 39.00 | 37.15 | 742.69 | 75.55 | 37.05 | - | - |
| Ind Glycols [5] | 816.65 | 848.60 | 832.20 | 859.40 | 819.55 | 173.32 | 1222.85 | 502.50 | 26 | 848.40 |
| Ind.Inv.Tru | 134.63 | 133.64 | 134.63 | 135.80 | 128.02 | 21.49 | 265.80 | 121.40 | 51 | 130.55 |
| Ind.Shelt.Fi | 667.50 | 711.30 | 690.00 | 715.00 | 660.85 | 133.02 | 1011.75 | 650.00 | - | - |
| Indegene | 423.50 | 444.10 | 427.80 | 450.00 | 423.65 | 558.62 | 632.90 | 414.00 | - | - |
| India Nippon [5] | 710.25 | 730.65 | 722.50 | 740.00 | 707.10 | 23.73 | 1099.95 | 565.00 | 17 | 726.65 |
| India Pesti. | 126.72 | 133.91 | 128.90 | 134.50 | 128.02 | 271.11 | 245.84 | 123.11 | - | - |
| Indiabulls | 9.23 | 9.39 | 9.80 | 9.80 | 9.24 | 4797.98 | 21.25 | 8.90 | - | - |
| IndiaCements | 349.45 | 356.55 | 355.00 | 359.05 | 349.15 | 187.79 | 489.65 | 252.55 | - | 356.65 |
| IndiaMart In | 1970.50 | 1963.90 | 1980.10 | 2019.00 | 1947.80 | 405.11 | 2799.00 | 1900.10 | - | - |
| Indian Bank | 838.20 | 871.45 | 850.00 | 876.85 | 850.00 | 1433.33 | 1000.00 | 519.50 | 10 | 871.45 |
| Indian Htl [1] | 582.45 | 604.05 | 599.90 | 607.50 | 588.00 | 2990.05 | 858.85 | 581.00 | 54 | 604.10 |
| INDIAN MET | 1179.70 | 1199.00 | 1191.40 | 1212.50 | 1147.10 | 143.22 | 1511.05 | 550.85 | 18 | 1199.35 |
| IndianOilCo | 138.11 | 138.70 | 141.58 | 142.50 | 137.02 | 30509.69 | 188.90 | 120.05 | 6 | 138.40 |
| IndianOverBk | 32.11 | 32.44 | 33.00 | 33.06 | 32.11 | 6024.47 | 45.19 | 31.58 | 13 | 32.43 |
| IndiaTour De | 390.05 | 404.15 | 396.00 | 406.15 | 389.55 | 42.90 | 714.05 | 387.55 | 43 | 403.75 |
| IndigoPaints | 712.95 | 729.95 | 735.00 | 746.95 | 723.00 | 186.20 | 1345.90 | 711.00 | - | - |
| IndiqubeSpac | 135.56 | 136.13 | 137.60 | 140.40 | 134.79 | 107.15 | 243.80 | 132.05 | - | - |
| Indo Amines | 82.12 | 87.84 | 83.40 | 90.54 | 83.34 | 238.40 | 176.25 | 81.90 | - | - |
| INDO CO [2] | 224.75 | 247.20 | 234.00 | 247.20 | 226.55 | 598.63 | 350.70 | 210.70 | 42 | 247.35 |
| Indo Farm Eq | 119.36 | 119.15 | 122.00 | 123.00 | 117.15 | 262.52 | 271.69 | 117.15 | - | - |
| Indo Nationl [5] | 273.55 | 283.50 | 289.00 | 297.00 | 276.05 | 26.54 | 589.00 | 271.00 | - | 286.15 |
| Indo Rama | 31.52 | 31.40 | 32.85 | 32.85 | 30.31 | 272.63 | 74.94 | 28.70 | 7 | 31.48 |
| INDO THAI [1] | 258.20 | 270.85 | 260.00 | 271.10 | 258.25 | 784.13 | 470.00 | 144.00 | 77 | 269.35 |
| Indo US BIo | 102.55 | 102.49 | 105.90 | 106.41 | 99.58 | 40.81 | 206.00 | 96.05 | - | - |
| IndocoRem [2] | 182.93 | 184.51 | 184.50 | 186.07 | 180.88 | 35.18 | 348.10 | 180.85 | - | 184.95 |
| IndogulfCrop | 53.60 | 54.14 | 54.70 | 55.29 | 52.35 | 350.86 | 122.00 | 52.25 | - | - |
| INDOSTAR | 183.32 | 183.87 | 187.50 | 192.99 | 182.02 | 543.82 | 368.55 | 180.00 | - | 184.10 |
| IndoTech Tra | 1233.50 | 1256.50 | 1285.00 | 1285.00 | 1217.20 | 32.50 | 2790.15 | 1138.95 | 15 | 1257.45 |
| Indrapra Gas [2] | 147.98 | 149.89 | 152.53 | 152.58 | 147.56 | 4833.19 | 229.20 | 147.35 | 15 | 150.05 |
| Indraprastha | 369.10 | 393.60 | 377.40 | 395.45 | 372.70 | 304.58 | 640.05 | 326.00 | 20 | 392.15 |
| IndSwiftLab | 134.03 | 142.39 | 137.50 | 145.09 | 136.52 | 368.62 | 151.95 | 67.15 | 26 | 142.30 |
| IndusInd BK | 778.35 | 797.25 | 789.85 | 802.15 | 771.70 | 6347.81 | 968.60 | 618.05 | - | 798.05 |
| IndusTowers | 413.60 | 429.30 | 422.00 | 432.90 | 415.45 | 4652.61 | 481.50 | 312.55 | - | - |
| INFO EDGE [2] | 974.70 | 987.40 | 985.00 | 996.90 | 962.00 | 1408.16 | 1549.00 | 931.00 | 59 | 987.20 |
| Infobeans Te | 131.42 | 136.62 | 135.00 | 138.00 | 130.48 | 749.57 | 1030.00 | 120.33 | - | - |
| INFOSYS [5] | 1256.80 | 1278.30 | 1269.00 | 1297.00 | 1251.00 | 13613.50 | 1727.85 | 1215.15 | 18 | 1278.20 |
| Ingersoll | 3537.80 | 3562.70 | 3555.50 | 3632.60 | 3510.00 | 12.65 | 4449.95 | 3070.00 | 41 | 3575.30 |
| Innova Cap | 665.55 | 691.00 | 668.90 | 694.20 | 661.30 | 21.69 | 1020.70 | 622.00 | - | - |
| INNOVISION | 374.20 | 350.80 | 369.00 | 383.30 | 311.10 | 2930.60 | 470.00 | 311.10 | - | - |
| Inox Grn Enr | 135.01 | 138.86 | 140.50 | 140.84 | 133.21 | 6213.21 | 279.00 | 104.00 | - | - |
| Inox India | 1162.90 | 1202.60 | 1192.00 | 1207.00 | 1160.00 | 98.26 | 1288.00 | 892.25 | - | - |
| Inox Wind | 76.15 | 77.91 | 78.40 | 79.67 | 76.53 | 10215.27 | 198.14 | 75.70 | 21 | 77.91 |
| INSECTCID | 569.80 | 574.95 | 581.20 | 590.00 | 557.35 | 56.80 | 1096.30 | 531.60 | 12 | 579.55 |
| INSOLATION EN | 94.75 | 94.43 | 98.39 | 98.40 | 93.95 | 606.01 | 104.90 | 91.11 | - | - |
| INTELLECT [5] | 636.80 | 643.05 | 652.00 | 654.00 | 631.50 | 306.39 | 1255.00 | 555.05 | 39 | 642.60 |
| INTENS T [2] | 77.61 | 78.48 | 78.00 | 83.46 | 77.22 | 50.71 | 149.90 | 75.80 | - | 78.65 |
| InterarchBui | 1673.60 | 1711.70 | 1730.10 | 1740.00 | 1692.90 | 65.04 | 2762.60 | 1264.00 | - | - |
| InterGlobeAv | 3945.30 | 4150.80 | 4065.00 | 4168.40 | 4021.00 | 2152.98 | 6225.05 | 3894.80 | 35 | 4151.15 |
| Intl Convey. | 65.46 | 65.98 | 66.40 | 67.68 | 64.32 | 79.40 | 114.54 | 64.09 | - | - |
| Intl Gemm In | 318.80 | 326.45 | 325.80 | 333.00 | 320.00 | 733.38 | 442.00 | 287.00 | - | - |
| Inventu Know | 1274.90 | 1347.30 | 1305.00 | 1351.50 | 1290.50 | 341.20 | 1876.00 | 1236.80 | - | - |
| IOL Chem [2] | 71.56 | 77.17 | 73.20 | 79.25 | 72.50 | 5619.34 | 126.60 | 57.51 | 18 | 77.15 |
| Ion Exch | 317.25 | 331.15 | 328.00 | 335.00 | 321.20 | 275.71 | 580.75 | 312.70 | - | - |
| Ipca Lab [1] | 1529.90 | 1530.80 | 1550.00 | 1550.90 | 1504.20 | 123.36 | 1624.00 | 1200.00 | 39 | 1536.35 |
| IRB INFRA [1] | 40.24 | 40.63 | 41.10 | 41.16 | 40.05 | 7026.57 | 54.38 | 36.99 | 28 | 40.61 |
| IRCON | 115.24 | 118.62 | 118.84 | 119.99 | 115.70 | 4898.45 | 225.52 | 114.50 | - | - |
| IREDA | 110.51 | 114.37 | 113.90 | 115.20 | 111.63 | 9452.51 | 186.58 | 110.00 | - | - |
| IRFC | 89.45 | 92.87 | 91.99 | 93.20 | 91.00 | 22201.90 | 148.95 | 89.20 | - | - |
| IRM Energy | 186.44 | 183.18 | 189.24 | 192.35 | 181.15 | 155.86 | 393.00 | 181.15 | - | - |
| IRTC | 510.30 | 515.15 | 520.05 | 521.95 | 504.85 | 1739.71 | 820.25 | 504.85 | - | - |
| ISGEC Hvy | 883.05 | 882.70 | 892.50 | 902.95 | 864.45 | 154.83 | 1281.30 | 683.95 | - | - |
| ITC [1] | 290.45 | 291.25 | 295.95 | 296.00 | 288.75 | 33335.72 | 444.15 | 288.75 | 18 | 291.20 |
| ITC Hotels | 140.11 | 145.27 | 145.00 | 147.69 | 138.96 | 8908.18 | 261.62 | 138.96 | - | - |
| ITI | 253.45 | 256.05 | 262.00 | 262.30 | 251.05 | 941.12 | 372.95 | 232.90 | - | 255.75 |
| IValue Infos | 212.60 | 219.87 | 216.90 | 221.11 | 207.36 | 221.40 | 340.00 | 207.35 | - | - |
| IWIND ENERGY | 8.42 | 8.31 | 8.70 | 8.70 | 8.20 | 481.31 | 23.71 | 8.00 | - | 8.40 |
| Ixigo | 166.57 | 173.26 | 169.74 | 175.40 | 168.00 | 1650.28 | 339.15 | 123.29 | - | - |
| **J** | | | | | | | | | | |
| J KUMAR IN [5] | 460.80 | 473.65 | 470.05 | 479.70 | 451.05 | 139.59 | 764.00 | 451.90 | 9 | 469.70 |
| J&K Bank [1] | 109.33 | 113.10 | 113.00 | 114.83 | 111.16 | 6462.82 | 128.45 | 82.01 | 6 | 113.10 |
| J.K.INDUS [2] | 392.05 | 398.05 | 409.95 | 416.95 | 393.05 | 2509.69 | 611.60 | 231.65 | 16 | 398.50 |
| Jagran Prak [2] | 59.85 | 60.31 | 60.36 | 61.30 | 59.90 | 180.98 | 83.99 | 59.72 | 5 | 60.18 |
| Jagson Phar [2] | 182.15 | 181.42 | 183.49 | 184.40 | 181.02 | 73.18 | 301.80 | 154.90 | 28 | 181.20 |
| Jai Corp [1] | 94.69 | 96.42 | 97.10 | 97.80 | 94.16 | 1301.46 | 178.00 | 81.27 | 10 | 96.40 |
| JaiBalaj.Ind | 57.76 | 58.24 | 59.96 | 60.07 | 56.31 | 3180.33 | 668.00 | 81.00 | - | - |
| JAIN IRRIG [2] | 27.67 | 29.63 | 28.75 | 30.49 | 28.22 | 10319.65 | 66.40 | 27.37 | - | 29.61 |
| Jain Resourc | 439.65 | 455.60 | 445.00 | 462.50 | 442.00 | 2419.36 | 462.50 | 247.57 | - | - |
| Jamna Aut [1] | 112.44 | 117.80 | 116.73 | 119.25 | 114.41 | 2136.25 | 152.50 | 70.00 | 20 | 117.75 |
| Jana SFB | 343.65 | 360.20 | 350.00 | 362.95 | 343.35 | 493.73 | 552.50 | 330.00 | - | - |
| Jaro InsofT | 457.50 | 472.10 | 467.50 | 475.35 | 457.00 | 118.61 | 890.00 | 386.00 | - | - |
| Jash Engg | 344.30 | 347.80 | 354.30 | 359.80 | 340.00 | 145.39 | 698.95 | 337.20 | - | - |
| JAY NECO IND | 68.90 | 72.05 | 71.50 | 72.90 | 69.30 | 4319.17 | 94.30 | 26.06 | 18 | 72.02 |
| JayBh Maru [2] | 78.72 | 81.30 | 81.00 | 83.00 | 80.15 | 185.73 | 115.63 | 55.32 | 11 | 81.15 |
| Jaykay Enter | 124.13 | 124.97 | 127.40 | 127.40 | 122.71 | 183.79 | 219.70 | 122.71 | - | - |
| JB Chem [1] | 2080.30 | 2076.80 | 2105.00 | 2105.00 | 2053.40 | 275.29 | 2195.00 | 1303.00 | 46 | 2075.65 |
| JBM Auto [1] | 540.70 | 572.20 | 560.00 | 603.55 | 553.15 | 18969.92 | 790.00 | 477.00 | 84 | 574.75 |
| JeenaSikhoLi | 586.65 | 606.65 | 603.75 | 612.00 | 590.00 | 312.53 | 2450.00 | 400.25 | - | - |
| JG Chem. | 315.15 | 328.85 | 321.00 | 338.90 | 321.00 | 175.39 | 558.00 | 280.45 | - | - |
| JHS Svend | 6.84 | 7.18 | 7.18 | 7.90 | 7.10 | 528.94 | 16.20 | 6.80 | - | 7.16 |
| JIN POLY INV | 1086.00 | 1112.50 | 1120.00 | 1145.90 | 1102.50 | 88.96 | 1480.00 | 660.00 | 1 | 1112.40 |
| Jindal Drill [5] | 459.10 | 469.90 | 457.00 | 476.50 | 456.90 | 422.30 | 954.00 | 440.00 | 7 | 471.00 |
| Jindal Saw [1] | 179.11 | 181.97 | 184.46 | 186.15 | 178.37 | 2986.56 | 285.00 | 153.20 | 10 | 182.05 |
| JINDAL SOUTH | 13817.00 | 12760.00 | 14099.00 | 14099.00 | 12603.00 | 28.32 | 27760.50 | 12666.15 | 118 | 12781.75 |
| Jindal Sta [2] | 695.70 | 717.45 | 703.90 | 721.70 | 703.90 | 609.44 | 883.25 | 497.00 | 21 | 717.90 |
| Jindal Ste [1] | 1106.20 | 1120.60 | 1129.40 | 1138.50 | 1111.00 | 1222.27 | 1270.00 | 770.00 | 26 | 1120.10 |
| Jindal Wor [1] | 19.67 | 20.11 | 20.04 | 20.75 | 19.80 | 584.69 | 79.32 | 19.45 | - | 20.22 |
| JindalPho | 1058.50 | 1077.80 | 1074.40 | 1124.90 | 1058.00 | 60.76 | 1634.80 | 618.55 | 258 | 1079.60 |
| JioFin Servi | 226.10 | 232.70 | 232.85 | 234.00 | 227.75 | 16119.87 | 338.60 | 203.10 | - | - |
| JK Cement | 4878.50 | 5122.50 | 4950.00 | 5139.00 | 4890.50 | 73.05 | 7565.00 | 4464.00 | 36 | 5118.90 |
| JK Lakshmi [5] | 577.80 | 597.95 | 582.30 | 602.90 | 581.40 | 115.64 | 1020.85 | 575.00 | 16 | 597.40 |
| JK PAPER | 315.25 | 322.15 | 324.10 | 327.85 | 311.30 | 411.33 | 444.45 | 294.50 | 26 | 322.50 |
| JM Financial [1] | 117.66 | 120.44 | 121.90 | 121.90 | 118.05 | 2240.10 | 199.75 | 78.00 | 14 | 120.55 |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| JNK India | 223.39 | 235.16 | 226.50 | 238.00 | 226.07 | 77.10 | 419.55 | 200.92 | - | - |
| JPPOWER | 14.67 | 14.91 | 15.04 | 15.18 | 14.64 | 93767.03 | 27.62 | 12.60 | - | 14.91 |
| JSW Cement | 113.09 | 115.05 | 116.50 | 116.50 | 112.81 | 1516.70 | 162.15 | 106.65 | - | - |
| JSW energy | 482.70 | 484.00 | 491.50 | 495.50 | 482.05 | 2125.83 | 578.85 | 428.00 | 94 | 484.25 |
| JSW Infra | 241.30 | 252.45 | 248.00 | 253.50 | 240.85 | 2664.33 | 349.00 | 240.00 | - | - |
| JSWSL [1] | 1109.60 | 1133.70 | 1131.90 | 1142.70 | 1112.00 | 1218.01 | 1284.55 | 907.25 | 38 | 1133.60 |
| JTL Indus. | 49.41 | 49.46 | 51.00 | 51.57 | 48.87 | 1881.09 | 85.99 | 48.87 | - | - |
| Jub.Ingrevia | 565.15 | 573.05 | 582.55 | 582.55 | 555.20 | 165.69 | 851.80 | 535.20 | - | - |
| Jub.Pharmova | 816.20 | 860.35 | 837.00 | 881.00 | 815.10 | 378.16 | 1248.00 | 786.05 | - | - |
| JUBL FOOD [2] | 438.05 | 448.60 | 445.90 | 455.50 | 441.10 | 2152.09 | 743.95 | 437.00 | 121 | 448.70 |
| Juniper Hot | 193.43 | 202.95 | 195.55 | 206.77 | 193.20 | 265.79 | 345.55 | 192.50 | - | - |
| Jupiter Life | 1258.20 | 1259.80 | 1267.50 | 1267.50 | 1249.00 | 40.30 | 1770.00 | 1198.80 | - | - |
| Jupiter Wag | 252.60 | 259.60 | 259.70 | 261.00 | 252.50 | 1879.32 | 457.00 | 246.20 | - | - |
| JUSTDIAL | 500.75 | 509.35 | 511.75 | 515.45 | 502.00 | 201.59 | 1049.85 | 499.00 | 8 | 509.20 |
| JYOTHY LAB [1] | 199.60 | 210.20 | 205.00 | 212.30 | 200.30 | 1239.78 | 399.95 | 199.00 | 22 | 210.20 |
| Jyoti CNC Au | 722.45 | 744.90 | 749.00 | 755.00 | 723.60 | 441.11 | 1330.00 | 686.75 | - | - |
| Jyoti Struct [2] | 9.75 | 10.28 | 10.04 | 10.44 | 9.80 | 17456.60 | 22.19 | 7.92 | - | 10.27 |
| **K** | | | | | | | | | | |
| K.P.R. MILL [1] | 822.75 | 837.45 | 835.00 | 846.70 | 821.75 | 177.96 | 1395.40 | 796.05 | 49 | 837.05 |
| KabraExtrus [5] | 194.95 | 200.30 | 197.90 | 204.00 | 195.00 | 46.66 | 332.75 | 180.40 | - | 199.85 |
| Kajaria Cere [1] | 890.85 | 902.60 | 915.80 | 915.80 | 888.30 | 220.31 | 1322.00 | 745.00 | 40 | 901.85 |
| Kalpataru Lt | 282.90 | 280.00 | 299.85 | 311.00 | 275.25 | 387.51 | 457.40 | 275.25 | - | - |
| KalpataruPro | 1018.10 | 1051.80 | 1070.00 | 1073.10 | 1027.40 | 356.78 | 1335.60 | 786.30 | - | - |
| Kalyan Jwl. | 362.70 | 371.70 | 375.00 | 375.20 | 364.00 | 2901.90 | 617.70 | 347.50 | - | - |
| KALYANI ST [5] | 638.05 | 651.35 | 643.00 | 668.00 | 643.00 | 81.68 | 988.00 | 625.05 | 11 | 644.45 |
| Kamat Hotels | 162.57 | 160.51 | 164.05 | 166.91 | 157.00 | 105.56 | 368.95 | 157.15 | 11 | 160.75 |
| KAMDHENU [1] | 19.26 | 19.68 | 19.50 | 20.22 | 19.50 | 1300.90 | 35.96 | 19.04 | 7 | 19.65 |
| Kamdhenu Ven | 4.13 | 4.05 | 4.16 | 4.37 | 4.02 | 756.78 | 12.49 | 3.95 | - | - |
| Kanpur Plast | 157.83 | 175.14 | 163.00 | 186.00 | 158.51 | 39.59 | 249.50 | 104.50 | - | - |
| Kansai Nero [1] | 159.07 | 161.29 | 161.04 | 165.00 | 159.21 | 602.94 | 274.80 | 158.00 | 20 | 161.25 |
| Karnataka Bk | 214.50 | 218.12 | 220.00 | 221.50 | 215.60 | 2397.53 | 239.00 | 163.10 | 7 | 218.15 |
| KarurVysya [2] | 261.15 | 272.30 | 271.05 | 276.25 | 260.35 | 6110.47 | 343.55 | 158.37 | 12 | 272.30 |
| KAVERI SEED [2] | 785.40 | 809.20 | 802.00 | 820.00 | 780.60 | 140.33 | 1601.85 | 705.80 | 15 | 808.45 |
| KAYA L | 252.25 | 259.35 | 259.45 | 268.00 | 254.65 | 25.70 | 486.90 | 220.00 | - | 260.90 |
| KaynesTech | 3409.70 | 3514.30 | 3515.00 | 3559.90 | 3411.20 | 1278.69 | 7705.00 | 3294.90 | - | - |
| KCP [1] | 128.20 | 131.98 | 133.78 | 133.78 | 128.91 | 438.93 | 229.80 | 126.80 | 18 | 131.70 |
| KDDL | 2102.50 | 2139.00 | 2135.00 | 2171.80 | 2065.10 | 17.48 | 3350.00 | 2067.25 | 40 | 2148.80 |
| KEC Inter [2] | 514.85 | 545.50 | 532.50 | 549.00 | 519.45 | 841.72 | 947.30 | 511.50 | 38 | 546.20 |
| KEI Inds [2] | 3990.50 | 4126.00 | 4123.50 | 4142.50 | 4000.00 | 356.05 | 5301.10 | 2443.70 | 46 | 4124.35 |
| KELLTON [1] | 15.43 | 15.87 | 16.24 | 16.24 | 15.50 | 2959.84 | 33.10 | 14.57 | - | 15.88 |
| Kernex Micro | 905.00 | 927.40 | 935.00 | 947.20 | 913.00 | 140.94 | 1433.95 | 672.05 | 32 | 928.05 |
| Kesoram Ind | 7.81 | 8.59 | 7.80 | 8.59 | 7.52 | 1297.04 | 14.25 | 2.94 | - | 8.49 |
| Kewal Kiran | 413.05 | 433.85 | 414.20 | 442.25 | 414.20 | 80.03 | 594.35 | 408.75 | 20 | 432.75 |
| Keystone Rlt | 370.65 | 370.80 | 381.80 | 381.80 | 365.65 | 45.13 | 697.00 | 358.80 | - | - |
| KFIN Tech | 877.60 | 906.25 | 903.00 | 919.60 | 886.60 | 767.59 | 1388.50 | 828.80 | - | - |
| KHADIM | 85.29 | 91.11 | 87.60 | 93.00 | 85.95 | 366.53 | 310.70 | 81.35 | 17 | 91.05 |
| Khaitan Chm | 46.82 | 47.88 | 47.52 | 49.24 | 46.91 | 333.12 | 135.80 | 43.17 | - | - |
| KILITCH DRUG | 313.60 | 152.70 | 152.00 | 160.00 | 152.00 | 41.52 | 245.00 | 132.75 | 18 | 152.80 |
| Kilos oil [2] | 1287.70 | 1327.90 | 1309.90 | 1335.00 | 1254.90 | 386.08 | 1529.40 | 585.75 | 41 | 1328.75 |
| KIMS | 630.50 | 631.05 | 652.00 | 652.00 | 626.45 | 289.88 | 798.40 | 528.05 | - | - |
| KIOCL | 324.60 | 330.40 | 330.45 | 337.95 | 320.15 | 442.55 | 634.35 | 188.15 | - | 330.60 |
| KIRI DYES | 357.90 | 365.90 | 365.95 | 373.00 | 353.00 | 506.97 | 778.00 | 353.35 | 82 | 365.55 |
| KIRL INDUS | 2631.50 | 2740.30 | 2631.50 | 2790.00 | 2618.00 | 15.19 | 4650.00 | 2605.15 | 37 | 2746.20 |
| KIRL.BROS. [2] | 1483.00 | 1496.10 | 1505.00 | 1511.90 | 1460.00 | 56.67 | 2475.55 | 1405.65 | 45 | 1496.45 |
| Kirlosk.Elec | 83.17 | 87.11 | 84.87 | 88.50 | 83.50 | 418.43 | 100.80 | 26.95 | 16 | |
| Kirlosk.Pne | 1041.60 | 1072.50 | 1060.00 | 1085.20 | 1038.40 | 41.23 | 1550.00 | 990.10 | - | - |
| KITEX GARM [1] | 150.21 | 158.39 | 155.55 | 165.00 | 153.00 | 1624.96 | 320.95 | 138.45 | 43 | 158.05 |
| Knowledg.Mar | 1443.10 | 1544.00 | 1479.80 | 1558.00 | 1466.50 | 67.86 | 3758.50 | 1264.05 | - | - |
| KNR CONST [2] | 114.06 | 112.72 | 115.66 | 116.95 | 110.06 | 2303.59 | 254.15 | 110.25 | 18 | 112.70 |
| KOHINOR | 21.96 | 21.73 | 22.41 | 22.98 | 21.30 | 146.95 | 46.00 | 21.28 | - | 21.57 |
| KOKUYO [1] | 73.58 | 75.22 | 74.80 | 76.99 | 72.79 | 85.18 | 137.70 | 72.02 | 29 | 75.30 |
| KOLTEPATIL | 323.10 | 322.25 | 328.00 | 328.20 | 319.00 | 56.93 | 497.80 | 310.00 | 90 | 321.90 |
| Kopran Ltd | 114.08 | 115.45 | 116.99 | 118.90 | 115.00 | 276.18 | 214.65 | 110.90 | 28 | 115.45 |
| Kotak Mah [1] | 356.55 | 366.85 | 363.00 | 370.95 | 361.40 | 19990.98 | 460.31 | 355.30 | 27 | 367.15 |
| KOTYARK IN | 386.05 | 382.30 | 380.15 | 421.00 | 372.00 | 132.67 | 421.00 | 316.00 | - | - |
| KP Energy | 264.50 | 273.20 | 274.00 | 274.90 | 260.40 | 262.61 | 583.70 | 237.90 | - | - |
| KPI Grn Enr | 357.95 | 375.50 | 371.60 | 379.50 | 359.70 | 1131.00 | 563.00 | 335.65 | - | - |
| KPIT Tech | 659.30 | 665.00 | 680.00 | 681.80 | 644.40 | 1567.45 | 1434.50 | 624.90 | - | - |
| KRBL. [1] | 285.20 | 296.35 | 290.00 | 301.00 | 286.65 | 733.82 | 495.00 | 225.70 | 10 | 296.30 |
| Krishana Ph. | 469.00 | 479.25 | 479.95 | 488.50 | 467.50 | 227.67 | 619.00 | 210.00 | - | - |
| Krishna def | 838.80 | 885.50 | 850.00 | 897.60 | 850.00 | 92.64 | 1240.00 | 601.00 | - | - |
| Kriti Ind. | 60.09 | 54.68 | 62.10 | 62.10 | 53.00 | 288.74 | 177.51 | 53.00 | - | - |
| KRN Heat Ex. | 847.95 | 896.75 | 880.00 | 909.70 | 865.05 | 938.43 | 1031.80 | 589.80 | - | - |
| Kronox Lab | 104.53 | 103.32 | 107.80 | 108.72 | 102.10 | 151.42 | 207.49 | 102.10 | - | - |
| Kross | 160.65 | 168.46 | 165.65 | 172.29 | 164.30 | 606.09 | 237.60 | 150.06 | - | - |
| Krsnaa Dia. | 574.30 | 564.25 | 576.10 | 591.60 | 550.90 | 133.36 | 894.40 | 550.90 | - | - |
| Krystal Int. | 540.05 | 540.75 | 551.00 | 557.95 | 540.00 | 12.18 | 729.50 | 423.05 | - | - |
| KSB | 782.85 | 799.20 | 792.00 | 809.75 | 780.15 | 212.64 | 912.00 | 647.80 | - | - |
| KSH Internat | 434.90 | 449.65 | 445.00 | 457.60 | 435.00 | 325.81 | 457.60 | 330.00 | - | - |
| KSolves Ind | 260.25 | 268.30 | 264.20 | 278.60 | 264.20 | 50.60 | 497.00 | 250.05 | - | - |
| Kuantum Pap. | 71.99 | 72.39 | 72.25 | 75.14 | 71.59 | 145.30 | 135.00 | 71.51 | - | - |
| KWALITY WALL'S | 23.18 | 23.63 | 23.69 | 23.99 | 22.86 | 10501.18 | 31.29 | 22.42 | - | - |
| **L** | | | | | | | | | | |
| L & T [2] | 3342.40 | 3516.80 | 3440.00 | 3547.10 | 3390.50 | 6037.85 | 4440.00 | 2967.65 | 43 | 3515.35 |
| L&T Finance | 247.65 | 254.80 | 254.00 | 255.75 | 248.90 | 6736.39 | 329.45 | 140.00 | - | - |
| Lal path lab | 1307.60 | 1310.90 | 1330.00 | 1334.90 | 1294.20 | 366.30 | 1771.30 | 1187.50 | 41 | 1311.20 |
| Landmark Car | 368.25 | 367.55 | 372.00 | 378.25 | 364.00 | 71.72 | 662.80 | 329.80 | - | - |
| LA-OPAL [2] | 177.14 | 181.13 | 181.60 | 182.24 | 175.25 | 133.18 | 286.00 | 175.65 | 20 | 182.20 |
| Latent View | 249.60 | 262.65 | 255.45 | 265.00 | 251.40 | 896.27 | 517.50 | 248.00 | - | - |
| Laurus Labs [2] | 961.40 | 992.60 | 978.00 | 1001.50 | 966.00 | 1521.77 | 1140.90 | 517.05 | 67 | 992.55 |
| Laxmi Gold. | 237.05 | 246.10 | 245.05 | 257.00 | 233.60 | 141.06 | 959.00 | 231.35 | - | - |
| Laxmi Organ. | 112.90 | 118.00 | 117.79 | 120.36 | 114.15 | 1161.74 | 241.00 | 110.15 | - | - |
| LaxmiDent | 168.45 | 164.32 | 172.00 | 173.70 | 163.25 | 162.20 | 509.95 | 163.25 | - | - |
| LaxmiIndFin | 82.00 | 80.57 | 85.00 | 85.95 | 80.20 | 301.93 | 180.90 | 77.61 | - | - |
| LEMONTREE | 102.14 | 106.16 | 105.15 | 107.35 | 103.36 | 3801.02 | 180.60 | 99.70 | 73 | 106.25 |
| Lenskart Sol | 501.50 | 502.00 | 511.00 | 515.75 | 500.00 | 1271.14 | 543.90 | 356.10 | - | - |
| LG Balkrish | 1651.30 | 1709.90 | 1669.50 | 1724.00 | 1669.50 | 29.79 | 2096.95 | 1080.00 | 18 | 1705.80 |
| LG Electroni | 1484.60 | 1491.60 | 1499.00 | 1507.90 | 1464.00 | 1061.59 | 1749.00 | 1325.50 | - | - |
| LIC | 740.00 | 758.70 | 758.75 | 763.00 | 740.40 | 1027.85 | 980.00 | 737.05 | - | - |
| LIC Housing [2] | 460.70 | 479.00 | 468.00 | 481.00 | 466.80 | 2779.62 | 646.60 | 459.05 | 5 | 478.75 |
| LikhithaInfr | 133.15 | 136.10 | 136.80 | 138.90 | 133.19 | 93.26 | 324.00 | 131.45 | - | - |
| LINDEINDIA | 6765.00 | 7393.50 | 6900.00 | 7515.00 | 6854.50 | 247.64 | 7865.05 | 5202.45 | 108 | 7398.90 |
| Lloyds Engg | 38.20 | 39.04 | 39.66 | 40.45 | 38.43 | 11380.51 | 84.27 | 38.00 | - | - |
| Lloyds Met. | 1209.60 | 1258.80 | 1245.00 | 1267.00 | 1221.00 | 675.84 | 1612.00 | 1015.00 | - | - |
| LMW | 12607.00 | 13038.00 | 12800.00 | 13174.00 | 12566.00 | 10.06 | 18250.00 | 12500.00 | - | - |
| Lokesh Machi | 191.45 | 190.25 | 193.22 | 202.49 | 189.00 | 119.69 | 255.90 | 138.00 | - | 190.15 |
| Looyds Ent. | 42.17 | 42.83 | 42.38 | 44.00 | 42.28 | 5209.20 | 96.40 | 41.30 | - | - |
| LT Foods | 364.00 | 379.05 | 376.00 | 385.45 | 366.60 | 781.61 | 518.55 | 288.25 | - | - |
| LTIMINDTREE | 4105.60 | 4211.50 | 4210.00 | 4240.00 | 4105.70 | 317.95 | 6429.50 | 3802.00 | - | - |
| LTTS [2] | 3075.60 | 3153.50 | 3164.90 | 3175.10 | 3051.70 | 184.45 | 4746.95 | 3046.85 | 27 | 3152.95 |
| Lumax Ind | 4808.00 | 5025.50 | 4998.00 | 5087.50 | 4833.00 | 15.25 | 6969.90 | 2200.00 | 31 | 5018.50 |
| Lumax Tech [2] | 1480.40 | 1571.80 | 1536.80 | 1599.00 | 1520.00 | 263.24 | 1823.75 | 452.55 | 122 | 1570.70 |
| Lupin Ltd. [2] | 2296.70 | 2331.80 | 2325.00 | 2348.90 | 2280.50 | 1275.82 | 2376.00 | 1774.00 | 19 | 2331.75 |
| LUXIND [2] | 926.35 | 945.15 | 939.90 | 966.00 | 917.00 | 73.61 | 1640.00 | 805.05 | 25 | 943.65 |
| Lyka Labs | 49.83 | 48.62 | 50.60 | 51.68 | 47.11 | 293.32 | 128.60 | 47.70 | - | 48.87 |
| **M** | | | | | | | | | | |
| M&M FinSer [2] | 293.05 | 306.20 | 301.40 | 308.40 | 292.75 | 1666.05 | 412.30 | 235.46 | 17 | 306.20 |
| Macpower CNC | 853.10 | 849.40 | 860.40 | 870.00 | 841.15 | 15.65 | 1090.00 | 723.00 | - | - |
| Macrote.Dev. | 727.90 | 726.40 | 740.00 | 742.00 | 715.45 | 11500.33 | 1531.00 | 715.45 | - | - |
| Madhya Bh.Ag | 441.50 | 454.10 | 442.00 | 457.60 | 435.80 | 518.20 | 489.45 | 240.00 | - | - |
| MagellanicCl | 20.75 | 21.15 | 21.45 | 21.70 | 20.95 | 1139.79 | 105.42 | 20.67 | - | - |
| MAH HOLIDAY | 248.00 | 245.95 | 248.90 | 250.25 | 242.00 | 259.56 | 381.55 | 241.00 | 20 | 246.20 |
| Mah Logis | 349.00 | 359.05 | 352.05 | 366.60 | 350.15 | 241.89 | 435.35 | 218.20 | 96 | 357.85 |
| Mah&Mah [5] | 2955.80 | 3031.30 | 3030.00 | 3057.30 | 2965.90 | 3944.28 | 3840.00 | 2360.45 | 24 | 3032.55 |
| Mah.seaml [5] | 537.70 | 550.60 | 542.00 | 559.90 | 538.10 | 178.71 | 774.00 | 500.00 | 9 | 550.35 |
| Maha.Scooter | 11891.00 | 12005.00 | 12019.00 | 12241.00 | 11768.00 | 2.70 | 18526.00 | 9225.05 | 44 | 12021.65 |
| MAHINDRALIFE | 324.15 | 327.90 | 329.05 | 336.00 | 324.10 | 117.79 | 428.35 | 253.81 | 95 | 327.50 |
| Maithan All | 864.60 | 895.70 | 895.00 | 901.40 | 866.80 | 78.66 | 1265.00 | 834.05 | 6 | 898.70 |
| MamataMach | 352.75 | 352.50 | 367.35 | 367.35 | 348.60 | 147.71 | 541.00 | 311.55 | - | - |
| Man ind [5] | 337.15 | 336.70 | 338.00 | 350.05 | 333.00 | 477.92 | 490.90 | 248.95 | 15 | 337.20 |
| Man Infra [2] | 85.80 | 86.73 | 86.86 | 88.89 | 85.01 | 944.14 | 191.90 | 85.35 | 22 | 86.95 |
| Manali Petro [5] | 42.12 | 43.18 | 43.80 | 44.70 | 41.85 | 396.07 | 81.00 | 42.00 | - | 43.26 |
| Manappura [2] | 252.30 | 252.65 | 253.75 | 257.00 | 248.65 | 3882.59 | 320.95 | 219.65 | 14 | 252.80 |
| MandB Eng | 248.00 | 249.80 | 252.00 | 253.50 | 243.10 | 236.89 | 535.90 | 243.10 | - | - |
| Mangalam Cem | 807.90 | 826.45 | 813.80 | 835.90 | 805.95 | 82.43 | 939.30 | 640.00 | 28 | 828.05 |
| Mangalam Glo | 11.71 | 13.32 | 12.01 | 13.47 | 12.01 | 1895.77 | 18.40 | 9.53 | - | - |
| MangalElec | 218.33 | 227.33 | 220.10 | 232.00 | 216.75 | 183.54 | 573.70 | 212.80 | - | - |
| Manindra EPC | 105.66 | 105.15 | 107.50 | 110.28 | 104.37 | 86.15 | 185.12 | 104.37 | - | - |
| Mankind Phr | 1927.40 | 1987.80 | 1952.90 | 1993.60 | 1917.00 | 728.68 | 2716.50 | 1909.70 | - | - |
| ManojVaibGem | 140.36 | 138.82 | 146.50 | 147.00 | 137.80 | 87.11 | 280.00 | 136.81 | - | - |
| Manomay Tex | 200.28 | 217.64 | 203.95 | 218.00 | 202.30 | 90.47 | 259.88 | 154.10 | - | - |
| Manorama Ind | 1207.40 | 1264.90 | 1265.00 | 1271.80 | 1226.10 | 62.81 | 1760.00 | 849.95 | - | - |
| Marath NX [5] | 406.85 | 413.55 | 411.00 | 420.05 | 404.85 | 102.65 | 774.55 | 368.40 | 16 | 412.55 |
| MARICOLTD [1] | 725.30 | 739.10 | 732.00 | 745.40 | 724.45 | 1852.58 | 813.10 | 623.10 | 50 | 739.60 |
| Marine Elec. | 161.67 | 165.59 | 164.96 | 172.00 | 163.70 | 699.86 | 258.00 | 155.10 | - | - |
| MarkolinePav | 146.90 | 147.72 | 150.00 | 151.25 | 145.65 | 163.50 | 188.00 | 131.65 | - | - |
| MARKSANS [1] | 160.20 | 164.54 | 163.00 | 167.99 | 159.70 | 1306.20 | 270.60 | 157.25 | 30 | 164.90 |
| MARSONS | 125.87 | 131.99 | 129.50 | 138.25 | 128.76 | 931.52 | 152.00 | 124.02 | - | - |
| Maruti Udy [5] | 12355.00 | 12464.00 | 12600.00 | 12650.00 | 12332.00 | 583.57 | 17371.60 | 11072.20 | 27 | 12467.50 |
| MASFIN | 293.30 | 297.90 | 296.50 | 300.25 | 290.00 | 73.52 | 354.95 | 230.35 | 16 | 298.20 |
| Mastek [5] | 1382.60 | 1432.00 | 1409.00 | 1446.00 | 1377.00 | 112.48 | 2817.75 | 1375.55 | 23 | 1430.50 |
| Master Trust | 62.30 | 66.03 | 63.23 | 67.75 | 62.00 | 293.06 | 174.40 | 62.00 | - | - |
| Mawana Sugar | 81.78 | 80.01 | 81.95 | 82.75 | 77.82 | 95.08 | 111.80 | 75.00 | 6 | 79.70 |
| Max Estate | 340.25 | 352.45 | 348.90 | 359.80 | 337.55 | 193.83 | 564.30 | 335.90 | - | - |
| Max Healthca | 956.90 | 969.20 | 967.00 | 983.10 | 963.40 | 2455.95 | 1314.30 | 933.80 | - | - |
| Max India | 138.32 | 138.01 | 144.99 | 144.99 | 136.35 | 78.36 | 241.57 | 136.35 | - | - |
| MAYUR UN. [5] | 493.20 | 516.10 | 500.00 | 523.45 | 500.00 | 60.76 | 629.30 | 434.90 | 13 | 516.40 |
| Mazagon Dock | 2206.70 | 2253.00 | 2260.00 | 2272.70 | 2213.10 | 1457.70 | 3775.00 | 2125.90 | - | - |
| Mazda Ltd [2] | 171.78 | 170.76 | 175.31 | 179.19 | 168.59 | 48.28 | 337.90 | 169.00 | 13 | 171.15 |
| MBL INFRA | 20.31 | 20.91 | 20.25 | 21.60 | 19.67 | 683.64 | 56.90 | 19.90 | - | 21.03 |
| MCLEOD [5] | 32.31 | 32.03 | 34.49 | 34.49 | 31.65 | 1062.20 | 68.73 | 29.65 | - | 31.98 |
| MCX [2] | 2314.40 | 2419.00 | 2383.80 | 2426.00 | 2291.00 | 4100.13 | 2706.00 | 905.35 | 85 | 2418.75 |
| Medi Assist | 304.55 | 313.70 | 310.05 | 316.25 | 307.85 | 145.92 | 594.10 | 294.70 | - | - |
| Medicam.Bio | 240.15 | 242.05 | 243.50 | 249.20 | 241.00 | 50.97 | 544.00 | 237.00 | - | - |
| Medico Reme. | 34.95 | 36.22 | 35.40 | 37.00 | 34.26 | 431.86 | 62.48 | 33.30 | - | - |
| Medplus Hlth | 797.75 | 822.15 | 800.75 | 832.50 | 800.75 | 67.26 | 1045.30 | 678.05 | - | - |
| Meesho | 141.87 | 150.73 | 144.97 | 153.10 | 143.59 | 6024.01 | 254.40 | 125.56 | - | - |
| MeghamaniOrg | 40.37 | 42.21 | 41.55 | 43.00 | 41.06 | 775.29 | 106.30 | 40.05 | - | - |
| Menon Bear [1] | 112.57 | 112.14 | 114.30 | 116.89 | 109.00 | 145.88 | 145.20 | 73.00 | 24 | 111.80 |
| Metro Brand | 902.60 | 931.00 | 919.30 | 935.90 | 903.20 | 40.42 | 1340.40 | 892.80 | - | - |
| METROPOL [2] | 450.20 | 443.00 | 448.00 | 472.00 | 432.50 | 382.83 | 564.83 | 345.93 | 64 | 448.65 |
| MFL | 58.21 | 58.93 | 59.00 | 60.74 | 58.10 | 139.18 | 24.70 | 12.15 | - | - |
| MFSL [2] | 1567.50 | 1583.50 | 1594.90 | 1599.00 | 1548.20 | 1556.96 | 1891.35 | 1090.65 | - | 1582.50 |
| MGL | 908.40 | 922.40 | 928.00 | 934.30 | 907.10 | 314.65 | 1586.00 | 902.00 | 9 | 918.80 |
| MIC Electr. | 31.31 | 31.61 | 32.50 | 32.70 | 31.42 | 619.28 | 82.97 | 31.17 | - | - |
| Midhani | 293.85 | 300.40 | 300.00 | 303.60 | 292.40 | 564.54 | 468.40 | 217.05 | 52 | 301.65 |
| Midwest Ltd | 1187.20 | 1236.50 | 1247.90 | 1247.90 | 1210.60 | 21.35 | 1859.90 | 1048.50 | - | - |
| MINDACORP [2] | 490.85 | 521.10 | 498.00 | 529.90 | 489.30 | 266.22 | 644.35 | 445.25 | 61 | 521.90 |
| MindTeck(I) | 160.97 | 161.88 | 163.38 | 178.99 | 159.02 | 207.49 | 307.00 | 141.00 | 23 | 161.70 |
| MINERAL&M [1] | 55.72 | 56.71 | 56.55 | 57.70 | 54.90 | 3969.90 | 88.20 | 42.55 | - | 56.77 |
| Mirc Elect [1] | 23.38 | 23.65 | 23.71 | 24.90 | 23.22 | 661.79 | 37.47 | 10.30 | - | 23.67 |
| Mirza Intl [2] | 27.59 | 28.14 | 28.41 | 28.93 | 27.51 | 165.12 | 43.84 | 26.25 | - | 28.13 |
| MM Forgings | 413.20 | 415.05 | 417.10 | 428.05 | 406.15 | 115.81 | 500.00 | 276.05 | 20 | 415.90 |
| MMP Ind | 206.68 | 206.33 | 206.68 | 210.18 | 202.00 | 33.75 | 318.00 | 201.99 | - | - |
| Mnkcmil Ltd [1] | 100.89 | 102.41 | 102.80 | 103.50 | 99.67 | 95.57 | 182.80 | 74.03 | 27 | 102.30 |
| Modison | 114.59 | 120.47 | 118.98 | 123.00 | 114.84 | 53.83 | 197.45 | 112.00 | - | - |
| MOIL | 285.25 | 289.65 | 290.60 | 292.00 | 276.50 | 2033.14 | 405.50 | 242.65 | 20 | 289.50 |
| MOLDTKPA [5] | 477.75 | 472.65 | 490.00 | 497.65 | 470.10 | 96.24 | 890.00 | 415.00 | 23 | 472.75 |
| Monarch Netw | 245.55 | 251.45 | 253.05 | 254.95 | 243.35 | 349.94 | 398.80 | 239.85 | - | - |
| Montecarlo | 497.85 | 511.30 | 503.30 | 514.95 | 499.05 | 28.99 | 865.00 | 489.80 | 11 | 510.80 |
| Morepen La [2] | 35.33 | 36.55 | 36.49 | 37.23 | 35.20 | 3254.92 | 70.40 | 33.47 | 35 | 36.55 |
| Moschip Tech | 157.06 | 164.16 | 162.34 | 166.15 | 159.37 | 1667.41 | 288.45 | 129.98 | - | - |
| Mothersn Sum | 35.89 | 37.51 | 36.09 | 37.67 | 36.09 | 5656.17 | 65.96 | 35.70 | - | - |
| MOTILALOFS [1] | 628.20 | 649.55 | 649.80 | 654.00 | 635.10 | 1045.48 | 1097.00 | 487.85 | 41 | 649.30 |
| Motisons Jwl | 12.14 | 12.29 | 12.40 | 12.60 | 12.19 | 2446.54 | 24.02 | 10.62 | - | - |
| MPHASIS | 2063.60 | 2116.80 | 2099.60 | 2138.20 | 2056.70 | 747.21 | 3035.15 | 2025.05 | 28 | 2116.60 |
| MPS | 1445.40 | 1508.50 | 1455.00 | 1525.00 | 1454.20 | 37.26 | 3071.85 | 1340.00 | 22 | 1509.20 |
| MRF | 124975.00 | 127645.00 | 127900.00 | 128860.00 | 125500.00 | 7.98 | 163500.00 | 107388.65 | 24 | 127763.80 |
| MRPL | 183.15 | 181.72 | 189.80 | 190.00 | 174.20 | 20193.01 | 214.95 | 114.40 | 15 | 182.00 |
| Mrs.Bect.Fd | 176.02 | 181.17 | 177.58 | 183.00 | 176.03 | 406.01 | 1654.00 | 174.38 | - | - |
| MSP Stl | 28.05 | 29.32 | 28.50 | 29.73 | 27.80 | 1620.86 | 41.25 | 23.56 | - | 28.92 |
| MSTC | 391.45 | 397.55 | 395.90 | 401.85 | 385.30 | 285.52 | 582.45 | 382.25 | - | - |
| MTAR Tech | 3372.20 | 3546.80 | 3500.70 | 3575.00 | 3401.90 | 232.07 | 3920.00 | 1155.60 | - | - |
| MTNL | 23.25 | 23.98 | 23.65 | 24.30 | 23.20 | 1787.25 | 58.00 | 23.07 | - | 23.91 |
| MufinGreen | 98.51 | 100.03 | 102.00 | 104.50 | 99.00 | 1099.17 | 126.34 | 63.11 | - | - |
| Mukand Ind | 120.11 | 120.07 | 121.40 | 123.31 | 119.14 | 88.50 | 160.85 | 84.64 | 18 | 119.65 |
| Mukka Protin | 20.32 | 20.58 | 21.00 | 21.00 | 20.05 | 234.80 | 34.79 | 20.05 | - | - |
| Munj Auto [2] | 70.78 | 72.73 | 72.75 | 72.99 | 71.12 | 74.41 | 114.60 | 60.04 | 24 | 72.43 |
| Muthoot Fin | 3115.60 | 3155.20 | 3141.00 | 3165.50 | 3047.10 | 1645.28 | 4149.00 | 1964.35 | 15 | 3155.00 |
| Muthoot MFin | 148.50 | 155.05 | 153.00 | 156.00 | 149.15 | 218.00 | 199.39 | 120.00 | - | - |
| **N** | | | | | | | | | | |
| N C L IND. | 162.65 | 160.01 | 167.70 | 167.70 | 159.60 | 162.62 | 239.20 | 160.00 | 11 | 160.10 |
| NagarAgri [1] | 131.10 | 127.37 | 131.10 | 133.99 | 124.55 | 719.11 | 309.41 | 89.81 | - | 127.85 |
| Nandan Den [1] | 2.08 | 2.10 | 2.20 | 2.20 | 2.10 | 1975.52 | 4.41 | 2.05 | - | 2.10 |
| Narmada Agr | 31.15 | 31.23 | 31.18 | 31.94 | 30.77 | 93.86 | 35.99 | 14.82 | - | - |
| Natco Pha [2] | 927.55 | 949.75 | 950.00 | 955.90 | 925.10 | 446.71 | 1059.60 | 660.05 | 11 | 949.70 |
| NATIONAL FER | 67.40 | 68.60 | 68.80 | 69.36 | 67.10 | 1636.19 | 112.11 | 66.10 | 23 | 68.60 |
| NationalA [5] | 349.75 | 354.65 | 358.55 | 359.75 | 350.65 | 9633.88 | 431.60 | 140.00 | 10 | 354.30 |
| Nava | 544.45 | 561.90 | 558.30 | 565.95 | 546.55 | 322.15 | 735.00 | 396.30 | - | - |
| Navin Fluori [2] | 5886.50 | 6184.50 | 6050.00 | 6225.00 | 5950.00 | 141.67 | 6960.00 | 3664.55 | 72 | 6174.70 |
| NAVKARCORP | 80.25 | 83.84 | 82.00 | 87.50 | 80.60 | 722.07 | 140.35 | 79.47 | - | 83.55 |
| Navneet Edu [2] | 123.69 | 125.29 | 125.50 | 129.12 | 122.69 | 316.05 | 168.00 | 123.15 | 15 | 125.70 |
| Nazara Tech | 217.65 | 229.00 | 224.20 | 232.40 | 219.40 | 1954.98 | 1453.00 | 215.70 | - | - |
| NBCC [1] | 79.09 | 81.85 | 82.00 | 82.67 | 80.00 | 12914.77 | 130.60 | 75.01 | 35 | 81.87 |
| NCC [2] | 132.29 | 136.16 | 137.00 | 137.50 | 132.44 | 2588.41 | 242.00 | 131.30 | 13 | 136.20 |
| NDR AutoComp | 639.85 | 667.35 | 657.75 | 674.75 | 647.50 | 14.26 | 1220.00 | 572.85 | - | - |
| NDTV [4] | 66.02 | 66.84 | 67.70 | 68.54 | 66.50 | 244.37 | 140.54 | 65.10 | - | 66.96 |
| NELCAST [2] | 118.35 | 118.32 | 119.20 | 121.88 | 118.00 | 69.91 | 180.65 | 80.37 | 22 | 117.65 |
| Nelco Ltd. | 537.95 | 552.65 | 549.00 | 561.95 | 537.00 | 131.53 | 1161.50 | 533.55 | 300 | 553.45 |
| Neogen Chem | 1249.60 | 1237.50 | 1274.80 | 1292.00 | 1225.00 | 50.22 | 1797.90 | 966.70 | - | - |
| Nephrocare | 501.00 | 525.40 | 515.90 | 530.00 | 495.95 | 62.56 | 616.00 | 446.00 | - | - |
| NESCO [2] | 1016.90 | 1033.50 | 1030.00 | 1050.10 | 1008.20 | 68.52 | 1638.85 | 882.00 | 18 | 1032.85 |
| NESTLE (I) [1] | 1166.80 | 1183.20 | 1180.00 | 1195.10 | 1163.20 | 1001.49 | 1339.85 | 1075.00 | 72 | 1182.85 |
| Netweb Tech | 3087.60 | 3198.90 | 3193.90 | 3232.30 | 3115.00 | 1134.31 | 4479.00 | 1251.55 | - | - |
| Network18 [5] | 29.21 | 30.10 | 29.95 | 30.50 | 29.50 | 7112.06 | 65.31 | 29.08 | - | 30.09 |
| NetworkPeoSR | 1060.90 | 1094.80 | 1079.90 | 1149.90 | 1070.00 | 81.79 | 2531.75 | 846.60 | - | - |
| Neuland Lab | 11555.00 | 12030.00 | 12000.00 | 12170.00 | 11521.00 | 28.52 | 19748.40 | 10060.00 | 87 | 12030.95 |
| Newgen Soft | 420.55 | 433.00 | 429.00 | 437.45 | 421.45 | 1082.68 | 1379.15 | 417.00 | 20 | 433.15 |
| Neyveli Lig | 253.80 | 259.35 | 258.00 | 261.70 | 251.65 | 1545.85 | 292.35 | 202.05 | 19 | 259.15 |
| NH | 1624.60 | 1655.50 | 1654.00 | 1673.40 | 1630.00 | 266.20 | 2371.60 | 1380.05 | 68 | 1654.50 |
| NHPC | 75.28 | 76.54 | 76.02 | 76.79 | 74.80 | 9600.10 | 92.30 | 68.66 | 24 | 76.53 |
| NIACL [5] | 124.65 | 124.72 | 127.48 | 128.00 | 121.25 | 1598.63 | 214.75 | 121.05 | 18 | 125.55 |
| NIBE | 891.60 | 909.20 | 920.00 | 944.70 | 902.00 | 50.33 | 2001.00 | 887.50 | - | - |
| NIIT [2] | 54.36 | 54.79 | 55.20 | 56.18 | 53.21 | 1270.80 | 150.55 | 53.26 | 30 | 54.73 |
| NIIT Lrn.Sys | 291.20 | 290.15 | 300.00 | 300.00 | 281.40 | 212.81 | 454.00 | 281.40 | - | - |
| Nila Spaces | 11.88 | 12.28 | 11.98 | 12.50 | 11.92 | 696.84 | 20.47 | 10.60 | - | - |
| Nilkamal Ltd | 1126.90 | 1119.40 | 1147.00 | 1155.90 | 1109.50 | 14.58 | 1901.20 | 1111.00 | 15 | 1115.20 |

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CHENNAI
businessline.
WEDNESDAY - MARCH 25 - 2026

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nintec Sys | 286.60 | 342.15 | 304.95 | 343.90 | 288.25 | 110.33 | 526.90 | 281.05 | - | - |
| NipponAM | 817.20 | 847.75 | 835.00 | 853.90 | 821.00 | 406.10 | 1009.00 | 498.05 | - | - |
| Niraj Cement | 23.61 | 23.44 | 25.40 | 25.40 | 22.84 | 208.06 | 68.00 | 22.84 | - | - |
| Nitco Tiles | 76.24 | 82.41 | 79.99 | 83.93 | 79.03 | 944.30 | 164.00 | 64.20 | 44 | 82.41 |
| NITINSPINNER | 353.55 | 357.60 | 360.30 | 367.90 | 354.05 | 196.05 | 426.95 | 300.00 | 12 | 358.10 |
| Niva Bupa | 68.40 | 68.64 | 69.03 | 69.90 | 67.50 | 723.85 | 95.21 | 67.50 | - | - |
| NMDC [1] | 75.09 | 76.77 | 77.45 | 77.45 | 74.92 | 22852.80 | 86.84 | 59.56 | 10 | 76.70 |
| NMDC Steel | 34.34 | 34.91 | 35.50 | 35.70 | 34.43 | 3119.30 | 49.65 | 32.13 | - | - |
| Nocil | 160.34 | 162.95 | 162.00 | 178.73 | 158.20 | 82836.00 | 211.00 | 125.35 | 39 | 163.00 |
| Northern Arc | 220.90 | 219.80 | 228.10 | 235.00 | 218.45 | 548.21 | 290.00 | 141.47 | - | - |
| Nova Agri | 21.33 | 21.14 | 22.13 | 22.30 | 20.95 | 396.01 | 62.84 | 20.95 | - | - |
| NRB Bearing [2] | 228.30 | 231.35 | 232.25 | 236.85 | 228.10 | 264.29 | 312.75 | 196.85 | 17 | 230.75 |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rossell Tech | 673.90 | 701.40 | 679.00 | 711.90 | 679.00 | 34.16 | 840.00 | 277.05 | - | - |
| Roto Pumps | 52.81 | 53.82 | 53.90 | 54.90 | 52.96 | 429.58 | 310.25 | 52.21 | - | - |
| Route Mobile | 445.45 | 460.25 | 452.00 | 465.00 | 443.00 | 338.11 | 1158.00 | 443.00 | - | - |
| Royal Orch | 289.35 | 301.95 | 296.00 | 307.20 | 290.50 | 117.18 | 594.10 | 288.00 | 46 | 301.15 |
| RPG lifesc [8] | 1744.00 | 1781.30 | 1750.90 | 1818.00 | 1741.00 | 13.69 | 2715.90 | 1731.25 | 28 | 1763.95 |
| RPOWER | 20.97 | 21.40 | 21.95 | 21.95 | 20.90 | 49913.77 | 76.49 | 20.86 | - | 21.44 |
| RPP INFRA | 62.20 | 64.38 | 63.50 | 65.48 | 61.55 | 195.25 | 177.45 | 61.59 | 8 | 64.44 |
| RPSG Vent. | 559.85 | 600.75 | 565.00 | 615.00 | 561.05 | 77.90 | 1027.00 | 551.90 | - | - |
| RR Kabel | 1316.10 | 1350.40 | 1364.20 | 1364.20 | 1311.60 | 107.53 | 1578.20 | 864.05 | - | - |
| RS Soft [5] | 25.91 | 25.70 | 26.10 | 27.86 | 25.50 | 166.92 | 91.31 | 25.38 | - | 25.73 |
| RSystems Int [1] | 251.95 | 251.75 | 256.10 | 257.55 | 249.80 | 252.71 | 496.95 | 249.30 | 12 | 251.00 |
| RTNPOWER | 7.92 | 7.95 | 8.20 | 8.25 | 7.92 | 20992.37 | 16.94 | 7.63 | - | 7.96 |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SYMPHONY [2] | 727.20 | 724.10 | 742.00 | 746.00 | 715.55 | 222.05 | 1348.85 | 716.65 | 30 | 723.95 |
| Syncom Formu | 11.19 | 11.37 | 11.85 | 11.85 | 11.20 | 2136.76 | 23.49 | 11.00 | - | - |
| Syngene | 397.85 | 398.85 | 402.50 | 406.15 | 395.05 | 908.84 | 760.95 | 381.05 | 42 | 398.90 |
| Syrma SGS | 746.00 | 790.90 | 774.90 | 801.05 | 755.00 | 2165.67 | 909.90 | 370.00 | - | - |
| **T** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Taj Gvk Hotl [2] | 284.95 | 292.85 | 290.00 | 299.90 | 284.95 | 212.19 | 539.95 | 281.75 | 19 | 292.80 |
| Talbr Auto [2] | 224.40 | 224.05 | 230.00 | 233.00 | 219.90 | 158.24 | 325.45 | 201.05 | 17 | 224.30 |
| Tamil.newspr | 128.33 | 131.46 | 129.60 | 133.08 | 127.00 | 101.00 | 190.05 | 115.05 | 31 | 131.85 |
| TamilNaduPet | 79.90 | 82.66 | 80.30 | 83.90 | 80.10 | 216.86 | 129.35 | 66.41 | 8 | 82.48 |
| Tanla Sol [1] | 400.00 | 410.95 | 409.20 | 418.30 | 400.35 | 502.77 | 765.75 | 394.85 | 16 | 411.10 |
| Tarsons Prod | 177.88 | 181.37 | 182.00 | 185.00 | 177.00 | 67.82 | 458.00 | 174.91 | - | - |

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Zydus Well [2] | 414.45 | 440.55 | 421.00 | 444.00 | 417.25 | 731.57 | 530.55 | 316.80 | 397 | 439.95 |

## Exchange Traded Funds

| Company | Pre Cl | NSE Cl | Vol | 52 WH | 52 WL | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 360ONEAMC - GOLD360 | 130.40 | 136.35 | 59.94 | 178.00 | 78.20 | - |
| 360ONEAMC - SILVER360 | 204.96 | 220.13 | 250.85 | 358.00 | 78.40 | - |
| AONEAMC - AONETOTAL | 10.45 | 10.63 | 508.52 | 12.51 | 9.63 | - |
| AoneAMC-Liq | 1051.89 | 1052.03 | 71.08 | 1060.00 | 908.58 | - |
| AONEAMC-Nif | 9.24 | 9.40 | 502.89 | 12.00 | 9.13 | - |
| UnionAMCGold | 131.20 | 137.15 | 7.73 | 177.00 | 85.00 | - |
| UTIAMC-BANKBETA | 53.03 | 54.24 | 106.64 | 73.70 | 48.74 | - |
| UTIAMC-GILT10BETA | 25.97 | 25.84 | 2.10 | 26.99 | 25.05 | - |
| UTIAMC-GILT5BETA | 64.59 | 64.03 | 17.50 | 66.43 | 60.40 | - |
| UTIAMC-SILVERBETA | 192.80 | 213.84 | 2775.91 | 379.66 | 85.08 | - |
| UTIAMC-SNXT50BETA | 82.02 | 83.18 | 5.52 | 102.25 | 75.74 | - |
| UTIAMC-UTIGOLDBETA | 113.50 | 117.05 | 1588.96 | 149.35 | 71.10 | - |
| WEALTH - TWCGOLDETF | 134.72 | 138.95 | 4.36 | 187.98 | 123.31 | - |
| Zerod Mid150 | 9.75 | 10.00 | 4029.08 | 12.00 | 7.66 | - |
| ZerodhaA-Gol | 21.11 | 21.99 | 20475.94 | 27.94 | 12.83 | - |
| ZerodhAMCGil | 29.73 | 29.78 | 113.81 | 30.94 | 28.71 | - |
| ZerodhAMCSil | 20.37 | 22.54 | 27283.72 | 38.01 | 9.00 | - |
| ZerodhAM-Nif | 8.98 | 9.14 | 1957.76 | 10.97 | 8.94 | - |

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

## BSE Stocks

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| Shanti Edu. [1] | 149.80 | 167.65 |
| Shilchar Tec | 3773.35 | 3775.85 |
| Shiva Ceme [2] | 14.94 | 14.75 |
| Shivalik Bim [2] | 395.30 | 375.15 |
| Shivalik Ras [5] | 209.75 | 227.05 |
| Shree Ram Twis | 44.40 | 44.15 |
| Shringar House | 174.50 | 183.60 |

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| Supriya Life [2] | 550.85 | 564.40 |
| Suryoday SFB | 125.50 | 124.90 |
| Suven Pha [1] | 300.70 | 295.45 |
| Suyog Tele | 612.45 | 612.20 |
| SW-Solar [1] | 158.65 | 162.75 |
| Swiggy [1] | 272.50 | 275.60 |
| Swiss Miltry [2] | 15.08 | 15.26 |

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|
| Unimech Aer [5] | 766.05 | 737.45 |
| Updater Svc | 129.80 | 141.90 |
| Urban Comp [1] | 110.10 | 114.15 |
| UTI Asset | 907.65 | 927.85 |
| Valiant Org | 243.20 | 236.35 |
| Vedant Fash [1] | 338.80 | 350.95 |
| Veeram Sec [2] | 10.83 | 10.90 |

## NSE Trade for Trade